

MAS penalises CS, UOB, UBS, Citi, JB and LGT for AML failings

Priyanka Boghani James Phillipps

766 words

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Citywire Asia

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Singapore's regulator, the Monetary Authority of Singapore (MAS) has hit nine financial institutions, including leading banks in the region, with penalties totalling S\$27.45m (\$21.54m), and penalised several relationship managers, over the money laundering scandal that rocked the country.

The individual bank penalties include S\$5.8m for Credit Suisse; S\$5.6m for UOB; S\$3m for UBS; S\$2.6 for Citibank; S\$2.4m for Julius Baer and S\$1m for LGT.

MAS said it completed its supervisory examinations of the roles of financial institutions and individuals in the S\$3bn (\$2.3bn) money laundering case of August 2023. The case resulted in the jailing of 10 foreign nationals and the seizure of assets including properties, gold bars and luxury watches.

Several other capital market services license holders were penalised, including UOB Kay Hian Private Limited (UOBKH), which was hit with S\$2.85m. Asset manager Blue Ocean Invest and Trident Trust Company (Singapore) were slapped with S\$2.4m and S\$1.8m penalties.

The watchdog said the breaches took place between early 2023 and early 2025, and arose out of 'poor or inconsistent implementation' of AML/CFT policies and controls.

Julius Baer, Blue Ocean Invest, Citi, Credit Suisse and UOB Kay Hian all failed to implement adequate customer risk assessments which led to the mid-rating of money laundering risks. On transaction monitoring, Julius Baer, Citi, Credit Suisse, LGT, UOB, UOB Kay Hian, Trident and UBS all failed to meet MAS' standards, showing inconsistencies.

Both UOB and UOB Kay Hian did not follow up in a timely manner with a post-suspicious transaction report.

All nine financial institutions did not detect or adequately follow up on significant discrepancies or red flags in information and documents that should have cast doubt on some customers' purported source of wealth and which indicated increased risk of money laundering.

MAS said the institutions have embarked on remediation of the deficiencies and MAS will monitor their progress closely.

Private bankers penalised

The MAS also took action against a series of individuals, including censuring two senior former UOB bankers for failings around the money laundering scandal. Ang Sze Hee, Alvin, and Tan Sheng Rong, both ex-team head of group retail privilege banking at the Singaporean bank, received reprimands for 'failures to conduct or ensure proper due diligence'.

The censures related to not adequately scrutinising persons of interest and failures regarding post-suspicious transaction report follow-ups.

A further nine relationship managers and RM supervisors, whose employers were not disclosed, were privately reprimanded for 'more limited' lapses, MAS said.

'MAS may take action against a few remaining individuals, after the conclusion of ongoing court proceedings or investigations,' the regulator said.

MAS issued prohibition orders ranging from three to six years against four Blue Ocean Invest staff. The prohibition orders prevent them from carrying out any regulated activities for the duration of their term.

A UOB spokesperson said: 'We have conducted a thorough assessment of the facts and circumstances surrounding the issues and staff involved, and taken appropriate actions to address accountability and discipline.'

Banks respond

The fined banks have all said they accept MAS's findings and have acted to improve their systems and controls.

A spokesperson from Citi said the bank is 'committed to ensuring the highest standard of governance and controls to detect and prevent money laundering'. It has also strengthened its client onboarding and monitoring processes, the spokesperson added.

Noting the announcement, Julius Baer said: 'We have taken concrete steps to strengthen our processes and anti-money laundering framework and remain firmly committed to upholding the high standards of the Singapore financial centre.'

In response to the penalties, a spokesperson from UOB said: 'We acknowledge and accept MAS' findings with regard to the identified areas for improvement.'

UOB added that over the past two years, it has invested in technology and implemented 'prompt remedial actions to address the deficiencies identified after a comprehensive internal review, including stepping up on our transaction monitoring and customer due diligence processes'.

Meanwhile, a spokesperson from LGT said it acknowledges the MAS' findings and the financial penalty imposed.

'We remain strongly committed to the fight against money laundering and safeguarding the integrity of Singapore's financial system,' the spokesperson said.

While UBS said it has 'fully cooperated with the authorities to resolve this issue.'

Citywire Asia also reached out to Credit Suisse for a comment.

This article has been amended on 5 July to add comments from LGT, Julius Baer and UBS.

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Banking

'Standard Chartered is betting on SMEs in India to help grow **wealth management** business'

Joel Rebello

394 words

23 June 2025

The Economic Times

ECTIM

English

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Standard Chartered (StanC) is building its small and medium enterprises (SME) business in India to create a supply line for its **wealth management** business even as the British lender adjusts to regional frontiers in an increasingly deglobalised world, a top global executive told ET. Xie Wen, global head, SME banking, who has been with the bank for 27 years in different leadership positions, said that as **wealth management** is a key area for the bank, the SME business becomes a crucial feeder for the lender focused on Indian and Chinese clients. "In our region, especially in Asia, wealth creation (happens) in SMEs. Over the years as we build trust with the promoters we can really cross-sell into wealth. We also have to figure out collaboration between SME relationship managers (RMs), wealth RMs and investment managers.

So SME (business) can become a very integrated part for our wealth business," Wen said. StanChart CEO Bill Winters has said that the bank will double investments in the **wealth management** business and reshape its mass retail business to focus on developing the pipeline of future affluent and international banking clients. StanC banks 100 billionaires of Indian origin across the world and about 30% of the net new money inflows in 2024 came from this segment. Wen said the SME business in India has been expanding in double digits (percentage) for many years and the bank expects it to continue to grow at that pace. She declined to give the book size globally or in India. "India is going through urbanisation which is a great opportunity. Growth of the middle-class propels consumption which will become the engine of growth. Global supply chain diversifications together with policy support and a growing market are big drivers. For example, Apple is producing phones in India which will bring its supply chain and enhance manufacturing capabilities," Wen said. Wen said StanC is banking on its international network especially in Asia and Africa. "Globalisation is being replaced by regionalisation. That is happening within Asia and also intra Europe. Where there are challenges, there are opportunities. For StanChart our biggest markets are in Asia and Africa where activity is increasing and we are well positioned to take advantage of," she said.

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HSBC announces new Head of Wealth and Premier Solutions for Singapore

Distributed by Contify.com

639 words

20 June 2025

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* HSBC appoints Ishan as the new Head of Wealth and Premier Solutions for Singapore, based in Singapore, to lead the development and management of wealth products and customer journeys across all client segments.

* Ishan brings 20 years of product experience from investments and sales roles across leading global financial institutions, joining HSBC six years ago and most recently heading Capital Markets for HSBC Global **Private Banking** and Wealth in Southeast Asia.

* As Head of WPS, Singapore, Ishan will drive a differentiated wealth strategy, including the development and management of wealth products, platforms, and customer journeys across all client segments, from Premier to Ultra-High Net Worth (UHNW).

Original Press Release:

June 20 -- HSBC Group issued the following news release:

HSBC has appointed Ishan Sarkar as its new Head of Wealth and Premier Solutions (WPS), Singapore. Ishan will assume his new role on 1 July 2025, reporting jointly to Ashmita Acharya, Head of International Wealth and Premier Banking, HSBC Singapore, and Stefan Lecher, Head of Wealth and Premier Solutions Asia.

Based in Singapore, Ishan joined HSBC six years ago, and most recently headed Capital Markets for HSBC Global **Private Banking** and Wealth in Southeast Asia. He brings with him 20 years of product experience from investments and sales roles across various leading global financial institutions.

As Head of WPS, Singapore, Ishan will drive a differentiated wealth strategy for Singapore, including the development and management of the full suite of wealth products, platforms, and customer journeys across all client segments, from Premier to Ultra-High Net Worth (UHNW).

Ashmita Acharya, Head of International Wealth and Premier Banking, Singapore, said, "We aspire to be Singapore's leading international wealth bank, providing differentiated solutions for our globally mobile clients' wealth preservation and growth needs. I'm confident that Ishan's expertise and leadership will bring the best of our diverse wealth solutions to clients across segments to help them reach their ambitions."

Stefan Lecher, Head of Wealth and Premier Solutions Asia, said, "The demand for world-class, innovative **wealth management** solutions and timely market insights is growing stronger than ever in Singapore. In his new role, Ishan will steer the team in Singapore to leverage our global network and deliver our investment and advisory solutions at pace for our clients to manage, grow and preserve their wealth for generations to come."

HSBC Singapore

HSBC opened its first branch in Singapore in 1877. A qualifying full bank serving the international needs of individuals, corporate and institutional clients, HSBC offers a comprehensive range of banking and financial services including retail banking and **wealth management**; commercial, investment and **private banking**; insurance; forfailing and trustee services; securities and capital markets services. In May 2016, HSBC subsidiarised its retail banking and **wealth management** business in Singapore and established, HSBC Bank (Singapore) Limited. HSBC in Singapore was recognised by Euromoney as "Best International Bank in Singapore" in 2024 and was conferred the Champion of Good by the National Volunteer and Philanthropy Centre.

HSBC **Private Bank**

HSBC **Private Bank** helps clients manage, grow and preserve their wealth for generations to come. Its network of global experts helps clients access investment opportunities around the world, plan for the future with wealth and succession planning, manage their portfolio with tailored solutions, and find the right support for their philanthropy. www.privatebanking.hsbc.com**Opens** in new window

About HSBC Holdings plc

HSBC Holdings plc, the parent company of HSBC, is headquartered in London. HSBC serves customers worldwide from offices in 58 countries and territories. With assets of US\$3,054bn at 31 March 2025, HSBC is one of the world's largest banking and financial services organisations.

[Category: Banking and Financial Services, Financial/ Capital Market, Asset and **Wealth Management**, New Offerings, Management/ Leadership Changes]

Source: HSBC Group

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AUM up by 39%, DBS Treasures strengthens its position as a trusted partner in global wealth | Bahasa

Distributed by Contify.com

1,336 words

19 June 2025

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* The number of High Net Worth Individuals (HNWIs) is projected to rise to 38.3% by 2028, driven by economic and per capita income growth.

* DBS Treasures offers comprehensive financial solutions to address the needs of individuals and businesses, particularly in Asia.

* The bank provides customers with strategic access to regional networks to unlock potential asset growth and cross-border business opportunities.

Original Press Release:

Indonesia, June 19 -- DBS Bank Ltd issued the following news release:

The current geopolitical dynamics and global economic uncertainty have led to a more defensive approach to **wealth management** as people keep an eye on opportunities in Asian markets. Under pressures from high interest rates, inflation, and geopolitical tensions, **wealth management** strategies now focus on protecting asset values and avoiding high risks.

On the other hand, the high net worth individual (HNWI) segment is still growing rapidly. The Knight Frank Global Wealth Report 2024 noted that the number of UHNWIs increased by 2.6 percent in 2023 from 2022. This figure is projected to continue rising to 38.3 percent by 2028, driven mainly by economic and per capita income growth, a young population increasingly able to get access to investment opportunities, as well as such factors as climate change and technological advancements.

The above projection is supported by DBS Treasures' business data in Indonesia, with Assets Under Management (AUM) growing by 39 percent from 2022 to 2025. The rapid growth of HNWIs has led to a growing need for comprehensive financial solutions. This has encouraged DBS Treasures to continue to establish itself as a Trusted Partner for Global **Wealth management**, mainly to address the needs of individuals and businesses, specifically clients in Asia.

Consumer Banking Director at PT Bank DBS Indonesia Melfrida Gultom explained that, "As the number of high net worth individuals increases, the demand for **wealth management** solutions is evolving and shifting towards more comprehensive and business-agnostic solutions. At Bank DBS Indonesia, we pride ourselves on being a trusted partner that not only offers market analysis expertise and technological strength, but also provides customers with strategic access to a strong regional network in Asia to unlock potential asset growth and cross-border business opportunities. This holistic approach enables us to assist our clients in building, managing, and passing down wealth sustainably across generations."

As customers look to grow their businesses and explore opportunities in Asia, Bank DBS Indonesia presents a dedicated team of global experts who actively analyse market signals to provide insights into and recommendations for investment opportunities. From an Asian perspective, DBS Bank Ltd (Bank DBS) offers **wealth management** services covering personal assets and family business management, as well as helps create prudent legacy plans for the second generation. Furthermore, Bank DBS Indonesia also holds Expert Discussion sessions, curated forums with selected experts to discuss the latest investment strategies through such sessions as Monthly & Annual Market Update, DBS CIO Insight, Asian Insights, Spring Festival, and Market Alert. In addition, DBS Expert Connection connects customers and the next generation with industry leaders across various countries.

In addition, Bank DBS Indonesia utilises a holistic approach to **wealth management** by combining global expertise with advanced technology. The guide provided by DBS Group Investment Experts is enriched by Artificial Intelligence (AI) that analyses market data and customer profiles to generate personalised and relevant investment advice. On top of that, Portfolio 360°, the in-house digital platform, enables Relationship Managers to thoroughly understand customer needs and provide incisive and personalised portfolio advisory. Customers also receive proactive notifications of market updates and product information through various channels of choice. For easy financial access 24/7 and to seize opportunities as they arise, customers can rely on the comprehensive and intuitive digibank by DBS application.

Head of Segmentation, Liabilities, and Secured Lending PT Bank DBS Indonesia Natalina Syabana added, "As a bank with extensive connectivity across Asia, Bank DBS Indonesia provides customers with strategic access to regional networks to unlock potential asset growth and cross-border business opportunities. Supported by a team of experts who understand the dynamics of Asian markets, we are ready to help customers optimise every investment opportunity. Moreover, our hassle-free global transactions, from transfers to more than 25 countries to access to emergency withdrawals across the DBS Bank network, ensure that customers can manage their wealth comfortably and with peace of mind wherever they are."

DBS Treasures customers can now enjoy the freedom to choose their privilege packages across Asia-Pacific, from travel to wellness and education. Most recently, DBS Treasures customers can obtain the DBS Vantage Visa Infinite Credit Card that supports wellness and travel, as well as sustainability, as it is made from recycled metals to provide eco-friendly solutions. The card provides access to medical check-ups in Indonesia and Singapore, as well as a Medical Concierge for various medical needs. It also comes with a feature to support the travel lifestyle, Vantage Points, which is valid for life and can be redeemed for flights to anywhere with any airline.

As part of its commitment to the ESG (Environmental, Social & Governance) agenda, DBS Treasures also offers a wide range of bonds and mutual funds that have the potential to continue to grow while making a positive impact; Spark Saving that allows account holders to donate a portion of their interest earnings to support children's education in remote areas; and DBS Foundation that supports social enterprises.

About DBS

DBS is a leading financial services group in Asia with a presence in 19 markets. Headquartered and listed in Singapore, DBS is in the three key Asian axes of growth: Greater China, Southeast Asia and South Asia. The bank's "AA-" and "Aa1" credit ratings are among the highest in the world.

Recognised for its global leadership, DBS has been named "World's Best Bank" by Global Finance, "World's Best Bank" by Euromoney and "Global Bank of the Year" by The Banker. The bank is at the forefront of leveraging digital technology to shape the future of banking, having been named "World's Best Digital Bank" by Euromoney and the world's "Most Innovative in Digital Banking" by The Banker. In addition, DBS has been accorded the "Safest Bank in Asia" award by Global Finance for 16 consecutive years from 2009 to 2024.

DBS provides a full range of services in consumer, SME and corporate banking. As a bank born and bred in Asia, DBS understands the intricacies of doing business in the region's most dynamic markets.

Established in 1989 as part of the Singapore-based DBS Group, PT Bank DBS Indonesia (Bank DBS Indonesia) is one of the banks with the longest history in Asia. Currently operating 1 Head Office, 13 Branch Offices, 16 Assistant Offices and 1 Functional Office and 3,011 active employees in 15 Major Cities in Indonesia, Bank DBS Indonesia provides comprehensive banking services that focus on the customer experience to 'Live more, Bank less'. We also see a purpose beyond banking and are committed to supporting our customers, employees, and the community towards a sustainable future.

PT Bank DBS Indonesia is licensed and supervised by The Indonesian Financial Services Authority (OJK), and an insured member of Indonesia Deposit Insurance Corporation (LPS).

DBS is committed to building lasting relationships with customers, as it banks the Asian way. Through the DBS Foundation, the bank creates impact beyond banking by supporting businesses for impact: enterprises with a double bottom-line of profit and social and/or environmental impact. DBS Foundation also gives back to society in various ways, including equipping underserved communities with future-ready skills and helping them to build food resilience.

With its extensive network of operations in Asia and emphasis on engaging and empowering its staff, DBS presents exciting career opportunities. For more information, please visit www.dbs.com.

[Category: Banking and Financial Services, Financial/ Capital Market, Asset and **Wealth Management**]

Source: DBS Bank Ltd

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Barclays hires former HSBC GPB UAE head

Priyanka Boghani
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Barclays has named its new head of **private bank** for the UAE, snapping up HSBC Global **Private Banking**'s former **private banking** boss for the UAE region.

Farzad Billimoria (pictured) will take on the new Dubai-based role from 1 July. He will report to Annabelle Bryde, Barclays' head of **private bank** international, the bank said in a 19 June statement.

'The Middle East presents significant growth opportunities for Barclays with its expanding influence on global markets and increasing wealth generation,' Bryde said.

Billimoria was most recently the senior executive officer and head of **private bank** for the UAE at HSBC where he drove the bank's strategy in the region. He led a team that established HSBC **Private Bank** (Suisse) SA offices in the Dubai International Financial Centre (DIFC) branch and Abu Dhabi Global Market (ADGM). He also launched HSBC's first onshore **private bank** booking centre in the UAE. Additionally, he managed the growth of the non resident Indians (NRI) business in the region and has handled some of the UAE's largest ultra-high-net-worth (UHNW) client portfolios and relationships.

He [left](#) the bank amid changes that took place as a result of the HSBC's need to simplify its structure and improve efficiency. His responsibilities were taken over by Aladdin Hangari, HSBC's head of GPB MENAT.

In May, Asim Sheikh, based in Dubai, [joined](#) HSBC GPB from Mashreq Bank, as its new head of onshore UAE.

Citywire Middle East understands that Barclays **Private Bank**'s UAE CEO and Mena head, Rasha Badawi will stay with the bank, but move into a new role.

Barclays has been growing its presence and assets under management (AUM) in the last five years, Badawi had [told](#) Citywire Asia in an earlier interview.

'We've been able to capture wealth migration, creation and multiplication [in the UAE] over the past three years in a very, very meaningful way because we've been able to cater to the clients' complex demands,' Badawi said.

The bank serves institutions, charities, endowments, family offices and ultra-high-net-worth individuals (UHNWI).

This article was amended at 1.08pm UAE time to add Aladdin Hangari's new responsibilities and information about Rasha Badawi's role.

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Business

DBS Hong Kong hiring **wealth managers** as investors' risk appetite grows

Enoch Yiu

685 words

16 June 2025

scmp.com

SCMCOM

English

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The subsidiary of the Singapore bank plans to hire 100 bankers and open a new **wealth-management** centre

DBS Hong Kong, a unit of Southeast Asia's biggest lender, plans to hire 100 bankers in the next three years and open a new wealth centre next year to capture the growing **wealth-management** business in the city, according to a senior executive.

The subsidiary of the Singapore bank was pressing ahead with its expansion plan as its wealthy customers were not worried about market volatility triggered by the US-China trade war, according to Ajay Mathur, head of DBS Hong Kong's consumer banking group and **wealth management**.

"The trade war and geopolitical tensions [may] have created volatility, [but] when there is volatility, it is a great time to trade currencies, bonds and equities," Mathur said in an interview with the Post. "Our affluent clients have made the most of it."

Do you have questions about the biggest topics and trends from around the world? Get the answers with [SCMP Knowledge](#), our new platform of curated content with explainers, FAQs, analyses and infographics brought to you by our award-winning team.

The benchmark Hang Seng Index plunged 13.2 per cent on April 7 after the US imposed hefty tariffs on Chinese imports, marking its largest one-day decline since October 1997. But the market recovered after both sides agreed to a 90-day truce last month.

The index has gained 24 per cent this year, after rising 18 per cent last year. Meanwhile, the average daily stock turnover in the first five months this year has jumped 120 per cent year on year to HK\$242 billion (US\$30.8 billion).

Mathur said the bank has seen investments increase across all asset types, including stocks, bonds and currencies this year, driven mainly by affluent clients who have at least HK\$1 million to invest.

As a result, DBS would hire an additional 100 relationship managers over the next three years to capture a slice of the growing **wealth-management** sector, Mathur said.

The bank was also in the process of identifying a convenient location for its flagship wealth centre, which would offer clients **wealth management**, insurance and other financial planning services, he said. The centre would be launched next year, he added.

The proposed **wealth-management** centre comes after the successful launch of its first hub at 18 Queen's Road Central last year. The plush 15,000 sq ft space targets high-net-worth customers from Hong Kong and the mainland.

"Our flagship **wealth-management** centre is designed to allow our bankers to establish client relationships," he said.

DBS and its rivals like HSBC and Standard Chartered are all betting on the growing **wealth management** business in the city.

Hong Kong, which had HK\$31 trillion of assets under management in 2023, was likely to overtake Switzerland by 2027 as the world's top hub for cross-border **wealth management**, according to estimates from Boston Consulting Group.

The main drivers of the **wealth-management** business in the city were the increasing number of visitors from the mainland and other Asian countries following the reopening of the border in 2023 after a three-year closure due to the pandemic.

Revenue from DBS Hong Kong's **wealth-management** business in the first quarter had grown 86 per cent from the same period in 2023, Mathur said.

He added that about 35 per cent came from non-Hong Kong residents, while overseas buyers accounted for half of its insurance sales. DBS does not have insurance products of its own, but sells Manulife's policies for a fee.

"Mainland and other Asian clients are coming to Hong Kong to invest to diversify their portfolio because Hong Kong is an international financial centre with a wide range of investment products, a liquid stock market and many bond offerings," Mathur said.

"The mainland and overseas customers also like to buy Hong Kong insurance policies for better returns and legacy planning to pass their wealth to the next generation."

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Business

DBS eyes slice of HK wealth business

Enoch Yiu

592 words

16 June 2025

South China Morning Post

SCMP

B1

English

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Local subsidiary of Singapore bank plans to hire 100 bankers and open a new centre for its affluent clients as investors' risk appetite grows

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Exclusive: BNP Paribas WM names Southeast Asia market co-head

Priyanka Boghani

183 words

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CWIRAS

English

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BNP Paribas **Wealth Management** has tapped internally for a new co-head of Southeast Asia market, Citywire Asia understands.

Sharon Loh is moving into the role, alongside Sean Tay, who is joining from UOB Private Bank. They will report to Garth Bregman, head of **wealth management** Singapore and Southeast Asia.

Citywire reached out to BNP Paribas for comment.

Loh's last role was Asia head of active advisory. She joined the bank in 2016, and has held similar roles across UBS Global **Wealth Management** and Deutsche Bank.

Loh and Tay's appointments fill the shoes of Alison Lim, market head SEA, who left last October after over five years at the French bank.

Tay was previously UOB Private Bank's Malaysia market head. Citywire Asia has also reported that Warren Tang, Daniel Lye and Ze Wei Tay will join from UOB to cover the Malaysia market.

See Piu Chua, managing director and market lead, has also recently tendered at BNP Paribas WM after four years. He covers the Southeast Asia market.

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Business

HSBC asset-management unit dives into private credit in Asia, with US\$4 billion backing

Aileen Chuang

717 words

4 June 2025

scmp.com

SCMCOM

English

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Lender is the latest financial institution to enter the private-credit market, drawn by attractive returns and diversification advantages

HSBC Asset Management will launch a dedicated private-credit strategy in Asia-Pacific later this year after its parent unveiled plans to inject US\$4 billion into its funds to bolster the higher-returning business.

The asset management arm of Hong Kong's biggest lender aimed to use the offering to support corporate, family and private equity-backed clients across the region, according to Chris Fletcher, head of Asia-Pacific private credit.

"We are going to be very much focused on supporting performing, mid-market companies," he said during a panel discussion at the Greater China Private Equity Summit last week.

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The move coincided with HSBC's decision to invest the cash into its asset management arm's private-credit funds, according to a Reuters report on Monday. The bank aimed to attract additional capital from external investors to build a US\$50 billion credit fund within five years, which would be invested globally, with an initial focus on direct lending in Asia and the UK, the report said. The bank declined to comment.

HSBC is the latest financial institution to enter the private-credit market, drawn by attractive returns and diversification advantages. The attention on Asia also makes sense due to the region's significant growth potential compared with the more developed Western markets in non-traditional lending.

"There is a clear trend in the private-credit market, characterised by rising investments from insurance companies, family offices and sovereign wealth funds," said Stephen Wong, an executive committee member of the Chartered Alternative Investment Analyst Association's Greater China chapter.

[Private credit](#), or private debt, provides an alternative channel to bank lending for borrowers. The asset class [took off in the US](#) after the 2008 global financial crisis. Asia-Pacific, a region dominated by bank lending, had only a 7 per cent share of the US\$1.7 trillion global private-debt market, according to data provider Preqin.

"Banks' lending role is decreasing because of the financial crisis and the regulatory scrutiny," Wong said. However, for companies still in need of funds, private credit funds emerged to fill the gap, he added.

Banks have developed their private-credit strategies. Last September, Citigroup partnered with private-equity giant Apollo on a private credit programme, which includes investments from an Abu Dhabi sovereign wealth fund Mubadala and Apollo's retirement-services unit Athene. Citigroup was providing its client network and capital-market expertise, the companies said.

HSBC's balance-sheet backing for its private-credit funds could help the bank's business and allow for more control in future investments, according to Wong. Investors in these private credit funds preferred visibility in the investment targets to avoid looking at a "black box", which created high risks and capital charges, he added.

HSBC CEO Georges Elhedery has embarked on a journey to reorganise the group's operations and explore ways to boost growth. He announced plans to redeploy US\$1.5 billion from "low return" areas to high-growth businesses in Hong Kong, mainland China, India and other Asian markets.

Fletcher noted three opportunities in China: supporting private-equity firms to optimise capital structures, because they hold onto assets longer; supporting Chinese companies that require capital to expand in Southeast Asia and beyond; and finally, helping China-based private equity firms diversify their portfolios by investing beyond local markets, particularly in the rest of Asia and Europe.

"We get China, we like it as a place to invest," he said. "We feel very confident in terms of our ability to assess the risk there, price it properly and underwrite it. China is the monster in the [Asia-Pacific] market. If you are genuinely claiming to be [Asia-Pacific]-focused, your strategy has to be a broad brush, and I'd expect to see a good weighting towards China as a market in your allocations."

Document SCMCOM0020250604e1640002w

HSBC GPB appoints UAE onshore head

Paromita Dey

222 words

30 May 2025

Citywire Middle East

CWIRME

English

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HSBC Global **Private Banking** (GPB) has appointed the head of onshore UAE, according to a recent update on LinkedIn.

Asim Sheikh, based in Dubai, joins from Mashreq Bank, where he served as senior vice president and regional head for **wealth management**. In that role, he led revenue growth initiatives, developed pricing strategies, and oversaw asset book management for the bank's high-net-worth (HNW) **wealth management** division.

This marks a return to HSBC for Sheikh, who previously spent seven years as senior manager for premier and **wealth management** in the Middle East. During that time, he led a 100-member team across Dubai, Abu Dhabi, and the Northern Emirates.

With nearly three decades of experience in **wealth management** and **private banking**, Sheikh has also held roles at ABN AMRO and Zurich Insurance.

In November 2024, the bank named Selim Kervanci as CEO for the Middle East, reporting to Surendra Rosha and David Liao, co-CEOs of Asia and the Middle East. Kervanci, previously CEO of HSBC Turkey, relocated to Dubai for the role in August.

In March this year, Farzad Billimoria, HSBC GPB's former head of **private banking** for the UAE, [stepped down](#) after nearly three decades with the bank. His responsibilities were taken over by Aladdin Hangari, head of GPB MENAT.

Document CWIRME0020250603e15u0002t

Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank** targets Middle East growth with further new hires in the UAE

Distributed by Contify.com

631 words

21 May 2025

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank** is targeting growth in the Middle East, specifically in the UAE, through further new hires.

* The bank aims to leverage its cross-border capabilities and **wealth management** expertise to drive sustainable growth opportunities in the region.

* The hiring initiative is part of the bank's strategy to expand its presence in the Middle East and tap into the region's growing demand for financial services.

Original Press Release:

Dubai, United Arab Emirates, May 21 -- Standard Chartered issued the following news release:

- The Bank is expanding its frontline team including appointing a new EMEA Market Head

Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank** ("the **Private Bank**") announced today a further expansion of its frontline **private banking** team in the UAE, including the appointment of a new Europe, Middle East and Africa (EMEA) Market Head. This expansion in the **Private Bank**'s UAE team is part of Standard Chartered's broader strategy to invest USD 1.5 billion in its Affluent business over the next five years.

Commenting on the appointments, Vinay Gandhi, Global Head of South Asian Community and Regional Head of EMEA, Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank**, said: "The Middle East is growing at an extraordinary pace, with the UAE in particular experiencing rapid growth in wealth creation amongst high-net-worth (HNW) and ultra-high-net-worth (UHNW) individuals who increasingly seek bespoke, cross-border financial solutions for wealth preservation, intergenerational transfers and sustainable growth."

He added: "As one of the Bank's wealth hubs, the UAE plays a pivotal role in Standard Chartered's global strategy. We continue to actively invest in our talent pool, provide tailor-made client solutions and diversify our product offerings to meet the needs of our HNW and UHNW clients. This latest expansion of the team, led by Yahya Ismail, reflects our commitment to accelerating the growth of our **private banking** business, leveraging our wealth capabilities, global network, and deep local expertise to unlock opportunities and help our clients protect, manage, and grow their wealth."

Latest UAE Appointments

Yahya Ismail joins as Managing Director, Market Head, Europe, Middle East and Africa. He has over 25 years of banking experience across corporate and **private banking**, having spent the last 20 years in private **wealth management** at Julius Baer and ABN AMRO.

Laura Haddad joins as Senior Client Partner, Lead, GCC UHNW. She brings over 20 years of experience in **wealth management** for ultra-high-net-worth clients and families, working with banks including Julius Baer, Credit Agricole, Citibank, Emirates NBD, and the Royal Bank of Canada.

Samia Shah Nawaz joins as Executive Director, Relationship Manager, **Private Banking**. She has over 20 years of banking experience across private and institutional banking, working with banks including Julius Baer, Bank of Singapore, Barclays and Citibank.

Ramla Mansukhani and Lakshmi Menon both rejoin as Relationship Manager, **Private Banking** and Client Service Manager, **Private Banking** respectively. They bring with them close to 20 years of diverse banking experience across international banks.

As a leading international **wealth manager**, Standard Chartered continues investing in its capabilities and leveraging the power of its network to support its clients' evolving needs. By the end of 2024, the **Private Bank** announced a 20% expansion to its frontline banking team in the UAE.

Standard Chartered

We are a leading international banking group, with a presence in 53 of the world's most dynamic markets. Our purpose is to drive commerce and prosperity through our unique diversity, and our heritage and values are expressed in our brand promise, here for good.

Standard Chartered PLC is listed on the London and Hong Kong stock exchanges.

[Category: Investment Banking and Brokerage, Hirings]

Source: Standard Chartered

Document ATINBK0020250527e151000e8



Wealth Management

Standard Chartered raids Julius Baer for UAE private banking team; UK bank hires Yahya Ismail as its new Dubai-based Emea market head

Kristen McGachey

307 words

21 May 2025

15:33

Financial News

LONFIN

English

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Standard Chartered has raided Julius Baer for a string of hires for its private banking team in the United Arab Emirates.

The UK bank has hired Yahya Ismail as managing director and market head for Europe, Middle East and Africa, based out of its Dubai office. Ismail was a managing director at Julius Baer, and leaves the Swiss wealth manager after nearly a decade.

It has also hired Laura Haddad and Samia Shah Nawaz from Julius Baer. Haddad joins as a senior client partner in its ultra high net worth team, while Shah Nawaz is an executive director and relationship manager for the private banking business.

Standard Chartered said expanding its frontline team in the UAE with fresh hires forms part of its broader strategy to invest \$1.5bn in its affluent business over the next five years.

Vinay Gandhi, regional head of Emea for Standard Chartered Global Private Bank, said the UK lender continues to "actively invest in our talent pool" as its ultra rich client base in the region grows.

"This latest expansion of the team, led by Yahya Ismail, reflects our commitment to accelerating the growth of our private banking business, leveraging our wealth capabilities, global network, and deep local expertise to unlock opportunities and help our clients protect, manage, and grow their wealth," Gandhi said.

Standard Chartered has upped its focus on wealth management, with chief executive Bill Winters committing to double investment in this area of the business last year.

In March, the UK lender rolled out an investment club for its ultra-wealthy clients last month to give them exclusive access to private markets deals globally.

Write to Kristen McGachey at kristen.mcgachey@dowjones.com

Document LONFIN0020250521e15I0005I

StanChart PB names EMEA market head, makes four new hires

Priyanka Boghani

323 words

21 May 2025

Citywire Middle East

CWIRME

English

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Standard Chartered **Private Bank** has hired a new Europe, Middle East and Africa market head from Julius Baer, as well as bolstered its **private banking** bench in the UAE with four more hires.

Yahya Ismail joins as EMEA market head, based in Dubai. He was at Julius Baer for almost a decade and at ABN AMRO Bank for over 16 years prior to joining the British lender.

Standard Chartered also hired Laura Haddad as senior client partner, lead GCC UHNW and Lakshmi Menon as senior service manager, **private banking**, as well as Samia Shahnawaz, Ramla Mansukhani as relationship managers.

'As one of the bank's wealth hubs, the UAE plays a pivotal role in Standard Chartered's global strategy,' said Vinay Gandhi, global head of South Asian community and regional head of EMEA at Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank**.

'We continue to actively invest in our talent pool, provide tailor-made client solutions and diversify our product offerings to meet the needs of our HNW and UHNW clients.'

The expansion is part of Standard Chartered's broader strategy to invest \$1.5bn in its affluent business over the next five years, according to the bank.

By 2024-end, the bank said it expanded its frontline **private banking** team in the UAE by 20%, hiring group head Momin Jaffar from HSBC as well as a string of relationship managers dedicated to the **private bank**.

Standard Chartered also [recently](#) opened the doors to its first 'Priority Private' centre for the Mena region, as it looks to expand its reach of the mass affluent and high net worth wealth tiers.

The bank also set the ambitious target of attracting \$200bn in net new money and double-digit growth in its wealth solutions over the next five years, with a focus on global Chinese and Indians stationed in Singapore, Hong Kong, the UAE and Jersey.

Document CWIRME0020250522e15100003

HSBC targets entrepreneurs with wealth programme launch

Cheryl Heng
280 words
21 May 2025
Citywire Asia
CWIRAS
English

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HSBC has introduced an entrepreneur wealth programme in Asia to target entrepreneurs who are yet to be their **private banking** clients, strengthening its one bank offerings.

HSBC launched the Private Wealth Entrepreneur Incubation programme for early-stage entrepreneurs, starting in Hong Kong, according to a 21 May release.

The programme offers tailored wealth planning, investment events, and access to a global network of industry experts, guided by experienced relationship managers, targeting high-potential business owners.

Lok Yim (pictured), regional head of Global **Private Banking**, Asia Pacific at HSBC, noted that two-thirds of their **private banking** clients in Hong Kong are entrepreneurs.

The new proposition leverages HSBC's connectivity across global **private banking**, commercial banking, and corporate and institutional banking, aligning entrepreneurs' business goals with investment and wealth planning needs.

According to HSBC's entrepreneurial wealth report, 83% of entrepreneurs globally prioritise family and legacy as the purpose of their wealth, and the bank noted that their one-bank solutions has seen significant demand.

Hong Kong's entrepreneurs are notably mobile, with 80% living part-time in multiple locations, compared to a global average of 53%. Despite this, 81% primarily operate their businesses domestically, reinforcing Hong Kong's role as a key market. This international lifestyle has fueled demand for cross-border financial solutions.

Additionally, HSBC introduced an Innovation Exchange programme in Hong Kong and the UK, connecting **private banking** clients with innovative businesses to share insights in the technology and innovation sectors.

This includes a segment which further engages with tech-focused ultra-high net worth clients in Asia, offering trips to the US to meet tech venture capitalists and startups.

Document CWIRAS0020250521e1510002t

StanChart PB names Asia philanthropy head

Priyanka Boghani

161 words

21 May 2025

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank** has appointed a new Hong Kong-based head of philanthropy, Asia, wealth planning and family advisory.

Scott Chang will take on the role, after several years in the philanthropy space. He will work with the bank's relationship managers and wealth planners to deliver philanthropy advisory solutions.

Most recently, he worked at Ford Philanthropy, based in mainland China and Thailand, where he led the foundation's work in Asia. He began his career at BSR, an NGO focused on corporate sustainability, where he was responsible for opening two new offices in the mainland.

Several **private banks** have dedicated philanthropy desks in Asia, with some opting to be based in Hong Kong and others in Singapore.

Most recently, Citi **Private Bank** [set up](#) its philanthropy advisory service in Singapore, where Hong Kong clients will only be able to access it if their accounts are held in the Lion City.

Document CWIRAS0020250521eI5I00004

HSBC report shows Asia's entrepreneurs diverge on preferred routes for business exit

Distributed by Contify.com

1,033 words

14 May 2025

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* HSBC's report 'Family-owned businesses in Asia: Harmony through succession planning' reveals that Asian family business owners are keen to maintain their legacy and wealth across future generations, but few are actively preparing for succession.

* Entrepreneurs in mainland China, Hong Kong, and Taiwan show the most interest in selling their business as the exit route, with 25%, 29%, and 27% respectively, compared to 21% globally.

* Family businesses in Asia account for about 79% of GDP in India and around 50% of GDP in mainland China, dominating the private sector.

Original Press Release:

May 14 -- HSBC **Private Banking** issued the following news release:

HSBC Global **Private Banking** today released a new report titled 'Family-owned businesses in Asia: Harmony through succession planning', which analyses how prepared family-owned businesses in Asia are for the future of their businesses and their wealth.

Family business owners in Asia are keen to maintain their legacy and wealth across future generations; however, few are actively preparing for succession, including those who are themselves second- or third-generation owners. This gap between intention and reality is particularly apparent when compared to Western markets.

Globally, 78 per cent of entrepreneurs would like to keep their business in the family. However, over half (52 per cent) have not planned for this future. Asian business owners lag even further behind, with approximately two-thirds of respondents from mainland China, Hong Kong and Taiwan not having planned for how their businesses might continue after them.

Key regional differences in business owners' motivations and preferences for exit include:

* India has the highest percentage of entrepreneurs who intend to pass their business on to a family member, with 79 per cent intending to do so, which puts Indian business owners on a level with their counterparts in the UK (77 per cent) and Switzerland (76 per cent). However, fewer than half of the respondents in Hong Kong share this intention (44 per cent), along with just 56 per cent in mainland China and 61 per cent in Taiwan

* Entrepreneurs in mainland China (25 per cent), Hong Kong (29 per cent) and Taiwan (27 per cent), plus to a slightly lesser extent Singapore (22 per cent), show the most interest in selling their business as the exit route of the 10 surveyed markets. The sector most favoured for sale globally is electronics (21 per cent), a sector in which Asia accounts for almost two-thirds of world exports

* This varied appetite for selling may also be connected to the lived experience and motivations of respondents who themselves inherited the family business. Among the second- and third-generation entrepreneurs surveyed, almost 60 per cent of respondents in mainland China say they felt a sense of obligation to take on the family business, compared to only 7 per cent in India

* Nevertheless, many multi-generational entrepreneurs across the region feel supported by older generations in the family. In Singapore, this stands at 83 per cent, and even in Taiwan, which sits at the bottom of the Asian pack, it still remains high at 70 per cent

Although families in Asia are planning for succession less than their global counterparts, they increasingly recognise the need to formalise their wealth structures. The importance of succession planning for family businesses in Asia is also underscored by their economic contribution. These enterprises account for about 79 per cent of GDP in India, one of the highest ratios globally, and around 50 per cent of GDP in mainland China, dominating the private sector.

Lok Yim, Regional Head, Global **Private Banking**, Asia Pacific, HSBC, said: "It is important to consider the value of family-owned businesses as a part of the global economy. Acknowledging this means accepting that we are now in the depths of a record transition of businesses between generations, or to new management. We have seen that the views and family dynamics of the founders can have significant consequences."

There is importance attached to legacy, but not necessarily to keeping the business in the family. HSBC's report found that, despite wanting and trusting the next generation to carry on the family business, many Asian entrepreneurs recognise their children may have different aspirations and a significant proportion are open to them exploring these.

Edith Ang, Head of Family Advisory, Asia Pacific, HSBC Global **Private Banking**, commented: "Asian entrepreneurs and their families can better prepare for the future by embracing a dynamic, forward-thinking approach to extending business longevity and protecting wealth."

"Having these conversations early allows family members to clarify their expectations, professionals working alongside to develop a deeper understanding of the family. Everyone benefits from adequate time to learn and grow into roles. This can maximise the smoothness of eventual transitions. It does not have to be a decision to keep the business in the family or sell and formalise the wealth through a single family office. Sometimes the optimal solution could be a blend of the two."

About HSBC's 'Family -owned businesses in Asia: Harmony through succession planning' report

The findings are based on extensive research conducted by Ipsos UK on behalf of HSBC among 1,798 high net worth business owners with at least USD2 million of investable assets. The research was conducted online in mainland China, France, Hong Kong, India, Singapore, Switzerland, Taiwan, UAE, UK and US. See the report for the full methodology.

About HSBC Global **Private Banking**

HSBC Global **Private Banking** helps clients manage, grow and preserve their wealth for generations to come. Its network of global experts helps clients access investment opportunities around the world, plan for the future with wealth and succession planning, manage their portfolio with tailored solutions, and find the right support for their philanthropy. www.privatebanking.hsbc.com

About HSBC Holdings plc

HSBC Holdings plc, the parent company of HSBC, is headquartered in London. HSBC serves customers worldwide from offices in 58 countries and territories. With assets of USD3,054 billion at 31 March 2025, HSBC is one of the world's largest banking and financial services organisations.

[Category: Banking and Financial Services, Banks, Retail Banking]

Source: HSBC **Private Banking**

Document ATINBK0020250515e15e000gy

Exclusive: HSBC GPB loses two Australia bankers

Priyanka Boghani

268 words

9 May 2025

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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HSBC Global **Private Banking**'s two Singapore-based Australia bankers have left, Citywire Asia can reveal.

Sanjay Shah and Mansie Virmani have resigned from their posts at the bank, where they covered the Australia market.

A spokesperson for the bank declined to comment.

Shah worked at HSBC for six years, holding different roles including desk head of international markets. Prior to that, he worked at BNP Paribas Wealth Management as its non-resident Indian North Asia head and spent almost a decade at JP Morgan in Singapore and Hong Kong.

Virmani recently relocated from Australia to Singapore, following the bank's decision to offer **private banking** services to clients in Australia via a specialist team based in Singapore.

Both Virmani and Shah were part of market head Abhishek Mehrotra's team, who covers the onshore and offshore markets of Thailand, Vietnam, Philippines, Australia and Japan.

Mehrotra has three desk heads in his team, following the recent [appointment](#) of Mina Chan as the GPB Philippines and Japan desk head. They also include Sanjay Shah, who covers Australia, and Benjamin Wang, on the Thailand desk.

Private banks have tweaked their Asean market strategies, with some opting to keep international desks and others opting to cover the markets under an Asean head. UBS Global Wealth Management, for example, recently [set up](#) international Japan and Australia desks in Singapore.

HSBC [reported](#) \$22bn of net new invested assets for the first quarter this year, of which Asia contributed \$16bn. This brought Asia's total invested assets to \$676bn, up 4.8% year-on-year.

Document CWIRAS0020250509e15900007

DBS: First-quarter profit before tax at record SGD 3.44 billion as total income grows 6% to new high of SGD 5.91 billion; net profit at SGD 2.90 billion with ROE at 17.3%

Distributed by Contify.com

1,332 words

8 May 2025

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* DBS Group achieved a record profit before tax of SGD 3.44 billion in the first quarter of 2025, with total income reaching a new high of SGD 5.91 billion due to robust business growth.

* Net profit was SGD 2.90 billion, 2% lower than the previous year due to higher tax expenses from the implementation of the 15% global minimum tax.

* Total income rose 6% from balance sheet growth, record fee income, and treasury customer sales driven by **wealth management**, as well as the strongest markets trading income in 12 quarters.

Original Press Release:

Singapore, Hong Kong, Indonesia, India, China, Taiwan, May 8 -- DBS Bank Ltd issued the following news release:

DBS Group achieved record profit before tax of SGD 3.44 billion in first-quarter 2025, slightly higher than a year ago, as total income reached a new high from robust business growth. General allowances of SGD 205 million were taken as a prudent measure to strengthen GP reserves in light of recent developments that have added to macroeconomic and geopolitical uncertainty. Net profit was 2% lower at SGD 2.90 billion due to higher tax expenses from the implementation of the 15% global minimum tax.

Total income rose 6% to SGD 5.91 billion from balance sheet growth, record fee income and treasury customer sales driven by **wealth management**, as well as the strongest markets trading income in 12 quarters. The cost-income ratio was stable at 37%. Asset quality was resilient with the NPL ratio at 1.1% and specific allowances at 10 basis points of loans.

Compared to the previous quarter, net profit was 10% higher. Group net interest income rose 1% on a day-adjusted basis from balance sheet growth, while non-interest income grew 25% driven by higher fees, treasury customer sales and markets trading. Expenses fell 8% partly due to non-recurring items in the previous quarter while specific allowances halved.

The Board declared an ordinary dividend of SGD 60 cents per share and a Capital Return dividend of SGD 15 cents per share for the first quarter.

Quarter-on-quarter performance

Commercial book net interest income declined 1% on a day-adjusted basis to SGD 3.72 billion as a nine-basis-point decline in net interest margin to 2.68% from lower interest rates was mitigated by balance sheet growth.

Loans rose 2% or SGD 7 billion in constant-currency terms to SGD 435 billion. Non-trade corporate loans increased 3% or SGD 8 billion from broad-based growth across the region and a range of industries. Trade loans fell 1% or SGD 1 billion while housing and other consumer loans were stable.

Deposits rose 3% or SGD 18 billion to SGD 576 billion led by a 5% or SGD 13 billion increase in Casa. The Casa ratio improved to 53%.

Commercial book net fee income rose 32% to a record SGD 1.28 billion led by **wealth management** and loan-related fees. **Wealth management** fees increased 39% to a new high of SGD 724 million driven by higher sales of investment products and bancassurance from a constructive market environment and seasonal factors. Loan-related fees rose 79% to a record SGD 227 million with increased deal activity.

Commercial book other non-interest income of SGD 548 million was stable compared to the previous quarter, which included property disposal gains. Treasury customer sales rose 32% to a new high.

Markets trading income more than doubled to SGD 363 million as interest rate, FX and equity derivative activities benefited from market volatility and as funding costs fell.

Expenses of SGD 2.21 billion were 8% lower partly due to non-recurring items in the previous quarter.

Profit before allowances rose 19% to SGD 3.69 billion.

Year-on-year performance

Commercial book net interest income rose 2% as a nine-basis-point decline in net interest margin was more than offset by balance sheet growth. Loans grew 3% in constant-currency terms led by non-trade corporate loans, while deposits were 6% higher.

Net fee income increased 22% as **wealth management** fees grew 35% from strong market sentiment and higher assets under management, while loan-related fees rose 23% with increased activity.

Commercial book other non-interest income was 12% lower. The decline was driven by non-recurring items, while treasury customer sales grew 11% to a record.

Markets trading income increased 48%, partly reflecting lower funding costs.

Expenses rose 6% from higher staff costs. The cost-income ratio was stable at 37%.

Profit before allowances increased 6%.

Balance sheet

Asset quality remained resilient. Non-performing assets fell 3% from the previous quarter to SGD 4.86 billion as new non-performing asset formation was lower than in recent quarters while upgrades were higher. The NPL ratio was stable at 1.1%. Specific allowances were SGD 120 million or 10 basis points of loans. Given the recent escalation in macroeconomic and geopolitical uncertainty, general allowances of SGD 205 million were prudently taken to strengthen GP reserves to SGD 4.16 billion. Allowance coverage stood at 137% and at 230% after considering collateral.

Liquidity remained healthy. The liquidity coverage ratio of 145% and net stable funding ratio of 115% were both well above regulatory requirements.

The reported Common Equity Tier-1 ratio was 17.4% based on transitional arrangements, while the pro-forma ratio on a fully phased-in basis was 15.2%. The leverage ratio of 6.5% was more than twice the regulatory minimum of 3%.

DBS CEO Tan Su Shan said, "We had a strong start to the year with broad-based business growth led by **wealth management**, and ROE above 17% despite the impact of the global minimum tax. Recent escalations in trade tensions have heightened macroeconomic risks and market volatility. As uncertainty persists, we will stay nimble to capture opportunities while prudently managing risks. We have strengthened our general allowance reserves, and together with our strong capital and liquidity positions, we have a solid foundation to continue supporting customers."

About DBS

DBS is a leading financial services group in Asia with a presence in 19 markets. Headquartered and listed in Singapore, DBS is in the three key Asian axes of growth: Greater China, Southeast Asia and South Asia. The bank's "AA-" and "Aa1" credit ratings are among the highest in the world.

Recognised for its global leadership, DBS has been named "World's Best Bank" by Global Finance, "World's Best Bank" by Euromoney and "Global Bank of the Year" by The Banker. The bank is at the forefront of leveraging

digital technology to shape the future of banking, having been named “World’s Best Digital Bank” by Euromoney and the world’s “Most Innovative in Digital Banking” by The Banker. In addition, DBS has been accorded the “Safest Bank in Asia” award by Global Finance for 16 consecutive years from 2009 to 2024.

DBS provides a full range of services in consumer, SME and corporate banking. As a bank born and bred in Asia, DBS understands the intricacies of doing business in the region’s most dynamic markets.

DBS is committed to building lasting relationships with customers, as it banks the Asian way. Through the DBS Foundation, the bank creates impact beyond banking by supporting businesses for impact: enterprises with a double bottom-line of profit and social and/or environmental impact. DBS Foundation also gives back to society in various ways, including equipping underserved communities with future-ready skills and helping them to build food resilience.

With its extensive network of operations in Asia and emphasis on engaging and empowering its staff, DBS presents exciting career opportunities. For more information, please visit www.dbs.com.

Source: DBS Bank Ltd

[Category: Financial Results]

Document ATINBK0020250508e1580005n

Exclusive: Three UOB PB bankers to join BNP Paribas

Priyanka Boghani

155 words

7 May 2025

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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Three UOB **Private Bank** relationship managers will join BNP Paribas **Wealth Management**, following their former Malaysia market head, Citywire Asia has learnt.

Warren Tang, Daniel Lye and Ze Wei Tay will move to the French **private bank** to cover the Malaysia market, where Sean Tay is [slated](#) to join and report to Garth Bregman, head of **wealth management** Singapore and Southeast Asia.

A spokesperson from BNP Paribas declined to comment on the hires.

Lye joined UOB in 2020, while Ze Wei Tay moved to the Singaporean **private bank** in 2022. Tay also worked at HSBC, Indosuez **Wealth Management** and CIC as a relationship manager based in Singapore.

The hires come after Singapore-based Alison Lim left BNP Paribas WM, following five years at the French bank. In a management reshuffle, Lim was named market head Southeast Asia, expanding her role to focus on the SEA markets.

Document CWIRAS0020250507e1570002u



Business

StanChart beats forecasts with 13% rise in net profit

Enoch Yiu

557 words

3 May 2025

South China Morning Post

SCMP

B1

English

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Bank remains confident as CEO attributes strong performance to focus on **wealth management**

Standard Chartered's first-quarter profit beat expectations, as the bank placed a greater focus on **wealth management** in the face of lower interest rates and rising bad-debt provisions.

Net profit rose by 13 per cent in the first three months of 2025 to US\$1.59 billion from US\$1.4 billion a year earlier, the bank said yesterday. Analysts expected a profit of US\$1.12 billion, according to a consensus estimate from Bloomberg.

Pre-tax underlying profit grew by 7 per cent to US\$2.28 billion from US\$2.13 billion, beating the consensus estimate of US\$1.9 billion.

"We delivered a strong performance in the first quarter of 2025, with earnings per share up by 19 per cent, driven by double-digit income growth in wealth solutions, global markets and global banking," CEO Bill Winters said in an earnings statement to the Hong Kong stock exchange.

"The subsequent imposition of trade tariffs has increased global economic and geopolitical complexity, and we remain watchful of the external environment. But our ability to help clients manage their business and wealth across borders in times of volatility reinforces our confidence that we can continue to improve returns."

In March, Winters told the Post that Hong Kong would be the focus of Standard Chartered's US\$1.5 billion investment in its **wealth management** business over the next five years.

Shares in the bank added 0.7 per cent to close at HK\$113.60 yesterday after rising by as much as 4 per cent. They have advanced by 19 per cent this year, outpacing the Hang Seng Index's 10.6 per cent gain.

The London-based bank, which generates most of its business in Hong Kong and other markets in Asia, as well as the Middle East and Africa, said its **wealth management** revenue rose by 28 per cent to US\$777 million. Assets under management for affluent clients grew by 6 per cent to US\$389 billion.

"We collected a lot of net new money from the world's fast-growing regions, [where] Hong Kong, Singapore and Dubai were the clear stand-outs," group chief financial officer Diego De Giorgi said.

Capital inflows continued last month even after the market turmoil unleashed by the global tariffs imposed by the United States, he said.

"The market environment is more uncertain and some customers may be more defensive in the allocation of those investments, but they are investing for the long term," he said.

Standard Chartered's net interest income in the first quarter rose by 7 per cent to US\$2.8 billion from a year earlier. Its net interest margin widened by 18 basis points to 2.12 per cent, thanks to cuts in interest rates.

The bank recorded credit impairment charges of US\$219 million during the quarter, up by 24 per cent from a year earlier, including US\$23 million in provisions for economic uncertainties arising from the US tariffs.

Standard Chartered had booked substantial provisions related to China's commercial property lending over the past few years, but that exposure had been reduced to US\$8 million, it said.

enoch.yiu@scmp.com

Document SCMP000020250502e1530000h

Standard Chartered's profits rise 10% as **wealth management** business booms

Arjun Neil Alim, Asia Financial Correspondent

558 words

2 May 2025

14:47

Financial Times (FT.Com)

FTCMA

English

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Chief executive Bill Winters says bank remains 'watchful' on impact of US tariffs

Standard Chartered increased profits in the first quarter on the back of higher **wealth management** income, although the bank warned about the coming impact of US President Donald Trump's trade war.

The Asia-focused lender reported pre-tax profits of \$2.1bn for the first three months of 2025, 10 per cent higher than the same period a year earlier and beating analyst forecasts that profits would be flat.

StanChart's return on tangible equity — a measure of profitability — increased by 1.3 percentage points to 14.8 per cent.

But Bill Winters, group chief executive and the longest-serving UK banking chief, warned the impact of US trade tariffs on clients was still ahead.

"Imposition of trade tariffs has increased global economic and geopolitical complexity, and we remain watchful of the external environment," he said in a statement on Friday.

The bank increased its risk-management probability of an intensified global trade war from 10 to 15 per cent — a scenario that it models would result in five years of below 1 per cent average annual GDP growth for the US and China — and raised its credit provisioning for such a scenario by \$23mn to \$66mn.

"The current state of uncertainty [comes] after decades of globalisation, after decades of economies getting more and more intertwined," said Diego De Giorgi, group chief financial officer.

"The ultimate result might very well be a more complex and more fragmented world, but it cannot be a world where the shutters come down between every country," he cautioned.

Underlying net interest income, which the bank tweaked to include income from foreign exchange swaps, increased in the first three months by 7 per cent year on year to \$2.8bn at constant exchange rates.

The other key driver of increased income at the bank was its **wealth management** division, which boosted operating income by 28 per cent on a constant currency basis, as customers piled into cross-border investment products and bancassurance.

"Our ability to help clients manage their business and wealth across borders in times of volatility reinforces our confidence that we can continue to improve returns," said Winters.

Last year, StanChart said it planned to double investment in its **wealth management** business, shifting its focus towards affluent individuals and global institutions and away from smaller domestic businesses and retail clients.

De Giorgi said the bank was targeting affluent expatriates and wealthy individuals, including "global Indians and global Chinese". He added that clients of its **wealth management** business had turned towards "more defensive" investment products in April as the US imposed sweeping tariffs on the rest of the world.

He said he was "optimistic" about the Chinese real estate market and Hong Kong following stimulus measures taken by Beijing. StanChart maintains a credit overlay of \$73mn for its exposure to Chinese commercial real estate and \$47mn for clients with exposure to the Hong Kong sector.

"The continued effort by the Chinese authorities to stimulate the economy, an effort that is likely to continue and increase...both on the monetary and increasingly on the fiscal side, will continue to support the Hong Kong economy," said De Giorgi.

Additional reporting by Ortenca Aliaj in London

Document FTCMA00020250502e15200105

HSBC rakes in \$16bn of net new invested assets in Asia

Cheryl Heng

348 words

29 April 2025

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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HSBC reported \$22bn of net new invested assets for the first quarter this year, of which Asia contributed \$16bn. This brought Asia's total invested assets to \$676bn, up 4.8% year-on-year.

Its quarterly net inflows were lower compared to the first quarter of last year, where it raked in \$27bn, including Asia's \$19bn.

Despite lower inflows on annual basis, wealth fee and other income jumped 23% to \$2.3bn, driven by robust client activity in Asia, particularly Hong Kong, according to its 1Q25 earnings. **Private banking** and investment distribution grew over 30%, with the former fueled by increased brokerage, trading, and annuity fees.

The insurance CSM balance, reflecting future policy profits, also showed strong performance.

'We have assessed plausible downside scenarios that model significantly higher tariffs, and related impacts on growth, policy rates and inflation on our earnings,' the bank said in its earnings report.

It added: 'We anticipate a low single-digit percentage direct impact on the group's revenue and around \$0.5bn in incremental expected credit losses.'

Tommy Leung, HSBC's head of global **private banking**, South Asia, [had said](#) that wealthy Asian clients are 'reassessing' their US dollar holdings, with some hedging currency exposure.

The bank's group-wide profit before tax dropped to \$9.5bn from \$12.7bn, impacted by one-time charges from disposals in Canada and Argentina.

HSBC plans to reduce its stake in Bank of Communications from 19.03% to 16%, expecting a \$1.6bn loss, and announced a \$3bn share buyback.

The bank has set medium-term targets to grow fee and other income in wealth at a double-digit percentage annual growth.

Its wealth business comprises its investment distribution, insurance, global **private banking** and asset management business.

HSBC is simplifying operations to achieve \$1.5 bn in annual cost savings by 2026, with wealth business expansion in Asia as a core growth strategy.

In March, the bank confirmed [Kanas Chan](#) as head of global **private banking** for North Asia and Hong Kong.

Document CWIRAS0020250429e14t0002t

Exclusive: StanChart PB's Asean market head departs

Priyanka Boghani

189 words

21 April 2025

Citywire Middle East

CWIRME

English

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Standard Chartered **Private Bank's private banking** market head for the Asean region which includes, Singapore, Malaysia and the Global South Asia diaspora, has left the bank, Citywire Asia can reveal.

Vijai Krovvidi has exited the British lender, where he worked in Singapore overseeing various teams for almost three years.

A spokesperson from the bank confirmed his departure.

Krovvidi's role was changed during a reshuffle of the bank's non-resident Indian (NRI) teams last year that saw its **private banking** head of global South Asian community, Ravi Ramakrishnan, move to the Middle East. The changes also involved him absorbing Andrew Ho and Lawrence Goh's roles as Southeast Asia market heads. [Ramakrishnan](#) has now joined EFG, while Goh is at UBP.

Prior to Standard Chartered, Krovvidi spent more than a decade at UBS Global Wealth Management. He was also at Deutsche Bank for two years before that.

There have been a string of market and group head departures, as **private banking bonuses** reveal that some bankers were on the receiving end of more bleak payouts than others.

Document CWIRME0020250421el4I00001

Business Times Breaking News

International

Play ball: Rising valuations and private equity inflows signal a new era in sports investment

Isabelle Chong

1,387 words

21 April 2025

Business Times Singapore

STBT

English

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Standard Chartered and DBS **Private Bank** have launched funds in the sports market for wealthy clients

[SINGAPORE] What do Singapore's remisier king Peter Lim, Malaysia's Berjaya Corp founder Vincent Tan and Thailand's former prime minister Thaksin Shinawatra have in common? They are part of an elite circle of ultra-rich who own or have owned top-flight football clubs.

More are expected to join their ranks. Industry watchers said interest in sports investing is growing, as major sports leagues and teams seek alternative capital financing options.

Standard Chartered (Stanchart) on Apr 14 introduced a new alternative fund focused on sports for ultra-high-net-worth and high-net-worth clients of its Global **Private Bank**.

This was spurred by "strong growing interest" from clients in alternative asset classes such as sports investing, said Samir Subberwal, the bank's global head of wealth solutions as well as deposits and mortgages.

"It is therefore timely to leverage the strong expertise of leading global fund managers to connect our high-net-worth clients to professionally managed solutions that provide access to hard-to-access opportunities," said Subberwal, who is also Stanchart's chief client officer.

Stanchart noted that the media industry has grown 16 to 17 per cent in media contract value in the last 10 years, with major sports leagues around the world signing record-breaking broadcasting deals. And the steady revenue generating model in sports has been gaining the interest of private investors.

Recent high-profile sports-related transactions among leading family offices have also highlighted sports investing as an alternative asset class for those looking to strengthen and diversify their portfolios.

The Business Times understands that DBS **Private Bank** launched a sports, media and entertainment fund for wealth clients on Apr 10.

Industry watchers said football clubs are no longer viewed solely as prestige assets – they are now part of complex investment strategies aimed at capturing value through media rights, sponsorships, global fan monetisation, and capital appreciation.

The investment boom

A DBS study noted that the global sports industry – currently valued at US\$463 billion – is expected to expand at a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 7 per cent to reach some US\$862 billion by 2033. Football makes up a small slice of this pie. But in the US – one of the largest sports markets – it has been growing quickly.

Major League Soccer – America's football league – grew at a CAGR of 17.1 per cent between 2018 and 2022. This outpaced growth of its National Football League (15.3 per cent), National Basketball Association (12.6 per cent), National Hockey League (9.1 per cent), and Major League Baseball (8.6 per cent).

Meanwhile, a Deloitte report revealed that football led all other sports in terms of investment by deal volume, accounting for half of total transactions. Industry analysts attributed the increased investor interest to rising club valuations and expanding global audiences.

Mergers and acquisitions (M&As) – which involve transferring ownership of a club to another party, often resulting in substantial changes in a team's strategy, financial structure and operational model – continue to lead the sports industry in terms of activity this year, said James Walton, Deloitte's sports business group leader for Asia-Pacific and South-east Asia.

The momentum follows a record-breaking 2024, during which M&A deals increased 44 per cent – largely fuelled by private equity inflows, enhanced fan engagement and the emergence of sports technology, Walton added.

High-profile transactions such as the US\$3.3 billion World Wrestling Entertainment-Ultimate Fighting Championship merger, and the significant stake sales in The Hundred cricket league franchises exemplify this trend.

Stadium financing is another key growth area, with significant capital deployed across North America, Europe and the Asia-Pacific. Notable deals include Everton's £350 million (S\$610 million) stadium financing deal, Walton noted.

The inflexion point of the financial landscape reached in 2024 signals a "new era" for sustainable growth, said Albert Yang, JPMorgan **Private Bank**'s Asia head of alternative investments.

He noted that private equity funds and institutional investors play a significant role in the financial landscape of sports, which is poised for sustainable growth.

Investor appetite is being fuelled by structural tailwinds: football's resilience in economic downturns; rising media and sponsorship revenues; limited supply of elite assets; and a growing population of ultra-high-net-worth individuals; said Ivo Voynov, Citi **Private Bank**'s global head of sports financing.

Real estate linked to clubs – such as stadiums and surrounding infrastructure – is also becoming a valuable lever for returns.

"There is a belief that with sophisticated institutional investment, the sector will ultimately become more disciplined in its approach to player transfers and salaries, which, as the revenues continue to grow, will result in more teams being profitable," Voynov said.

Market drivers

Voynov noted that valuations of football teams have increased significantly over the past decade, with investors drawn to the massive global audience of the game.

Deloitte attributed this surge to a number of core financial fundamentals – which include the rising value of media rights; growth in commercial partnerships; brand strength; team performance; and the size and loyalty of the fan base.

The sector's upside potential is further bolstered by the expansion of the global sports market – especially with the evolution of digital platforms and streaming services. These platforms have significantly broadened teams' international exposure and created more opportunities for revenue generation, Walton said.

Private equity interest has further amplified valuations, with many firms seeing sports assets as a hedge against traditional market cycles.

"One appealing aspect of investing in sports for private equity is the potential for uncorrelated returns. Unlike traditional investments that are heavily dependent on market performance, sports investments offer diversification into a new asset class and may shield investors from market volatility," he said.

DBS' chief investment office noted that sports investments, once seen as trophy assets, are increasingly regarded as legitimate opportunities for long-term financial gain. This is in part due to the highly limited supply of franchises, especially in the US, where only 153 teams exist across the five major leagues due to stringent expansion criteria.

"This scarcity factor enhances the desirability of franchises, making them coveted assets and driving up their value," DBS said.

Deloitte's Walton added that a surge in football investments in 2021 and 2022 was largely due to the financial impact of the pandemic, including historically low interest rates and distressed clubs being put up for sale.

However, the landscape has changed. With fewer attractively priced clubs available and many investors focused on building value within their existing portfolios, opportunities are becoming more limited. Owners' exit prices have also become increasingly unrealistic, making acquisitions more challenging, Walton said.

This has prompted a growing interest in minority stake deals, Walton said. As top-tier valuations rise, many investors are choosing to acquire smaller equity positions as an entry point into the market.

Examples include minority investments in prominent clubs such as Manchester United and Paris Saint-Germain.

Another area gaining inflow traction is women's football, which is seen as having "significant growth potential", Walton noted.

Pointing to other trends, Walton noted that there has been an increase in investment interest especially from private and sovereign-wealth investors, which has brought about substantial growth in valuations of major sports properties.

Major League Soccer has seen a 1,565 per cent increase in valuation over the last decade, which has significantly "outpaced" the S&P 500, the sports analyst added.

"Sports offer investors a way to diversify and build more resilient portfolios with long-term capital gain potential while offering stable returns from recurring revenue streams," Walton said. "Many investors in this class also recognise the intangible value from owning a high-profile sports property."

Deloitte anticipates that the market could see a first wave of private equity exits this year.

"This marks a critical juncture in the evolving sports investment landscape," Walton said, warning that investors will have to evaluate the returns achieved by early market participants and consider their own investment thesis and exit strategies. "This could potentially shape future ownership structures and influence how new capital is deployed in the sector."

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Business

HSBC to offer anti-ageing treatments, medical check-ups at Hong Kong wealth centre

Enoch Yiu

687 words

16 April 2025

scmp.com

SCMCOM

English

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The wealth centre, which will open in the second half, is aimed at the growing silver economy, HSBC Life's Daisy Tsang says

HSBC, the largest lender in Hong Kong, will open a wealth centre in the second half of this year as planned, undeterred by the ongoing market turmoil triggered by the US-China trade war.

The wealth centre, which will also serve as a paramedical centre, will provide anti-ageing treatments, medical check-ups, as well as insurance, **wealth management** and vaccination services, as part of its strategy to tap the growing "silver economy".

"We take a long-term view of our investments [and] are not worried about short-term market volatility," Daisy Tsang, CEO for Hong Kong and Macau at HSBC Life, said in an exclusive interview with the Post on Monday. "We strongly believe in Hong Kong's potential as a hub for wealthy customers from mainland China and beyond to manage their wealth, insurance, retirement and legacy planning."

Do you have questions about the biggest topics and trends from around the world? Get the answers with [SCMP Knowledge](#), our new platform of curated content with explainers, FAQs, analyses and infographics brought to you by our award-winning team.

The new centre, the insurer's third, will be located in the heart of the city to make it convenient for visitors from the mainland and local residents living in the Greater Bay Area, she added.

HSBC Life opened its first **wealth management** centre in Hong Kong at K11 Musea in October 2021 followed by Hysan Place in February 2022. The demand for services at these two centres has been strong, Tsang said, pointing out that the number of clients using these centres more than doubled year on year in 2024.

Tsang said the new centre will offer hyperbaric oxygen therapy, which can heal damaged tissue by helping the body grow new skin, blood vessels and connective tissue.

The therapy involves delivering oxygen in a pressurised chamber at two to three times normal air pressure, helping lungs absorb more oxygen to accelerate tissue repair and fight infections.

"With ageing populations in both Hong Kong and China, we believe there will be strong demand from our customers for anti-ageing and other longevity treatment programmes," she said.

People aged 65 and above accounted for 22 per cent of the city's 7.5 million residents last year, according to government data. Life expectancy in 2023 was 88.1 years for women and 82.5 for men in 2023, up from 75.3 and 67.8 years, respectively, in 1971.

In February, HSBC group CEO Georges Elhedery said he would redirect US\$1.5 billion from "low-return" markets to high growth areas like Hong Kong, mainland China, Singapore and India, with **wealth management** as a priority.

Tsang said HSBC Life would also partner with hundreds of mainland hospitals and clinics to offer medical services to Hong Kong residents retiring in the Greater Bay Area, enabling treatment on the mainland with bills settled directly by the insurer.

An HSBC survey late last year found one in three Hong Kong residents wished to retire outside Hong Kong. The study, which polled 1,000 respondents, showed 65 per cent preferred Greater Bay Area cities, 15 per cent other mainland cities, 13 per cent the UK and 10 per cent Australia.

About 88,000 Hong Kong residents aged 65 or above were living in the Greater Bay Area – nine cities in Guangdong province and Macau and Hong Kong – at the end of 2022, an increase of about 11 per cent compared with five years earlier, according to Hong Kong government statistics.

Tsang said the challenge for HSBC Life was to develop **wealth management** services that stand out from its competition.

The company's rivals, such as AIA, Manulife, BOC Life, Prudential and Sun Life, also have their eyes on high-net-worth individuals.

"HSBC has a global network and a history of 160 years," Tsang said. "We have the trust of our customers."

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Singapore - Banks - Competitive Landscape

3,357 words

10 April 2025

MarketLine Industry Profiles

DMRP

English

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The Singaporean banking industry consists of four top performers: DBS Group, Oversea-Chinese Banking (OCBC), Standard Chartered Bank Singapore (SCBS), and United Overseas Bank (UOB). All the main players are based in Singapore, indicating the strong presence of Singaporean banks in the industry. There is not much differentiation in the industry, as all the main players offer similar financial products to consumers and operate with similar strategies. The only way a player could get a competitive edge over their peers is if that player was involved in a government project or financed a low-risk endeavor.

Who are the leading players?

DBS Group Holdings Ltd (DBS)

DBS, through its principal subsidiary, DBS Bank, is the largest bank in Singapore, with a market share of 37.1% in 2024. The bank is based in Singapore and offers consumer, corporate, and SME banking and other financial solutions. It also provides cash management, **wealth management**, and capital markets solutions. DBS classifies its operations into four segments: Institutional Banking, Consumer Banking/ **Wealth Management**, Treasury Markets, and Others. As of December 31, 2023, it had assets of SGD739.3 billion (\$553.3 billion).

United Overseas Bank Ltd (UOB)

UOB is the second-largest bank in Singapore, with a market share of 21.7% in 2024. The bank is based in Singapore and provides personal, commercial, business, private, and investment banking solutions. It also offers corporate finance, asset management, insurance, treasury, capital markets, venture capital management, and stock broking services. UOB classifies its operations into four segments: Group Retail (GR), Group Wholesale Banking (GWB), Others, and Global Markets (GM). As of December 31, 2023, it had assets of SGD523,520 million (\$391.8 billion).

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp Ltd (OCBC)

OCBC is the third-largest bank in Singapore, with a market share of 18.5% in 2024. The bank is based in Singapore and is a provider of consumer, corporate, investment, private, and transaction banking, as well as global treasury and stockbroking services. It also carries out insurance and asset management business activities through its subsidiaries. OCBC classifies its operations into five segments: global consumer and **private banking** (GCPB), global wholesale banking (GWB), insurance, global Treasury and markets (GTM), and others. As of December 31, 2023, OCBC operated through more than 420 branches and representative offices in Brunei, Myanmar, the Philippines, Thailand, Vietnam, Japan, South Korea, Taiwan, the US, Indonesia, Australia, the UK, the UAE, and Luxembourg. As of December 31, 2023, it had assets of SGD581,424 million (\$435.1 billion).

Standard Chartered Bank (Singapore) Ltd, (SCBS)

SCBS, a subsidiary of Standard Chartered, is the fourth-largest bank in Singapore, with a 7.5% market share in 2023. The bank is based in Singapore and is an international banking group that provides personal, business, private, SME, wholesale, Islamic, online, and investment banking services to personal and business customers globally. Standard Chartered classifies its business operations into four segments: Corporate, Commercial & Institutional Banking, Consumer Private & Business Banking, Central & other items, and Ventures.

What are the strategies of the leading players?

DBS is focused on leveraging megatrends such as Asia's strong growth, rising intra-regional trade, rapid technological advancements, and the shift toward sustainability. The company aims to support trade and capital flows and foster wealth creation in Asia, with a growing presence in Greater China, South Asia, and Southeast

Asia. The company's strategy includes strengthening technology resilience, enhancing risk management capabilities, and streamlining processes across all markets. DBS also plans to improve climate risk management and stress testing and mitigate financial crime and cyber threats. To achieve its targets, DBS is adopting both organic and inorganic strategies, expanding its full-service banking capabilities in Singapore, Hong Kong, India, and Taiwan.

OCBC has developed a three-year strategy aimed at driving growth and reinforcing its core strengths. The bank's strategy focuses on capturing regional trade, investments, and wealth flows. The major goals and plans under this strategy include capturing rising Asian wealth through its Singapore- Hong Kong hubs and digital propositions, supporting increasing ASEAN- Greater China trade and investment flows, unlocking value from the new economy and high-growth industries, and contributing to the transition to a sustainable low-carbon world. To achieve these targets, OCBC is adopting a combination of organic and inorganic strategies. The bank plans to deepen its **wealth management** capabilities to enhance its competitive position in the market.

UOB is focused on building the future of ASEAN for both individuals and businesses within the region, as well as those connecting with ASEAN. Guided by its values and supported by its fundamental strengths, the group aims to support its customers while driving performance across its franchise. UOB's approach to customer support is built on a long-term perspective, maintaining a prudent and disciplined approach to balancing growth with responsibility. The major goals and plans outlined under UOB's strategies include creating personalized financial solutions for individuals and businesses, helping them achieve their financial goals through an omnichannel approach. The group also seeks to enable customers to grow sustainably by integrating sustainability into its business operations, driving responsible growth that has a positive and meaningful impact on the economy, society, and environment. Additionally, UOB plans to connect its customers across ASEAN, China, and the rest of the world through sector specialization, ecosystem partnerships, and an integrated digital platform, utilizing a One Bank approach.

What have been the recent M&A activities?

In August 2024, DBS partnered with Visa and launched the BAC+ debit card to support businesses. This partnership enables DBS to strengthen its offerings for businesses in Southeast Asia. By providing innovative financial solutions that facilitate cross-border transactions and cash flow management, DBS enhances its value proposition, fostering long-term customer relationships and expanding its market presence.

In February 2024, Singapore-based fintech start-up Xalts acquired Contour Network, a digital trade finance platform launched in 2020 by leading banks like ANZ, BNP Paribas, HSBC, and Standard Chartered. Contour was comprised of 21 banks and various partners from various industries. Xalts plans to focus on embedded trade and supply chain finance solutions, enabling banks, logistics, and technology companies to offer integrated solutions on one platform. The acquisition follows Contour's suspension of operations in October 2023 due to insufficient funding.

In January 2024, OCBC introduced a money lock feature that allows customers to disable digital access to their deposit accounts. The bank's extension of money lock to time deposits enhances digital security by safeguarding funds from unauthorized access due to scams. This proactive measure boosts customer confidence, promotes secure financial practices, and aligns with OCBC's commitment to protecting client assets.

This section contains brief overviews of the leading companies in the Singaporean banks industry.

Company

Company Name: DBS Group Holdings Ltd

DBS Group Holdings Ltd (DBS), through its principal subsidiary, DBS Bank Ltd (DBS Bank), offers a range of banking and financial solutions that include current, savings, multi-currency, and business accounts; debit and credit cards; fixed deposits; and loans for home, personal, business, car, education, working capital, and business property purchase. DBS offers supply chain, equipment, secured lending, and venture debt-financing solutions. It provides insurance coverage for life, health, travel, car, accident, education, and business. The company also offers **wealth management**, treasury products, cash management, trade finance, **private banking**, institutional banking, online banking, and advisory and capital markets solutions. Its priority markets are India, China, Taiwan, Malaysia, Indonesia, Singapore, and Hong Kong. DBS is headquartered in Singapore.

The bank reported interest income of (Singapore Dollars) SGD30,927 million for the fiscal year ended December 2024 (FY2024), an increase of 11% over FY2023. In FY2024, the bank's operating margin was 54.4%, compared

to an operating margin of 51.3% in FY2023. In FY2024, the bank recorded a net margin of 28.1%, compared to a net margin of 27.5% in FY2023.

Head office: 12 Marina Boulevard Marina Bay Financial Centre Tower 3, Singapore, Singapore

Telephone: 6568788888

Fax: 6564451267

Number of Employees: 41000

Website: www.dbs.com/investors/fixed-income/overview

Financial Year End: December

Ticker: D05

Stock Exchange: Singapore Exchange Securities Trading

Company Overview

DBS Group Holdings Ltd (DBS), through its principal subsidiary, DBS Bank Ltd (DBS Bank), offers a range of banking and financial solutions that include current, savings, multi-currency, and business accounts; debit and credit cards; fixed deposits; and loans for home, personal, business, car, education, working capital, and business property purchase. DBS offers supply chain, equipment, secured lending, and venture debt-financing solutions. It provides insurance coverage for life, health, travel, car, accident, education, and business. The company also offers **wealth management**, treasury products, cash management, trade finance, **private banking**, institutional banking, online banking, and advisory and capital markets solutions. Its priority markets are India, China, Taiwan, Malaysia, Indonesia, Singapore, and Hong Kong. DBS is headquartered in Singapore. The bank reported interest income of (Singapore Dollars) SGD30,927 million for the fiscal year ended December 2024 (FY2024), an increase of 11% over FY2023. In FY2024, the bank's operating margin was 54.4%, compared to an operating margin of 51.3% in FY2023. In FY2024, the bank recorded a net margin of 28.1%, compared to a net margin of 27.5% in FY2023.

Business Description

DBS Group Holdings Ltd (DBS) offers consumer, corporate, and SME banking, and other financial solutions. It also provides cash management, **wealth management**, and capital markets solutions.

As of December 31, 2023, it had assets of SGD739.3 billion, deposits of SGD535.1 billion, and loans and advances to customers of SGD416.2 billion.

DBS classifies its operations into four segments: Institutional Banking, Consumer Banking/ **Wealth Management**, Treasury Markets, and Others.

Company

Company Name: Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp Ltd

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp Ltd (OCBC), is a financial services group that offers a wide range of banking services. The bank's main activities include banking, **wealth management**, insurance, and consumer banking. OCBC provides products and services such as unit trusts, bancassurance products such as accident & health, travel, car, and home insurance; advisory services, structured deposits, consumer loans, securities trading, **private banking**, and digital banking services. The bank serves a diverse customer base, including individuals, large corporates, financial institutions, government agencies, and SMEs. It has a presence in Brunei, Myanmar, the Philippines, Thailand, Vietnam, Japan, South Korea, Taiwan, the US, Indonesia, Australia, the UK, the UAE, and Luxembourg. OCBC is headquartered in Singapore.

The bank reported interest income of (Singapore Dollars) SGD22,444 million for the fiscal year ended December 2024 (FY2024), an increase of 7.6% over FY2023. In FY2024, the bank's operating margin was 42.4%, compared to an operating margin of 42.7% in FY2023. In FY2024, the bank recorded a net margin of 22.4%, compared to a net margin of 22.7% in FY2023.

Head office: 65 Chulia Street #29-08 Ocbc Centre, Singapore, Singapore

Telephone: 6565301513

Fax: 6565304438

Number of Employees: 33656

Website: www.ocbc.com

Financial Year End: December

Ticker: O39

Stock Exchange: Singapore Exchange Securities Trading

Company Overview

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp Ltd (OCBC), is a financial services group that offers a wide range of banking services. The bank's main activities include banking, **wealth management**, insurance, and consumer banking. OCBC provides products and services such as unit trusts, bancassurance products such as accident & health, travel, car, and home insurance; advisory services, structured deposits, consumer loans, securities trading, **private banking**, and digital banking services. The bank serves a diverse customer base, including individuals, large corporates, financial institutions, government agencies, and SMEs. It has a presence in Brunei, Myanmar, the Philippines, Thailand, Vietnam, Japan, South Korea, Taiwan, the US, Indonesia, Australia, the UK, the UAE, and Luxembourg. OCBC is headquartered in Singapore. The bank reported interest income of (Singapore Dollars) SGD22,444 million for the fiscal year ended December 2024 (FY2024), an increase of 7.6% over FY2023. In FY2024, the bank's operating margin was 42.4%, compared to an operating margin of 42.7% in FY2023. In FY2024, the bank recorded a net margin of 22.4%, compared to a net margin of 22.7% in FY2023.

Business Description

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp Ltd (OCBC), along with its subsidiaries, is a provider of consumer, corporate, investment, private, and transaction banking; and global treasury and stockbroking services. It also carries out insurance and asset management business activities through its subsidiaries. As of December 31, 2023, it had assets of SGD581,424 million, loans to customers of SGD292,754 million, and deposits of SGD363,770 million.

OCBC classifies its operations into five segments: Global Consumer/**Private Banking**, Global Wholesale Banking, Insurance, Global Markets, and Others.

As of December 31, 2023, OCBC operated through more than 420 branches and representative offices in Brunei, Myanmar, the Philippines, Thailand, Vietnam, Japan, South Korea, Taiwan, the US, Indonesia, Australia, the UK, the UAE, and Luxembourg.

Company

Company Name: United Overseas Bank Ltd

United Overseas Bank Ltd (UOB) provides banking and other financial-related services. The group's primary activities include retail banking, wholesale banking, and global markets operations. The group offers trade finance, corporate finance, financial supply chain management, savings bonds, cash management, treasury management, and debt and equity capital market solutions. UOB provides various other services such as asset management, **wealth management**, venture management, advisory, **private banking**, transaction banking, mobile banking, online banking, and internet banking services. The group serves individual customers, small, medium, and large enterprises, local and multinational corporations, financial institutions, government-linked entities, financial sponsors, and property funds. It has a presence in Brunei, Hong Kong, India, Indonesia, Japan, China, Malaysia, Australia, Canada, France, the UK, the US, Myanmar, the Philippines, South Korea, Taiwan, Thailand, and Vietnam. UOB is headquartered in Singapore.

The bank reported interest income of (Singapore Dollars) SGD23,259 million for the fiscal year ended December 2024 (FY2024), an increase of 4.6% over FY2023. In FY2024, the bank's operating margin was 49.6%, compared to an operating margin of 46.9% in FY2023. In FY2024, the bank recorded a net margin of 21.6%, compared to a net margin of 21% in FY2023.

Head office: 80 Raffles Place Uob Plaza, Singapore, Singapore

Telephone: 6562222121

Fax: 6565367712

Number of Employees: 32071

Website: www.uobgroup.com

Financial Year End: December

Ticker: U11

Stock Exchange: Singapore Exchange Securities Trading

Company Overview

United Overseas Bank Ltd (UOB) provides banking and other financial-related services. The group's primary activities include retail banking, wholesale banking, and global markets operations. The group offers trade finance, corporate finance, financial supply chain management, savings bonds, cash management, treasury management, and debt and equity capital market solutions. UOB provides various other services such as asset management, **wealth management**, venture management, advisory, **private banking**, transaction banking, mobile banking, online banking, and internet banking services. The group serves individual customers, small, medium, and large enterprises, local and multinational corporations, financial institutions, government-linked entities, financial sponsors, and property funds. It has a presence in Brunei, Hong Kong, India, Indonesia, Japan, China, Malaysia, Australia, Canada, France, the UK, the US, Myanmar, the Philippines, South Korea, Taiwan, Thailand, and Vietnam. In UOB is headquartered in Singapore. The bank reported interest income of (Singapore Dollars) SGD23,259 million for the fiscal year ended December 2024 (FY2024), an increase of 4.6% over FY2023. In FY2024, the bank's operating margin was 49.6%, compared to an operating margin of 46.9% in FY2023. In FY2024, the bank recorded a net margin of 21.6%, compared to a net margin of 21% in FY2023.

Business Description

United Overseas Bank Ltd (UOB) provides personal, commercial, business, private, and investment banking solutions. It also offers corporate finance, asset management, insurance, treasury, capital markets, venture capital management, and stock broking services. As of December 31, 2023, it had assets of SGD523,520 million, total deposits of SGD385,469 million, and loans to customers of SGD317,005 million.

UOB classifies its operations into four segments: Group Retail (GR), Group Wholesale Banking (GWB), Others, and Global Markets (GM).

As of December 31, 2023, it had a network of over 500 branches and offices, and more than 1.1 million ATMs in 19 countries and territories in Europe, North America, and the Asia Pacific.

Company

Company Name: Standard Chartered Bank (Singapore) Ltd

Standard Chartered Bank (Singapore) Ltd, (SCBS) a subsidiary of Standard Chartered PLC, is a financial services provider that offers banking services. The bank provides deposit-taking, **wealth management** services, overdrafts, credit cards, auto financing, personal loans, mortgages and others. SCBS offers trade finance, lending, foreign exchange, cash management, securities services, debt capital markets and corporate finance to corporate and institutional clients. The company also provides **private banking** services through its **private banking** division. It serves corporate and retail customers, individuals, and small and medium-sized enterprises. SCBS operates through a network of branches, banking centers and ATM centers. SCBS is headquartered in Singapore City, Singapore.

Head office: 9 Changi Business Park Cres #05-01 Singapore City, Singapore

Website: www.sc.com/sg

Financial Year End: December

Company Overview

Standard Chartered Bank (Singapore) Ltd, (SCBS) a subsidiary of Standard Chartered PLC, is a financial services provider that offers banking services. The bank provides deposit-taking, **wealth management** services, overdrafts, credit cards, auto financing, personal loans, mortgages and others. SCBS offers trade finance, lending, foreign exchange, cash management, securities services, debt capital markets and corporate finance to corporate and institutional clients. The company also provides **private banking** services through its **private banking** division. It serves corporate and retail customers, individuals, and small and medium-sized enterprises. SCBS operates through a network of branches, banking centers and ATM centers. SCBS is headquartered in Singapore City, Singapore.

Market Definition

Banking industry involves the activities of banks and similar institutions that offer financial services such as savings, loans, mortgages, and related services to businesses and consumers. Market value represents the total assets held by banks or related institutions in a country in a year. The market share represents the total asset held by the companies in the specific year. Geographical segmentation measures the total assets held by commercial banks of a particular region.

The market is segmented into bank credit, inter-bank loans, cash assets, trading assets, and others. The scope of others includes investments, loans receivable, and fixed assets. Bank credit refers to funds that a bank lends to individuals, businesses, or other entities. Inter-bank loans are loans made between banks. These loans serve as a mechanism for banks to manage their short-term liquidity needs and meet regulatory requirements. Cash asset products of banks provide customers with a secure and convenient way to manage their cash holdings while earning potential returns on their funds. Customers can choose from a variety of products based on their financial goals, risk tolerance, and liquidity needs. Bank trading assets refer to financial instruments and securities that banks hold primarily for trading to generate profits. These assets are actively bought and sold within the bank's trading desk or investment division to capitalize on short-term price fluctuations, market trends, or arbitrage opportunities. Trading assets can encompass a wide range of financial instruments such as equities, commodities, and foreign exchange.

All market data and forecasts are based on nominal prices and all currency conversions used in the creation of this report have been calculated using yearly annual average exchange rates. The USD values may show a declining trend for few countries such as Argentina, Turkey, Nigeria, Egypt, and Russia. This is primarily because of the impact of exchange rates considered.

For the purposes of this report, the global market consists of North America, South America, Europe, Asia-Pacific and the Middle East & Africa.

North America comprises Canada, Mexico, and the United States.

South America comprises Argentina, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, and Peru.

Europe comprises Germany, France, the United Kingdom, Italy, Russia, Spain, the Netherlands, Turkey, Switzerland, Sweden, Belgium, Poland, Norway, Austria, Denmark, Greece, Finland, Portugal, Ireland, and the Czech Republic.

Asia-Pacific comprises China, Japan, India, Australia, South Korea, Indonesia, Taiwan, Thailand, Malaysia, Singapore, Philippines, Pakistan, New Zealand, Hong Kong, Vietnam, and Kazakhstan.

The Middle East & Africa comprises South Africa, Nigeria, Saudi Arabia, Egypt, Israel, and the United Arab Emirates.

Document DMRP000020250509e14a000ga



Wealth Management

Standard Chartered eyes private markets tie-ups in ultra high net worth push; Lender wants to ink deals with other 'tier one managers' to boost its investment club for the ultra wealthy

Kristen McGachey

536 words

10 April 2025

07:00

Financial News

LONFIN

English

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Standard Chartered is eyeing further tie-ups with major private markets players as it looks to bolster its presence in the high net worth market.

The UK lender rolled out an investment club for its ultra-wealthy clients last month to give them exclusive access to private markets deals globally.

Nicholas Cheng, head of private markets at Standard Chartered's private bank, said the aim of the Private Markets Co-Investment Club is to help investors build portfolios with institutional-grade investments.

"We've seen a growing demand from our clients, especially in key markets like Singapore, Hong Kong and Dubai, for direct access to private markets," Cheng told Financial News.

Standard Chartered has partnered with French secondaries shop Ardian on the new investment platform.

But the bank plans strike up partnerships with other "tier one managers", Cheng told FN.

Each partner firm will be a specialist in a particular area, such as early or late stage venture capital, private credit, direct lending or specific areas of the real estate market like data centres.

Standard Chartered is having conversations with prospective alternatives managers "all day, every day, twice on Sundays," Cheng said.

He declined to comment on whether more partnerships would be announced this year.

"The way we want to run the business is slightly different from the rest of the industry," Cheng told FN. "We're picking themes and strategies that are relevant to clients, and filling that vertical with best-in-class managers."

read more

* [Hg tops \\$1bn in wealth fund push](#)

* [BlackRock's Larry Fink hails democracy for private assets. But what will it mean for fees?](#)

Private banks and wealth managers have launched a flurry of products to help the ultra-rich tap into private equity, venture capital and private credit — investments that were previously only available to large pension funds or sovereign wealth funds.

Wealthy individuals have been drawn to private assets, enticed by the prospect of punchy returns and greater diversification.

Meanwhile, public equity markets have been shrinking as companies choose to stay unlisted for longer, which has helped fuel a dearth of IPOs.

"There's an element of FOMO, and wanting to get access to [private companies] before they become generally available to the public," Cheng said.

Alongside providing access to manager-led co-investment opportunities, members of the Standard Chartered club will also get benefits such as institutional-grade due diligence, facilitated execution and "comprehensive post-sale support", including ongoing monitoring and reporting, Cheng said.

"Most platforms operate on a pure introducer-broker model," he said. "You leverage your networks, find the exposure, and connect clients through it. But thereafter it's caveat emptor because you are now dealing directly with either the financial sponsor and/or the company."

Standard Chartered's CIC is currently available to eligible high net worth clients in Singapore, Hong Kong and the UAE, but the bank is planning to extend the service to clients in Jersey.

Write to Kristen McGachey at kristen.mcgachey@dowjones.com

Document LONFIN0020250409e149000dx

Unveiling HSBC Privé: A Gateway to Unparalleled Luxury and Global Experiences

Distributed by Contify.com

1,052 words

8 April 2025

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* The card is designed for high-net-worth (HNW) and ultra-high-net-worth (UHNW) clients, with privileges tailored to complement their mobile lifestyles and provide access to private clubs, premium travel experiences, and top-tier hospitality worldwide.

* Credit card spending by ultra high net worth and high net worth Mastercard cardholders in the Asia Pacific region increased by 52 per cent between 2023 and 2024, with notable growth in categories such as dining, travel, and live entertainment.

* HSBC Privé was developed using deep client insights to reflect how HNW and UHNW clients spend, travel and experience the world, and was shaped by a recent client survey of existing HSBC credit cardholders in Singapore.

Original Press Release:

April 8 -- HSBC **Private Banking** issued the following news release:

HSBC Singapore has unveiled HSBC Privé – its first premium credit card offering access to extraordinary global experiences curated exclusively for HSBC Global **Private Banking** clients. Following its debut in Hong Kong and subsequent launch in India, Singapore marks the next phase of the global rollout, with further expansion planned across key wealth hubs across Asia.

Launched in collaboration with Mastercard, HSBC Privé's privileges are designed for high-net-worth (HNW) and ultra-high-net-worth (UHNW) clients who are entrepreneurial, international and keen to expand their networks to discover new opportunities globally.

Tommy Leung, Head of HSBC Global **Private Banking**, South Asia at HSBC, said: "Our Global **Private Banking** clients lead dynamic, international lives, balancing business expansion with personal aspirations. They choose us not only for our distinctive wealth management approach and deep understanding of their needs, but also for our ability to provide bespoke solutions that extend beyond banking. HSBC Privé was designed with this in mind—offering not just exclusive privileges, but a gateway to extraordinary global experiences. We are excited to introduce this invitation-only card to our clients in Singapore, empowering them to explore the world with unparalleled ease and distinction."

Singapore continues to strengthen its position as a leading wealth hub, with a growing number of international and next-generation wealth clients seeking sophisticated solutions that extend beyond traditional banking. HSBC Privé is tailored to complement their highly mobile lifestyles, providing seamless access to prestigious private clubs, premium travel experiences, and top-tier hospitality worldwide.

Spending trends among the wealthy in Asia

Credit card spending by ultra high net worth and high net worth Mastercard cardholders in the Asia Pacific region have increased by 52 per cent between 2023 and 2024^[1], with notable growth in categories such as dining (+47 per cent), travel (+58 per cent), and live entertainment (+51 per cent). These figures rose even further when cardholders were overseas, with spending on dining, accommodation, and live entertainment increasing by 59 per cent, 58 per cent, and 90 per cent respectively.

Recognising these trends, HSBC Privé was developed using deep client insights to reflect how HNW and UHNW clients spend, travel and experience the world. Driven by a client-centric approach, HSBC Global **Private Banking** conducted in-depth studies in early 2024 to review recent market developments and future client needs. The bank's recent client survey[2] reveals that a vast majority of HSBC Global **Private Banking** clients are existing HSBC credit cardholders in Singapore (77 per cent), and their feedback was instrumental in shaping the HSBC Privé proposition.

Ari Sarker, President, Asia Pacific, Mastercard, said "HSBC Privé is designed for people who strive for the same level of access and quality wherever they go. They are ambitious and deliberate in growing their network and influence. Mastercard is proud to partner with HSBC to offer an enhanced suite of experiences for HSBC's Global **Private Banking** clients in Singapore as they travel and make meaningful connections around the world."

Exclusive benefits designed for HSBC Privé cardholders

HSBC Privé offers a curated suite of privileges designed to match the global lifestyle and sophisticated preferences of Singapore's **private banking** clients, including:

- * Exclusive access — worldwide access to bespoke private clubs, members-only lounges and workspaces at more than 150 locations across Asia, Australia, Europe and the United States
- * Elevated travel — A complimentary business class airline ticket with leading airlines, access to premium airport lounges worldwide, airport limousine transfers, hotel night stays, hotel loyalty membership upgrades and travel insurance
- * Exceptional lifestyle — Complimentary tasting menus for cardholders and an accompanying guest at Michelin-starred restaurants and premium hospitality groups, courtesy green fees at select golf courses and fast-track to top membership status at iconic department stores in London and Paris

About HSBC Global **Private Banking**

HSBC Global **Private Banking** helps clients manage, grow and preserve their wealth for generations to come. Its network of global experts helps clients access investment opportunities around the world, plan for the future with wealth and succession planning, manage their portfolio with tailored solutions, and find the right support for their philanthropy. www.privatebanking.hsbc.com

The Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corporation Limited

The Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corporation Limited is the founding member of the HSBC Group. HSBC serves customers worldwide from offices in 58 countries and territories. With assets of USD3,017 billion at 31 December 2024, HSBC is one of the world's largest banking and financial services organisations.

About Mastercard

Mastercard powers economies and empowers people in 200+ countries and territories worldwide. Together with our customers, we're building a sustainable economy where everyone can prosper. We support a wide range of digital payments choices, making transactions secure, simple, smart and accessible. Our technology and innovation, partnerships and networks combine to deliver a unique set of products and services that help people, businesses and governments realize their greatest potential. www.mastercard.com www.mastercard.com Open In New Window

Footnotes:

[1]. Statistics provided by Mastercard.

[2]. The HSBC GPB Credit Card Value Proposition Survey was conducted between February and March 2024 with more than 200 existing Global **Private Banking** clients in Hong Kong and Singapore.↵

[3]. Terms and conditions apply.

[4]. For more information, visit <https://www.hsbc.com.sg/credit-cards/products/prive> <https://www.hsbc.com.sg/credit-cards/products/prive> Open In New Window

[Category: Banks, Banks, Retail/ Commercial Banks, New Offerings, Business Expansion]

Source: HSBC **Private Banking**

Document ATINBK0020250409el48000dx

HSBC unveils premium credit card in Singapore

Cheryl Heng
293 words
8 April 2025
Citywire Asia
CWIRAS
English

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HSBC has rolled out its premium credit card offering for its **private banking** clients in Singapore, following its launches in Hong Kong and India.

In collaboration with Mastercard, the Prive card targets ultra- and high net worth clients who are entrepreneurial and international, said the bank in a 8 April statement.

The Prive card joins a [league of premium credit cards](#) in Singapore, as banks double down to gain market share of the expanding mass affluent segment.

HSBC's invite-only card was designed recognising key spending trends among wealthy Asians, having surged 52% year-on-year in 2024. Dining, travel and live entertainment were the top categories, with wealthy cardholders inclined to spending more when they are abroad.

About 77% of HSBC Global **Private Banking** clients are existing HSBC credit cardholders in Singapore.

'Our **private banking** clients lead dynamic, international lives, balancing business expansion with personal aspirations,' said Tommy Leung (pictured), head of HSBC GPB, South Asia at HSBC.

Card benefits include exclusive access to private clubs, members-only lounge and workspaces at over 150 locations globally. It includes a complimentary business class airline ticket with leading airlines, airport lounge access and limousine transfers, as well as hotel night stays.

Cardholders also get complimentary tasting menus at Michelin-starred restaurants, along with an accompanying guest.

Additional perks feature courtesy green fees at some golf courses and top membership status at certain department stores in London and Paris.

In October, HSBC debuted the Prive card in Hong Kong.

Competitors like Standard Chartered has recently launched its mass affluent card called Beyond. In the **private banking** segment, Prive is up against rivals Citi's Ultima, DBS's Insignia, UOB's Reserve and OCBC's Voyage card.

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Business

HSBC bets big on Hong Kong to tap Asia's **wealth-management** boom, CEO Elhedery says

Enoch Yiu

877 words

31 March 2025

scmp.com

SCMCOM

English

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HSBC's customers base increased to 6.2 million last year from 5.4 million, showing the importance of the city, Elhedery says

HSBC, the largest bank in Hong Kong with 6.2 million customers, will invest heavily in **wealth management** and technology in the city, using it as a base to tap the fast-growing markets in Asia, according to group CEO Georges Elhedery.

"Hong Kong is on track to be the largest cross-border wealth hub on the planet before the end of this decade, and we are in a bold position to be able to capture this growth opportunity," Elhedery said in a media briefing on Thursday. "I am very optimistic about Hong Kong."

Hong Kong, where the bank was established 160 years ago, is its largest profit contributor and biggest source of new clients. Pre-tax profit from the Hong Kong operations, including its Hang Seng Bank unit, grew 9.5 per cent last year to US\$11.69 billion, largely due to the addition of 800,000 customers.

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"We moved our customer base from 5.4 million to 6.2 million here, which demonstrates how important the Hong Kong market is," said Elhedery, who took over in September.

HSBC's customer base in Hong Kong was equal to more than 80 per cent of the city's 7.5 million population, but that was not going to limit the bank's client growth as most new signings were from those living elsewhere, he said. About two-thirds of non-local new customers were from mainland China and the rest from across the world, he added.

"Hong Kong is probably one of the brightest spots for the last couple of years, so there is definitely strong optimism in terms of Hong Kong as a global financial centre," Elhedery said.

He said the bank planned to recycle capital saved from its restructuring plan and redeploy US\$1.5 billion from "low-return" markets to markets like Hong Kong, mainland China, Singapore and India, with **wealth management** as the main focus.

The expansion plan includes hiring more **wealth managers**, opening new wealth centres in Hong Kong, Singapore, mainland China, India, the United Arab Emirates and the UK, as well as exploring the use of artificial intelligence (AI) and other digital platforms.

Hong Kong would be one of the big winners in the expansion plan, group chief financial officer Pam Kaur said in the same briefing.

The bank's big presence in the city would allow it to hire more people and grow quickly, said Kaur, the first woman to serve in the role at the bank.

Hong Kong, which had HK\$31 trillion (US\$4 trillion) of assets under management in 2023, was likely to overtake Switzerland by 2027 as the world's top hub for cross-border **wealth management**, according to estimates from the Securities and Futures Commission and Boston Consulting Group.

Elhedery said HSBC would also invest in technology, including mobile apps and other digital services, to enhance customer experience.

"The challenge for all of us now is how we can adopt AI in a thoughtful and safe way, while generating improved productivity and customer service," he said.

Kaur said the adoption of AI would not affect HSBC's recruitment plans.

"AI is an enabler to help you develop more products, to have better customer journeys in terms of the use of apps," she said. "But **wealth management** is fundamentally a people business."

Elhedery said HSBC would also expand its presence in corporate banking, the small and medium-sized business sector and cross-border payment systems in the city, while at the same time use Hong Kong as a gateway to connect China with the world.

"We are supporting Chinese customers to expand overseas, and we are supporting international customers to capture opportunities opening up in China by bringing them onshore," he said.

On the impact of US tariffs on China, Elhedery said companies would relocate their production and supply chains to eliminate the threat, adding that HSBC's global network could help its corporate clients cope with the changes.

London-based Elhedery hosted the second edition of HSBC's Global Investment Summit from March 25 to 27 in Hong Kong, which was attended by more than 4,000 guests, mostly from overseas.

"The Global Investment Summit highlighted the city's vibrant financial ecosystem and growth opportunities," he said, adding that the bank planned to turn the event into a regular annual meeting.

"The level of dynamism, vitality and excitement at the conference is amazing," he said. "During the summit, HSBC arranged 7,000 one-on-one meetings between investors and companies, which is 100 meetings per hour of the conference."

Elhedery also attended the Hong Kong Sevens rugby tournament sponsored by the bank at the new Kai Tak Stadium.

He will host the bank's informal shareholders meeting on Tuesday before returning to London.

Document SCMCOM0020250331e13v0002v

Big Story

Piyush Gupta steps down as CEO at his final AGM with DBS

Sheila Chiang

763 words

29 March 2025

The Straits Times

STIMES

English

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Mr Piyush Gupta has officially stepped down as DBS Bank chief executive and passed the baton to Ms Tan Su Shan.

Ms Tan, who is the first female CEO in DBS' history and was previously the bank's deputy CEO, is expected to continue DBS' focus on high return on equity businesses and global growth.

In a statement read out at DBS' annual general meeting (AGM) on March 28 at the Sands Expo and Convention Centre, Temasek Holdings CEO Dilhan Pillay said that the partnership between DBS chairman Peter Seah and Mr Gupta created "significant value" for the bank, its franchise, its shareholders and the financial services sector.

Temasek is a major shareholder of DBS.

"Piyush Gupta has driven a total transformation of DBS over these 15 years. His achievements speak for themselves -- the accolades that DBS has received over the years, including recognition by Euromoney in 2016 as the first bank to be named World's Best Digital Bank. In 2018, DBS was named the World's Best Bank and has received the award multiple times since then," said Mr Pillay.

He added that DBS will continue to be in the good hands of Mr Seah and Ms Tan, and that Temasek is confident they will "continue to drive DBS' relentless focus on excellence for value to all its stakeholders".

Mr Gupta, who is 65 and a Singapore citizen, is stepping down from a high point in the bank's history.

South-east Asia's largest bank by assets reported in February a record performance in 2024, with full-year net profits up 11 per cent year on year to \$11.4 billion.

The board proposed a final dividend of 60 cents per share for the fourth quarter of 2024, bringing the full-year ordinary dividend to \$2.22 per share, an increase of 27 per cent from the previous year.

Since Mr Gupta first took on the role of CEO in November 2009, DBS' share price has increased more than 280 per cent to \$46.47 at the close on March 28.

DBS' market capitalisation crossed \$100 billion in May 2024, a first for a Singapore-listed company, the bank said in its annual report. By year-end, its market value had risen further to \$124 billion.

Total shareholder returns for 2024 were 51 per cent, comprising a share price gain of 44 per cent and a dividend return of 7 per cent. It is the highest in DBS' history outside crisis-rebound years, the bank said.

Mr Gupta noted that higher fee income helped to offset the decline in interest income as interest rates fell during the year.

He said that DBS' **wealth management** business was a strong growth driver for the bank, having benefited from "a lot of new money which came in". Assets under management grew 17 per cent year on year in 2024 to \$426 billion.

There were, however, some low points in Mr Gupta's 15-year career with the bank.

In 2023, for example, DBS suffered a series of digital disruptions that led to him receiving a 27 per cent pay cut for the year.

In 2024, he was paid \$17.6 million, compared with \$11.2 million after the pay cut in 2023.

Mr Gupta noted at the AGM that the board took "very serious cognisance" of the bank's technology outages in 2021 and 2023, and put in measures to strengthen its technological risk management.

Moving forward, Ms Tan noted that there will be heightened political and economic uncertainty globally. But the bank will focus on delivering medium- and long-term results, she said.

She said that consumers are getting more sophisticated and want more from their banks.

Customers will stay with safe and trusted banks and roll their **wealth management** with them, she said, noting that **wealth management** is a high return on equity business and that DBS will continue to grow the segment.

For its transaction banking business, Ms Tan said that DBS has been able to create a high velocity of volumes and transactions with its corporate clients, especially for digital payments and cross-border payments.

"DBS will continue to be at the forefront of this," she said.

She also noted that intra-Asian trade is growing, and there may be more Western multinational companies that want to invest in Asia and benefit from the demographic growth there.

"So the connectivity flows, the trade flows will continue, and we want to be in that flow," she added.

Document STIMES0020250328e13t0040w

Supplement 1

Standard Chartered Global Private Bank innovating to redefine wealth management

905 words

26 March 2025

Business Times Singapore

STBT

English

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IN AN environment of growing market volatility and shifting geopolitical risks, ultra-high-net-worth (UHNW) clients are increasingly focusing on preserving, diversifying and growing portfolios. Additionally, they are actively seeking solutions that go beyond traditional **wealth management**.

Foo Tian Ong, Regional Head for Southeast Asia and Singapore Location Head at Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank** ("the Bank"), believes that ongoing innovation is crucial to staying ahead. He remarked, "We are a client-centric global **private bank** that emphasises personalised wealth advice to meet client's needs."

"In addition to navigating uncertainty, today's clients are global citizens with diverse needs, and there is no "one-size-fits-all" solution. The Bank's strength lies in understanding clients' sophisticated requirements and leveraging our extensive network and capabilities to meet those needs. Whether it's wealth accumulation and preservation, or supporting wealth transfer in accordance with their family values, we are the trusted partner on their wealth journey," Foo said.

Curated solutions

The Bank leverages its international network spanning more than 50 vibrant markets with deep local expertise to offer a comprehensive array of solutions which can be tailored to meet diverse client needs. Its unique open-architecture investment advisory approach empowers both advisors and clients to navigate market uncertainties with unbiased confidence.

The Bank's strategic portfolio construction approach focuses on creating customised, diversified portfolios that are designed to remain resilient during volatile periods. It has a range of holistic wealth solutions, ranging from discretionary to advisory and execution-only services. The Bank can tailor these solutions to clients' preferences and their desired level of involvement in decision-making. This ensures timely portfolio reallocation to manage market volatility while seizing opportunities, enabling clients to achieve their financial goals with precision and care.

Clients can also benefit from broader portfolio diversification through alternative asset classes, including private credit, hedge funds and access to co-investment opportunities in the private markets.

Foo also discussed going beyond providing **wealth management** advice. He recounted the success of the Bank's inaugural Global Family Network Forum held in Hong Kong in 2024. This event covered global family topics such as managing inter-generational wealth, exploring new avenues for direct investments, future-proofing family businesses, and making an impact on our communities. The forum connected 200 international participants, including 80 global UHNW families. Participants shared insights and engaged with one another on a range of topics.

Relationship managers at the forefront

Cutting-edge technology complements the client experience today. The Bank is investing in WhatsApp and WeChat solutions in addition to allowing clients to take leverage on its digital banking platform. However, the Bank values the role that human relationships play in guiding clients through intricate wealth journeys.

Building long-term relationships is a key driver of the Bank's strategy and Foo believes this is essential for serving clients across generations. Amidst a rising trend of wealth transfer, this is particularly pertinent in Asia, where UHNW families are increasingly requiring strategic planning advice to secure their legacies.

According to McKinsey's analysis, UHNW and high-net worth families in the Asia-Pacific region are experiencing an inter-generational wealth transfer estimated at US\$5.8 trillion between 2023 and 2030.

Foo highlighted that the Bank is growing its Relationship Manager (RM) bench through "selectively hiring top talent" to meet its growth ambition. This aligns with the Bank's target to achieve US\$200 billion of net new money from its affluent business. In 2024, the number of Singapore-based RMs grew by 15 per cent, with similar growth expected in 2025.

Apart from a deep understanding of financial products and market trends that will enable RMs to remain agile during market uncertainties, Foo noted that experienced RMs should be able to proactively engage clients on their changing needs as they journey through different life stages.

"Not only are we supporting our clients' wealth ambitions, we are also committed to safeguarding and helping them pass on their wealth to future generations. Each client is valued and benefits from a tailored approach to meet their unique situational needs and wealth objectives," he said.

Foo recounted the case of a particular RM, who had built trusted relationships with several UHNW clients over the years. Their conversations went beyond portfolio management, expanding into the clients' aspirations and concerns for their family's future. Through these deeper interactions, the RM recognised that legacy planning was becoming a growing priority and took the initiative to bring in the Bank's wealth planning team to better understand the clients' legacy ambitions. This enabled the team to craft bespoke solutions, safeguarding their families' wealth for generations to come.

The power of a universal bank

With increasing international mobility, UHNW clients need solutions to manage their wealth across jurisdictions. Standard Chartered's wealth hubs in Singapore, Hong Kong, UAE, and Jersey, complement its global network by connecting clients' wealth needs to global market opportunities.

Moreover, as a universal bank, Standard Chartered brings the advantage of a one-bank approach. UHNW clients can access corporate banking services, ensuring their individual and business needs are met under one roof in a streamlined client-centric approach.

"By seamlessly integrating individual wealth solutions and corporate banking services, our one-bank approach empowers clients with the resources and solutions to effectively manage their life's work and build lasting legacies," Foo concluded.

Document STBT000020250325e13q004ke



Business

Standard Chartered plans Hong Kong wealth centres to tap US\$200 billion of 'new money'

Aileen Chuang

601 words

24 March 2025

scmp.com

SCMCOM

English

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The next **wealth management** centre will open in Central later this year, while the bank scouts for new locations in the city

[Standard Chartered](#) will open one **wealth management** centre a year over the next five years in Hong Kong as part of its global strategy to grow its wealth business and also tap small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs) in the Greater Bay Area, according to a senior executive.

"We are focused on opening more **wealth management** centres to serve the affluent population in the area and improve the service quality to sustain the strong business performance," Stephen Man Wai-shing, head of wealth and retail banking at Standard Chartered Hong Kong, said at the launch of the bank's fifth such centre last week in the tourist hotspot of Tsim Sha Tsui.

The centre provides banking services for affluent local, cross-border and international clients. The next outlet would be in Central, complementing the existing one at Exchange Square, with a soft launch towards the end of this year, Man said. Future facilities in locations such as Causeway Bay were also being considered, he added.

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The robust growth in services for affluent clients drove Standard Chartered's profit up 21 per cent in 2024, prompting group CEO Bill Winters to set an ambitious goal of attracting US\$200 billion of **wealth-management** business worldwide from newly affluent people in the next five years.

Another growth area for the bank in Hong Kong is mainland SMEs with a focus on imports. Standard Chartered recently started working with Cainiao, a Chinese e-commerce logistics provider and Alibaba Group Holding affiliate, to streamline lending processes for SMEs based on transaction data. Alibaba owns the Post.

Data from Cainiao would help the bank "quicken and enlarge credit approvals" as part of its efforts to support SME development and transformation, Man said.

Two loan facilities were approved a week after the launch of the partnership, Man said, without disclosing the borrowers.

Standard Chartered's partnership with Cainiao followed a similar collaboration with Hong Kong-listed supply-chain fintech solutions provider Linklogis to access Amazon's real-time data, including merchants' sales performance and refund rates.

Eligible SMEs selling on Amazon's platform can get an overdraft facility of up to US\$1 million, according to an announcement last May.

The bank also plans to target SME owners to offer its **wealth management** services. "We will focus more on these business owners in the Greater Bay Area starting this year," he said.

To support the ambitions, the bank is looking to hire more than 100 **wealth managers** in Hong Kong this year.

The recruitment is part of the lender's US\$1.5 billion investment in the **wealth-management** business over the next five years, with Hong Kong – the bank's largest profit centre – set to be the focus of the expansion.

Standard Chartered Hong Kong's retail banking business, which excludes private banking, recorded double-digit growth in affluent clients' assets under management last year from the previous year. Revenue from funds and insurance products rose by 40 per cent in the same period.

Revenue from mainland clients also experienced double-digit growth, while net new money from mainland clients went up by 40 per cent.

Document SCMCOM0020250324e13o00002

HSBC appoints Kanas Chan as Head of Global **Private Banking**, North Asia and Hong Kong

Distributed by Contify.com

611 words

21 March 2025

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* Kanas Chan is appointed as Head of Global **Private Banking**, North Asia and Hong Kong at HSBC, effective 14 April 2025.

* Chan joins HSBC from Deutsche Bank, where she had three decades of experience in **wealth management**.

* In her new role, she will drive strategic growth priorities and performance for the **private bank** across Hong Kong, Taiwan, and offshore mainland China markets.

Original Press Release:

March 21 -- HSBC Global **Private Banking** issued the following news release:

HSBC today announced the appointment of Kanas Chan as Head of Global **Private Banking**, North Asia and Hong Kong, effective 14 April 2025.

Chan, a seasoned banker with three decades of experience in **wealth management**, will join HSBC from Deutsche Bank. In her new role, she will drive strategic growth priorities and performance for the **private bank** across Hong Kong, Taiwan and offshore mainland China markets. Her leadership is expected to further enhance the already strong Global **Private Banking** business in Asia, which has achieved record profits for full year 2024. This success is marked by double-digit year on year revenue growth in every quarter, supported by a 21 per cent increase in invested asset, to USD199 billion.

Based in Hong Kong, Chan will report to Lok Yim, Regional Head, Global **Private Banking**, Asia Pacific and Maggie Ng, Head of Wealth and Personal Banking, Hong Kong.

Commenting on Chan's appointment, Lok Yim, Regional Head, Global **Private Banking**, Asia Pacific, HSBC, said: "The **wealth management** industry in Hong Kong is brimming with opportunities as wealth in the region is expected to continue on a rapid growth trajectory. We are delighted that Kanas is joining HSBC Global **Private Banking**, bringing her substantial experience in client coverage and deep knowledge of investment products and markets. Her expertise will help us continue to spearhead the growth agenda in North Asia."

Maggie Ng, Head of Wealth and Personal Banking, Hong Kong, HSBC, commented: "Kanas brings extensive expertise in investment and **wealth management**, positioning her to effectively lead our high-performing teams in delivering tailored wealth solutions for our **private banking** clients. Her proven leadership will contribute to our mission to become Asia's leading **wealth manager**. With her distinguished track record, she will help enhance the impact of HSBC's global network and unparalleled expertise, supporting high-net-worth (HNW) and ultra-high-net-worth (UHNW) individuals in growing and preserving their financial legacies for future generations."

Chan joined Deutsche Bank in 2007 and has since held several senior positions in their **Wealth Management** business, most recently as Head of North Asia for the **private bank**. Prior to that, she led Capital Markets business in **Wealth Management** Asia Pacific. Before joining Deutsche Bank, Chan also worked at Citi **Private Bank** and DBS **Private Bank**.

About HSBC Global **Private Banking**

HSBC Global **Private Banking** helps clients manage, grow and preserve their wealth for generations to come. Its network of global experts helps clients access investment opportunities around the world, plan for the future with

wealth and succession planning, manage their portfolio with tailored solutions, and find the right support for their philanthropy. www.privatebanking.hsbc.com.

The Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corporation Limited

The Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corporation Limited is the founding member of the HSBC Group. HSBC serves customers worldwide from offices in 58 countries and territories. With assets of USD3,017 billion at 31 December 2024, HSBC is one of the world's largest banking and financial services organisations.

[Category: Banks, Asset Management/ Mutual Funds, Financial/ Capital Market, Management/ Leadership Changes]

Source: HSBC Global **Private Banking**

Document ATINBK0020250324el3I00030

Exclusive: HSBC GPB adds Philippines desk head to SEA coverage

Priyanka Boghani

280 words

21 March 2025

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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Following an internal reshuffle, HSBC Global **Private Banking** (GPB) has named its Philippines desk head, as it looks to strengthen its Southeast Asia coverage, Citywire Asia understands.

Mina Chan has been given the new GPB Philippines and Japan desk head title, reporting to Abhishek Mehrotra, market head, Southeast Asia International. Hong Kong-based Chan, who was an investment counselling team head with over 20 years at HSBC, will relinquish this role.

Mehrotra, who will relocate from Hong Kong to Singapore in due course, covers the onshore and offshore markets of Thailand, Vietnam, Philippines, Australia and Japan. He now has three desk heads in his team with Chan's appointment. They include Sanjay Shah, who covers Australia and Benjamin Wang, on the Thailand desk.

HSBC GPB has been relocating its Australia onshore bankers to Singapore to cover the market offshore.

Citywire Asia reached out to the bank for a comment on the reshuffle.

Wang's role was [announced](#) along with Urban Binggeli, who joined the bank as desk head for Indonesia, reporting to Hammad Hashmi, market head for Singapore, Malaysia, and Indonesia at HSBC GPB.

The changes to the Southeast Asia desk follows the bank's decision to [split](#) Chris Harwood's role between two existing market heads, Mehrotra and Hashmi, in November.

The bank also [confirmed](#) the appointment of North Asia **private banking** head, Kanas Chan in a 21 March press release and Jean Nabaa as the organisation's COO for **private bank** and wealth globally, reporting to global head of international wealth and **private banking**, Terecina Kwong. His appointment was first [reported](#) last June by Citywire Asia.

Document CWIRAS0020250321e13l00002

Exclusive: UOB Private Bank's Malaysia market head resigns

Cheryl Heng

102 words

19 March 2025

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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UOB Private Bank's head of Malaysia market head has quit, Citywire Asia understands.

Sean Tay has resigned from his post, where he covered the Malaysia market, based in Singapore.

A spokesperson from the bank declined to comment on the departure.

Tay had worked at the Singaporean private bank since 2020, according to the regulator's registry. Prior to UOB, he was at Bank of Singapore as a team head of core wealth.

Last August, UOB Private Bank Malaysia team head Remus Tan left the bank, along with several private bankers.

Document CWIRAS0020250319e13j00001

Business

HSBC and UBS expand wealth units in India amid IPO surge

KRISHN KAUSHIK; CHRIS KAY

564 words

18 March 2025

Financial Times

FTFTA

1; Main

7

English

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Sharp increase in multimillionaires ? Banks move to offer bespoke services

HSBC and UBS are expanding their **wealth management** arms in India to compete with local rivals after a listings boom minted a new class of millionaires.

The Swiss bank is looking to acquire shares in 360 ONE, one of India's largest **wealth management** companies, said two people familiar with the matter, while HSBC announced in January that it would nearly double its branches in India with a focus on "cities identified for their growing wealth pools".

A record level of initial public offerings last year created a new crop of rich Indians, prompting big banks to start offering bespoke services and catering to wealthy households outside the large metropolitan areas.

Wealth under management is expected to triple to more than \$850bn in the next five years, according to broker and asset manager Motilal Oswal Financial Services. Property consultancy Knight Frank estimates that the number of people in India with more than \$30mn will rise by half to nearly 20,000 in the five years to 2028, the fastest pace globally and far higher than the 28 per cent worldwide average growth.

"There has been remarkable wealth creation that's taken place across all the client segments ... linked to the way India is growing," said Rajesh Saluja, chief executive of Blackstone-backed ASK Private Wealth in Mumbai, which serves about 3,500 wealthy families.

He added that the **wealth manage**-ment industry had "serious tailwinds" as start-up founders exercised their stock options.

Yatin Shah, co-founder of publicly listed 360 ONE, declined to comment on whether his company was in talks with UBS, but told the Financial Times that a "lot of other good reputable franchises reach out to us, that they look at India for next 10 to 20 years as a very attractive destination outside the US".

UBS did not respond to a request for comment.

Global banks view their advantage as serving clients in the Indian diaspora and those interested in overseas investments. Sandeep Batra, HSBC India's international wealth head, said in January that the bank was "aiming to be the preferred international bank for India's affluent and globally mobile Indians".

However, Gautami Gavankar, one of the heads of Kotak Mahindra Bank's **wealth management** business, told the FT that India would remain a top investment destination for clients, especially as rules allow Indians to invest only up to \$250,000 outside the country.

Kotak's **wealth management** clientele has grown almost 15 per cent annually for the past four years, she said, while the number has doubled in so-called second and third-tier cities in the past two years.

Demand for multifamily offices is growing across the country, added Gavankar, who expects competition to intensify as activity picks up in India's equity market over the next decade.

Akash Hariani, co-managing director of Motilal Oswal's **wealth management** business, said that he took seven to eight flights a week to meet clients, demonstrating the "kind of money creation that's happening across the country".

"It's unbelievable," he said. "There is so much activity that you will feel bad for not being there."

'Franchises ... look at India for next 10 to 20 years as a very attractive destination outside the US'

Document FTFTA00020250318el3i00092

HSBC Bank USA N.A. Wealthiest Investors Spread a Wider Net in Drive for Global Diversification

712 words

14 March 2025

Investment Weekly News

INVWK

35

English

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2025 MAR 15 (VerticalNews) -- By a News Reporter-Staff News Editor at Investment Weekly News -- The world's wealthiest investors are becoming more mobile as they plan for additional residences around the world and seek out global opportunities for their assets and businesses. HSBC's Global Wealth Hubs: Drivers of Diversification 2025 report shows how wealthy business owners share a global mindset - where national and regional borders are viewed as opportunities rather than obstacles. The report is based on a survey of high net worth (HNW) and ultra high net worth (UHNW) entrepreneurs about their attitudes towards their wealth and businesses in international markets. It focuses on five key global wealth hubs - each with unique attributes that complement each other: US: The US remains a magnet for the world's wealthy and business owners, ranking equal first in the survey of 23 cited markets for HNW entrepreneurs considering it as a location to establish part or all of their business.

Hong Kong: Hong Kong ranks top for business owners with multi-residency. It also forms part of the biggest wealth corridor in our research, with 49% of Hong Kong entrepreneurs having an additional residency in mainland China. Singapore: Singapore has thrived as an international wealth hub in recent decades, particularly with the region's entrepreneurs. The Singapore-India wealth corridor is the third largest in our research. Switzerland: Switzerland retains its broad appeal across all ages and levels of wealth. It ranks first for entrepreneurs seeking to move their personal wealth to a new location over the next 12 months. UK: The UK is home to the largest percentage of multi-resident entrepreneurs surveyed in Western markets and is the most popular location for the oldest and the wealthiest surveyed entrepreneurs considering taking up residency.

Racquel Oden, U.S. Head of International Wealth, Premier, and Global **Private Banking**, said: "The innovators and entrepreneurs driving the U.S. economy make it an incredibly attractive proposition to everyone else, which explains why we're seeing a widening of wealth corridors to include investors from all across the world." About Global Wealth Hubs: Drivers of Diversification 2025 The findings are based on extensive research conducted by Ipsos UK on behalf of HSBC among 1,798 high net worth business owners with at least US\$2m of investable assets. A third (583) were ultra high net worth with a net worth of more than US\$100m. The research was conducted online in mainland China, France, Hong Kong, India, Singapore, Switzerland, Taiwan, UAE, UK and US. See the report for the full methodology. About HSBC Global **Private Banking** HSBC Global **Private Banking** helps clients manage, grow and preserve their wealth for generations to come. Its network of global experts helps clients access investment opportunities around the world, plan for the future with wealth and succession planning, manage their portfolio with tailored solutions, and find the right support for their philanthropy.

www.privatebanking.hsbc.com About HSBC Holdings plc HSBC Holdings plc, the parent company of HSBC, is headquartered in London. HSBC serves customers worldwide from offices in 58 countries and territories. With assets of US\$3,017bn at 31 December 2024, HSBC is one of the world's largest banking and financial services organisations. HSBC Bank USA, National Association (HSBC Bank USA, N.A.) serves customers through Wealth and Personal Banking, Commercial Banking, **Private Banking**, Global Banking, and Markets and Securities Services. Deposit products are offered by HSBC Bank USA, N.A., Member FDIC. It operates Wealth Centers in: California; Washington, D.C.; Florida; New Jersey; New York; Virginia; and Washington. HSBC Bank USA, N.A. is the principal subsidiary of HSBC USA Inc., a wholly-owned subsidiary of HSBC North America Holdings Inc. HSBC Innovation Banking in the U.S. is a business division with services provided in the United States by HSBC Bank USA, N.A For more information, visit: HSBC in the USA View source version on businesswire.com: <https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20250227160892/en/>

Keywords for this news article include: Asia, Hong Kong, Singapore, HSBC Bank USA N.A., Investment and Finance.

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Exclusive: HSBC GPB's UAE head of private banking exits

Priyanka Boghani

315 words

14 March 2025

Citywire Middle East

CWIRME

English

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HSBC Global Private Banking's head of private banking for the UAE region is leaving as the bank undergoes several changes, Citywire Middle East can reveal.

Farzad Billimoria will exit the bank, where he was the CEO and head of its private banking business in the UAE for almost a decade.

HSBC confirmed his departure, adding that Billimoria's responsibilities will be assumed by Aladdin Hangari, head of Global Private Banking MENAT. The changes reflect the bank's need to simplify its structure and improve efficiency, the spokesperson added.

Billimoria has spent almost two decades at HSBC, working across Dubai and Mumbai in various roles, including regional deputy head of the non-resident Indian services segment for the Mena region, and team head in Dubai.

As private banking head, he was responsible for setting up the DIFC branch in Dubai, driving its strategy for the region, alongside managing a team of Mena and NRI bankers, according to his LinkedIn profile.

Last November, HSBC reshuffled its senior management, appointing Selim Kervanci as its new CEO, Middle East, reporting to Surendra Rosha and David Liao, co-CEOs of Asia and the Middle East. Kervanci, who relocated to Dubai three months ago to take the new role, was previously Istanbul-based and CEO of HSBC Turkey.

The UAE continues to be a hotbed of private banking activity, attracting domestic and foreign players to set up shop as the wealth opportunity grows. However, some private banks are still in early stages, formulating their strategies as competition increases.

There have been a few recent private banking CEO exits in the region, including UBP's Mohamed Shoukry and Edmond de Rothschild's Ali Raza, who has since resurfaced at EFG.

This article was amended on 14 March at 5.40pm SGT to add comments from a spokesperson from HSBC.

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Standard Chartered Launches Private Markets Co-Investment Club for Ultra-High-Net-Worth Clients

Distributed by Contify.com

833 words

11 March 2025

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

- * Standard Chartered has launched a Private Markets Co-Investment Club for ultra-high-net-worth clients.

- * The club aims to provide unique access to sustainable growth opportunities across Asia, Africa, and the Middle East.

- * The bank's business model combines cross-border capabilities with wealth management expertise to offer clients global insights.

Original Press Release:

Singapore, March 11 -- Standard Chartered issued the following news release:

Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank** ("the **Private Bank**") has launched the Private Markets Co-Investment Club (CIC) to provide eligible ultra-high-net-worth (UHNW) clients with exclusive deal-by-deal access to manager-led private market co-investment opportunities globally.

The CIC addresses the growing demand from sophisticated investors for a resource-efficient approach to constructing institutional-grade private market portfolios, focusing on manager-led direct and co-investment opportunities. Clients who are CIC members benefit from access to institutional grade due diligence while retaining full discretion over their individual investment decisions. They can also access facilitated execution and transaction support, alongside reporting and progress updates at scheduled intervals.

For the inaugural launch of the CIC, Standard Chartered has entered into an exclusive partnership with Ardian, a world-leading private investment house, to provide programmatic access to private equity co-investment opportunities. Leveraging Ardian's extensive network and expertise, this collaboration delivers a structured flow of deals so that clients can gain access to a curated pipeline of high-quality, institutional-grade investments. This is a distinct advantage that the CIC brings to clients, opening doors to a wider range of market opportunities.

Raymond Ang, Global Head of **Private Bank** and Affluent Clients, Standard Chartered, said: "Ultra-high-net-worth individuals are increasingly looking beyond traditional investment solutions to access the private markets. We are disrupting the industry with the Co-Investment Club to offer our clients differentiated access to high-quality direct investment opportunities that are otherwise not readily available. This innovative approach leverages our global network and deep local expertise and reinforces our commitment to invest and enhance our capabilities as a leading international wealth manager."

Nicholas Cheng, Head of Private Markets Group, **Private Banking**, Standard Chartered, added: "Our ultra-high-net-worth clients are seeking greater control and transparency in their private market investments. Our partnership with Ardian via the Co-Investment Club offers a capital-efficient solution for clients to tap into industry-leading expertise for programmatic access to unique private market opportunities. This exclusive partnership levels up our offering to meet our client's evolving needs and deliver alpha for them."

Jan Philipp Schmitz, Executive Vice-President and Member of the Executive Committee at Ardian, commented: "We are committed to offering innovative solutions tailored to meet the unique needs of every private investor segment and enabling them to access high-quality private capital investments. This collaboration with Standard Chartered will provide investors with access to Ardian's market-leading co-investment platform, which is one of the largest globally. Through this strategic partnership, we are looking forward to meeting the evolving needs of our investors."

Standard Chartered's CIC is available to eligible clients in Singapore, Hong Kong, and the UAE, with plans for expansion to Jersey, UK. Eligibility is determined based on criteria set by the **Private Bank**.

Ardian

Ardian is a world-leading private investment house, managing or advising \$177bn of assets on behalf of more than 1,720 clients globally. Our broad expertise, spanning Private Equity, Real Assets and Credit, enables us to offer a wide range of investment opportunities and respond flexibly to our clients' differing needs. Through Ardian Customized Solutions we create bespoke portfolios that allow institutional clients to specify the precise mix of assets they require and to gain access to funds managed by leading third-party sponsors. Private Wealth Solutions offers dedicated services and access solutions for **private banks**, family offices and private institutional investors worldwide. Ardian's main shareholding group is its employees and we place great emphasis on developing its people and fostering a collaborative culture based on collective intelligence. Our 1,050+ employees, spread across 20 offices in Europe, the Americas, Asia and Middle East are strongly committed to the principles of Responsible Investment and are determined to make finance a force for good in society. Our goal is to deliver excellent investment performance combined with high ethical standards and social responsibility.

At Ardian we invest all of ourselves in building companies that last. ardian.com

Standard Chartered

We are a leading international banking group, with a presence in 53 of the world's most dynamic markets. Our purpose is to drive commerce and prosperity through our unique diversity, and our heritage and values are expressed in our brand promise, here for good.

Standard Chartered PLC is listed on the London and Hong Kong stock exchanges.

[Category: Banks, Asset Management/ Mutual Funds, Financial/ Capital Market, New Offerings, ESG]

Source: Standard Chartered

Document ATINBK0020250311e13b0008o

Stock in news

StanC keen to break with local banks, play wealth manager

Joel Rebello

509 words

11 March 2025

The Economic Times

ECTIM

English

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Mumbai: Lending will become secondary to Standard Chartered's (StanChart) retail business in India as the Anglo-Asian bank is moving away from single-product relationships and pivoting toward **wealth management**, a top executive told ET. "If mortgage is the only thing you want to do with us, then we will want to move away. In a single-product relationship, we can't really differentiate," said Judy Hsu, CEO of retail and **wealth management**. "In a single product relationship, personal loans, or single product mortgages we can't compete with local banks who can do much better than us." As the global head of wealth and retail banking, Hsu oversees assets of \$367 billion which grew 35% year-on-year in 2024, according to a presentation of the bank's annual results. Her business reported a pre-tax profit of \$2.4 billion.

The bank has set a target to attract \$200 billion of net new money over the next five years and achieve a double-digit compounded annual growth rate for wealth solutions-related income. Hsu said StanChart is also banking 100 billionaires of Indian origin across the world and about 30% of the net new money inflows in 2024 came from this segment. "Half of them are our clients here. Half of them are clients outside of India. In the overall global private bank across the world we have about 7000 clients, more than half of them are billionaires," Hsu said adding that with 30% of net new money, brisk GDP growth and a wide diaspora make India one of the bank's most important markets. As part of its focus on **wealth management** StanChart will convert 25 of its 100 branches in India to priority sectors to bank high-net-worth clients, changing some branch locations to get into prominent parts of the city. In the last two years, StanChart has added about 70 affluent banking relationship managers (RMs). In 2025, the bank plans to double its private banking RMs by adding 50 more people by June 2025. Priority Centres "Now that we have these priority centres, we see more clients coming into branches. The role of the branch is changing into more lifestyle. I think for now, we feel that we want to focus on upgrading them," she said. India now ranks sixth globally in ultra HNI population and third in Asia, trailing only China and Japan. The country's ultra HNI count reached 13,600 in 2024 and is projected to soar by 50% by 2028, according to a 2024 report by real estate consultancy firm Anarock, shared by StanChart. "In terms of the growth trajectory, people are becoming affluent. Clients here want to book in Singapore, Jersey or UAE. So the overall strategy of who we are, which is a network bank, an affluent bank, that doesn't change. But obviously, the nature of the clients in India is more domestic," Hsu said.

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Document ECTIM00020250311e13b0001x

Singapore's DBS courts rich Chinese with **wealth manager** hiring spree

Owen Walker in Singapore

613 words

6 March 2025

13:00

Financial Times (FT.Com)

FTCMA

English

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Expansion comes as other banks grow wary of customers from China after S\$3bn money-laundering scandal

DBS is dramatically increasing staff numbers in its **wealth management** business as Singapore's biggest bank tries to attract rich Chinese clients keen to move their money overseas.

The bank hired 80 relationship managers focused on the north Asia market in 2024, with nearly half based in Singapore. People with knowledge of its plans said it intended to recruit at least 30 more in the year ahead.

DBS is seeking to capitalise on Singapore's growing importance as an offshore centre for **wealth management** and on the city-state's booming family office sector.

Other global **wealth managers** in Singapore have become increasingly wary about accepting accounts from rich Chinese customers following a S\$3bn (US\$2.2bn) money-laundering scandal involving more than 20 individuals linked to a gang from China's Fujian province.

Singaporean authorities responded to the case by forcing banks to introduce tougher anti-money laundering checks on new customers, which have led to long delays in setting up client accounts.

DBS, however, has been expanding its **wealth management** business in the region, increasing the number of relationship managers by an average of 8 per cent a year since 2020 as other banks pull back.

Last year's hires brought DBS's total number of relationship managers to 850, with 130 additions planned this year, according to people with knowledge of the plans. More than a third of the group's **private bankers** serve clients in north Asia.

DBS became the second-biggest **wealth manager** in Asia outside China by number of relationship managers and third biggest by assets with the collapse of Credit Suisse two years ago, behind UBS and HSBC, according to Asian **Private Banker**.

"On the back of robust growth in wealth inflows into this region, we hired some 80 bankers last year to serve the needs of our clients in north Asia," said Joseph Poon, head of DBS's **private bank**. "The competition for talent has definitely intensified over the years."

Among the recent recruits to the north Asia desk — which largely covers mainland China but also Hong Kong and Taiwan — are Gloria Sun, who previously ran Deutsche Bank's north Asia team, and Raymond Cheung, a former Credit Suisse banker who joined from UBS.

Singapore has seen an influx of money from wealthy Chinese nationals in recent years, but the money-laundering scandal two years ago exposed lax vetting procedures at some banks.

Police seized billions of dollars' worth of high-end properties, luxury cars and jewellery — as well as assets in banks and crypto accounts — from criminals linked to scams and illegal gambling operations.

DBS has also increased the number of relationship managers catering to Russian customers, while other banks have pulled back from that market since Moscow's full-scale invasion of Ukraine three years ago and the imposition of sanctions on high-profile Russians. The number of Russian-speaking DBS bankers in Singapore has risen to nine.

Thailand is another market where DBS is seeking to win new clients, with a plan to double the number of relationship managers focused on the country by next year.

The **private bank** was one of the key drivers of the record annual profits DBS reported last month, with **wealth management** fees rising 45 per cent to S\$2.2bn.

The focus on growing the **private bank** comes as Tan Su Shan, who ran DBS's **wealth management** business for a decade, is set to take over as group chief executive this month.

Document FTCMA00020250306el36000p1

Standard Chartered opens first wealth centre for Mena region

Priyanka Boghani

280 words

4 March 2025

Citywire Middle East

CWIRME

English

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Standard Chartered has launched its first 'Priority Private' centre in the Middle East, Europe and Africa (Mena) region, dedicated to providing wealth management for high net worth individuals.

By leveraging Standard Chartered's network, including wealth hubs in the UAE, Singapore, Hong Kong, Jersey (UK), and India, the Priority Private centre also offers clients access to a range of international investment opportunities, multi-market lending facilities, and tailored wealth solutions. The centre also has rooms for key international corridors, including Africa, India, China, Singapore and Jersey/UK, the bank said.

'The UAE's strategic location as a global financial hub makes it the ideal choice for this initiative,' said Rajesh Kannan, head of wealth and retail banking UAE and head of international banking EMEA, Jersey and Global Indian at Standard Chartered.

'The growing demand for cross-border wealth solutions requires a seamless and innovative approach. Our Priority Private centre represents a step forward in how we serve our clients, offering them the tools and expertise they need to navigate the complexities of global financial markets.'

The launch is part of the bank's ambitions to expand its wealth and affluent segment globally.

It comes after a year of heavy recruiting where the British lender [bolstered](#) its private banking front office by 20%, making big hires such as Momin Jaffar, HSBC's former UAE-based private banking head.

The bank also set the ambitious target of attracting \$200bn in net new money and double-digit growth in its wealth solutions over the next five years, with a focus on global Chinese and Indians stationed in Singapore, Hong Kong, the UAE and Jersey.

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Standard Chartered opens first wealth centre for Mena region

Priyanka Boghani

280 words

4 March 2025

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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'The UAE's strategic location as a global financial hub makes it the ideal choice for this initiative,' said Rajesh Kannan, head of wealth and retail banking UAE and head of international banking EMEA, Jersey and Global Indian at Standard Chartered.

'The growing demand for cross-border wealth solutions requires a seamless and innovative approach. Our Priority Private centre represents a step forward in how we serve our clients, offering them the tools and expertise they need to navigate the complexities of global financial markets.'

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The bank also set the ambitious target of attracting \$200bn in net new money and double-digit growth in its wealth solutions over the next five years, with a focus on global Chinese and Indians stationed in Singapore, Hong Kong, the UAE and Jersey.

Document CWIRAS0020250310e13400008



Standard Chartered bolsters frontline private banking team in UAE

153 words

4 March 2025

19:32

SeeNews Banking

SEBNK

English

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March 4 (SeeNews) - UK lender Standard Chartered Plc (LON:STAN) has unveiled a 20% increase in its frontline private banking team in the UAE.

The move is part of the bank's broader strategy to double its investment in the affluent business over the next five years, with a significant focus on the UAE. It reinforces its commitment to meeting the rising demand for bespoke wealth management services in the region, Standard Chartered said in a statement on Friday.

"Expanding our private banking team in the UAE reflects our confidence in the country's unique role as a global wealth hub," commented Vinay Gandhi of Standard Chartered Global Private Bank.

As part of the expansion, Momin Jaffar has been appointed managing director, group head, bringing over 15 years of experience in private banking, most recently serving as head of private banking for the UAE at HSBC.

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Business

Standard Chartered to open sixth Hong Kong wealth centre, increase headcount: Mary Huen

Enoch Yiu

727 words

3 March 2025

scmp.com

SCMCOM

English

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Hong Kong is a key market for the bank to achieve its goal of accumulating US\$200 billion of net new money in the next five years

Standard Chartered, one of Hong Kong's three note-issuing banks, will continue to hire additional private bankers and open more new **wealth management** centres in the city as part of its ambition to garner US\$200 billion of new money from affluent clients over the next five years, according to a top executive.

"Affluent **wealth management** and cross-border businesses have been, and continue to be, our twin growth engines in Hong Kong," Mary Huen Wai-yi, CEO of Hong Kong, Greater China and North Asia, said in a media briefing last week.

Standard Chartered this year will open its sixth cross-border **wealth management** centre in the city, she said. The bank currently operates five such facilities to serve high-net-worth clients, including in the tourist hotspot of Tsim Sha Tsui.

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"We have found that high-net-worth and affluent clients respond positively to these cross-border **wealth management** centres," she said. "We have already set up such centres in Taiwan and Shanghai in recent years [and] we are considering similar centres in Greater Bay Area cities such as Shenzhen and Guangzhou."

The bank would continue to hire more wealth experts, she added, noting that it had already hired some 100 relationship managers in Hong Kong last year to serve high-net-worth customers.

The recruitments were part of the lender's US\$1.5 billion investment in the **wealth-management** business over the next five years, with Hong Kong set to be the focus of the expansion, group CEO Bill Winters said in a media briefing on February 21 to announce the full-year results.

A robust growth in services for affluent clients drove Standard Chartered's profit up by 19 per cent in 2024, prompting Winters to set an ambitious goal of garnering US\$200 billion of net new money in the next five years.

Hong Kong figures prominently in the bank's growth plan. Underlying pre-tax profit in the city last year jumped by 24 per cent to a record US\$2.3 billion, representing 34 per cent of the total, making Hong Kong the bank's biggest market.

This was driven by a 9 per cent growth in the number of affluent clients in 2024, with net new money from these clients jumping 64 per cent, Huen said.

Another growth engine Standard Chartered is banking on in Hong Kong is the cross-border corporate banking business.

"We have seen an increasing number of corporate clients in Hong Kong and mainland China keen on expanding in Asean and the Middle East where Standard Chartered has a strong network," Huen said. "The companies want to establish a manufacturing base in Asean and sell some of their products in the Middle East."

She said the bank was fast adding clients from the new economy sector, mainly companies operating in solar energy, electric vehicles, biotech and healthcare.

On Friday, Standard Chartered was added to a group of 24 lenders, which would receive half of the funds from a 100 billion yuan (US\$13.8 billion) trade-financing facility launched by the Hong Kong Monetary Authority.

Under the scheme, banks can get funding from the facility at a cost based on the onshore yuan interest rate plus a premium to support trade settlement for their customers, who can arrange funding for one, three and six-month periods.

Huen said the trade finance facility would promote Hong Kong's yuan business, while the improved market sentiment would also encourage clients to seek loans to fund expansion.

"Overall, [we are] cautiously optimistic about our growth in Hong Kong this year, as our clients have been more active in making investment decisions amid a lower interest-rate environment since September," she said.

"With expectations of two more rate cuts between a quarter to half a percentage point this year, it would lead to more loan demand."

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Business

Former HSBC CEO Quinn to join Julius Baer as chairman in May

Enoch Yiu

572 words

1 March 2025

scmp.com

SCMCOM

English

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Quinn's experience at HSBC could help Julius Baer tap the fast-growing Asian market, one analyst says

Former HSBC CEO [Noel Quinn](#) will join Swiss wealth manager Julius Baer Group as its next chairman in May, pending shareholder approval, according to a company statement on Friday.

The board of directors at Julius Baer will nominate Quinn for election as its new non-executive chairman at the annual general meeting on April 10, replacing Romeo Lacher, who is not seeking re-election.

Quinn, a British banking veteran who turned 63 in January, will assume his new role on May 1 due to prior commitments, according to Julius Baer. The appointment marks his first move since stepping down as HSBC CEO in September, passing the leadership to [Georges Elhedery](#). Quinn spent 37 years at HSBC, including the last five years as its global CEO.

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"It is a real privilege to be nominated to take on the chair role of the largest pure-play wealth manager and one with such a great heritage," Quinn said in the statement.

"Having spent over 37 years in the international financial services sector, I am looking forward to working with the board and management team to capitalise on the many exciting opportunities ahead of us."

Zurich-based Julius Baer, which traces its roots back to 1890, managed 480 billion Swiss francs (US\$531 billion) worth of assets as of the end of October, according to its financial report. The firm operates in 60 markets worldwide, including key locations in Asia such as Hong Kong, Singapore, Shanghai and Tokyo.

"Quinn's appointment will help Julius Baer tap into the fast-growing Asian market, as he had led HSBC's expansion in the region," said Kenny Ng Lai-yin, a strategist at Everbright Securities International.

"Asia is the fastest-growing area for high-net-worth clients. It is natural to see the Swiss lender join the wave of international financial firms appointing heavyweight bankers like Quinn to leverage the Asian growth story."

While HSBC is based in London, the 160-year-old lender earns most of its revenue in Asia.

"Noel's appointment is a testament to the strength of the Julius Baer franchise; he is an exceptional candidate who brings an international mindset and strong cultural values to the role," said vice-chairman Richard Campbell-Breeden, who serves as interim chairman until April 30.

"His expertise will be an invaluable addition to the board as we enter a new phase of the company's growth and development."

Quinn is expected to work with Julius Baer's newly appointed CEO, Stefan Bollinger, to develop new strategies for the lender. The reshuffle came after the lender in February 2024 reported 586 million Swiss francs in losses on loans to Signa, the property firm owned by disgraced Austrian tycoon René Benko.

Bollinger joined Julius Baer in January after former CEO Philipp Rickenbacher stepped down last year.

Julius Baer has [expanded its Hong Kong operations](#) in recent years. In April 2023, it opened a new office in Quarry Bay to better serve high-net-worth clients and family offices.

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HSBC: Wealthiest investors expand global footprint as Singapore emerges as a top destination

Distributed by Contify.com

563 words

28 February 2025

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* Singapore ranks 1st among 23 countries as the top destination for HNW individuals considering relocation, according to HSBC's Global Wealth Hubs: Drivers of Diversification 2025 report.

* Singapore has thrived as an international wealth hub, with the number of Single **Family Offices** (SFOs) growing from 400 in 2020 to 1,650 as of September 2024.

* The Singapore-India wealth corridor is the third largest, with 19% of Indian entrepreneurs planning to move assets to Singapore in the next 12 months.

Original Press Release:

Feb. 28 -- HSBC Group issued the following news release:

HSBC's Global Wealth Hubs: Drivers of Diversification 2025 report shows how wealthy business owners share a global mindset – where national and regional borders are viewed as opportunities.

The study, which surveyed high-net-worth (HNW) and ultra-high-net-worth (UHNW) entrepreneurs, highlights how key global wealth hubs—Singapore, Hong Kong, Switzerland, the UK, and the US—continue to attract investment and residence from entrepreneurs worldwide.

Singapore has thrived as an international wealth hub in recent decades, particularly with the region's entrepreneurs:

* Ranked 1st among 23 countries as the top destination for HNW individuals considering relocation.

* The Singapore-India wealth corridor is the third largest in our research with 19 per cent Indian entrepreneurs planning to move assets to Singapore in the next 12 months.

* A growing center for **family offices** & philanthropy: The number of Single **Family Offices** (SFOs) in Singapore has grown from 400 in 2020 to 1,650 as of September 2024, reinforcing its status as a key destination for global wealth management.

Alongside Singapore, four other wealth hubs continue to play a central role in global asset diversification:

* Hong Kong ranks top for business owners with multi-residency. It also forms part of the biggest wealth corridor in our research, with 49 per cent of Hong Kong entrepreneurs having an additional residency in mainland China, while 37 per cent from mainland China have one in Hong Kong.

* Switzerland retains its broad appeal across all ages and levels of wealth. It ranks first for entrepreneurs seeking to move their personal wealth to a new location over the next 12 months.

* The UK is home to the largest percentage of multi-resident entrepreneurs surveyed in Western markets and is the most popular location for the oldest and the wealthiest surveyed entrepreneurs considering taking up residency.

* The US remains a magnet for the world's wealthy and business owners, ranking equal first alongside Singapore in the survey of 23 cited markets for HNW entrepreneurs considering it as a location to establish part or all of their business.

Tommy Leung, Head of Global Private Banking, South Asia, HSBC, said: "Singapore has firmly established itself as a wealth hub of choice for entrepreneurs across Asia, attracting global investors who value its financial stability and strong regional connectivity. The increasing wealth flows into Singapore, particularly from India, mainland China, Hong Kong, and Taiwan, highlight its growing role in facilitating cross-border wealth planning and business expansion. As Singapore continues to evolve, we see a growing emphasis on geographical and asset diversifications, alternative investments and philanthropy, reinforcing its appeal to UHNW entrepreneurs looking to leave a lasting legacy."

[Category: Asset Management/ Mutual Funds, Financial/ Capital Market, Retail/ Commercial Banks, Business Expansion, ESG]

Source: HSBC Group

Document ATINBK0020250319e12s000ed

Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank** expands frontline bankers by 20 percent in the UAE

Distributed by Contify.com

884 words

28 February 2025

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

- * Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank** has expanded its frontline bankers in the UAE.

- * The bank offers unique access to sustainable growth opportunities across Asia, Africa, and the Middle East through its network.

- * Its business model combines cross-border capabilities with **wealth management** expertise to support clients' growth across borders.

Original Press Release:

Dubai, United Arab Emirates, Feb. 28 -- Standard Chartered issued the following news release:

- Part of a broader strategy to double its investment in the affluent business over the next five years

Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank** announced today the expansion of its frontline **private banking** team by 20% in the UAE. This move underscores the Bank's unwavering commitment to supporting the growing demand for bespoke **private banking** solutions in one of the world's most prominent financial hubs.

The investment in the **private banking** business in the UAE is part of Standard Chartered's broader strategy to double its investment in the consistently fast-growing and high-returning affluent business over the next five years, with the UAE playing a pivotal role in these efforts. As a gateway to international markets and a hub for innovation, the UAE offers unparalleled opportunities for clients seeking stability and global connectivity.

Commenting on the appointments, Vinay Gandhi, Global Head of GSAC and Regional Head of AMEE, Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank**, said: "Expanding our **private banking** team in the UAE reflects our confidence in the country's unique role as a global wealth hub. With its strategic location, world-class infrastructure, and forward-looking economic policies, the UAE continues to attract HNW and UHNW clients seeking stability and growth. This growing demand for bespoke **private banking** solutions is driving our commitment to further enhance our capabilities in the UAE, positioning us as a trusted partner that seamlessly connects clients to global markets and investment opportunities while helping them protect, manage, and grow their wealth."

He added: "The UAE continues to be a priority market for Standard Chartered, with the bank actively investing in talent and resources to meet the needs of its high and ultra-high-net-worth clients. This latest expansion reflects the bank's strategy to remain at the forefront of **private banking**, leveraging its global network and local expertise to provide unparalleled services to this growing client segment."

Standard Chartered's focus on expanding its presence in key markets like the UAE highlights its dedication to delivering tailored **private banking** solution and building lasting partnerships with clients. In addition to this expansion, the Global **Private Bank** announced earlier this year over a dozen new hires, and today's new hires aligns with its ambition to consistently build up capabilities to support the needs of high and ultra-high net worth (HNW and UHNW) clients.

Key UAE Appointments

The following colleagues will report to Nash Mithani, Market Head, **Private Banking**, UAE, and Head, Global South Asia Community:

Momin Jaffar joined as Managing Director, Group Head. He has over 15 years banking experience which was built during his tenure in HSBC in the UAE. While he started with commercial banking, Momin spent the last 10 years honing his relationship management skills in **private banking**. He was most recently Head of **Private Banking** for the UAE at HSBC.

Hamza Zahid and Zein Chaudhry joined as Executive Director, Relationship Managers. Hamad brings nearly 15 years of **wealth management** and **private banking** experience which was honed during his tenure at HSBC in the UAE and Pakistan. Zein started his banking career with HSBC in the UK as a financial advisor before relocating to the UAE to further his career in **wealth management** and **private banking** with the Bank.

Ahmed Anabtawi joined us as Executive Director – Team Leader. He is an accomplished **Private Banking** professional with over 25 years of experience in the financial services industry, working within Banks at Mashreq, QIB, Emirates NBD, HSBC and Jordan Gulf Bank.

Mahmoud Elsgaei joined as Director, Relationship Manager. Mahmoud has over 10 years of experience in **wealth management** and **private banking**, most recently managing private wealth for HNWs at ADCB.

Alasdair Scarr joined as Executive Director. He is an accomplished **Private Banking** professional with over 35 years of experience in the financial services industry, working within **Private Banks** at HSBC, Deutsche, and Citibank.

Samar Zarifeh joined us as Director. She is a passionate **private banker** professional with over 20 years of experience in the financial industry working with banks like Mashreq, ADCB, and CIBC (Canada), as well as non-financial roles at Emaar and Du.

Hamsah Fadhil joined us as Director. She is a seasoned and highly accomplished **private banker** professional with over two decades of dedicated service in the financial industry working with banks like Mashreq, ADCB, RBS, ABN AMRO, and CIBC (Canada).

Standard Chartered

We are a leading international banking group, with a presence in 53 of the world's most dynamic markets. Our purpose is to drive commerce and prosperity through our unique diversity, and our heritage and values are expressed in our brand promise, here for good.

Standard Chartered PLC is listed on the London and Hong Kong stock exchanges.

[Category: Banks, Asset Management/ Mutual Funds, Financial/ Capital Market, Business Expansion, ESG]

Source: Standard Chartered

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Finance

HSBC Reportedly Says Pinnacle Project Is Completed About Reports It Will Cut 900 Workers at China Unit

Liao Shumin

329 words

28 February 2025

Yicai Global

YICAIG

English

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(Yicai) Feb. 28 -- Regarding reports that HSBC Holdings will let go of 900 employees at its digital **wealth management** business in China, the UK banking giant said the Pinnacle project has been successfully completed, according to a new report.

HSBC now offers mobile, integrated insurance and investment services through the wealth planning team under HSBC Insurance Brokers, The Paper reported today, citing a Pinnacle spokesperson as saying yesterday.

HSBC is reducing staff numbers at its China digital wealth business Pinnacle by nearly half, Reuters reported yesterday, citing two sources. The move is a sharp reversal of its ambition for the unit as part of its expansion in that country, it added.

HSBC is committed to becoming the preferred international **wealth management** institution for mass affluent and high-net-worth clients in the Chinese mainland, the spokesperson noted, adding that the bank holds a long-term strategic commitment to China and considers it a priority development market.

"We will continue to invest in expanding our client acquisition and service channels through relationship managers at our service points, mobile wealth planners, and digital tools while broadening the **wealth management** solutions we offer to our clients," the spokesperson said.

Pinnacle was launched in 2020 to develop mobile wealth planning services aimed at helping HSBC acquire clients beyond its bank branches. It previously said that it employs 1,700 **wealth management** managers.

HSBC's **wealth management** investment assets in the Chinese mainland surged 61 percent last year from the year before.

HSBC has sought to control costs better since Georges Eihedery stepped in as chief executive officer last September. Reports emerged a month later that the company is evaluating Pinnacle's operating costs and management structure, which may involve staff cuts.

Pinnacle reported a net loss of USD46 million in the first half of last year.

Editor: Martin Kadiev

[Click here to view image.](#)

Document YICAIG0020250228e12s00032

HSBC Private Banking: Wealthiest investors spread the net wider

Distributed by Contify.com

697 words

27 February 2025

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* **Global Mobility of Wealthy Investors:** The world's wealthiest investors are increasingly becoming more mobile, planning additional residences globally and seeking opportunities for their assets and businesses in international markets.

* **HSBC's Global Wealth Hubs Report:** The Global Wealth Hubs: Drivers of Diversification 2025 report explores how high net worth (HNW) and ultra-high net worth (UHNW) entrepreneurs view national and regional borders as opportunities rather than obstacles. It focuses on five key global wealth hubs.

* **Hong Kong:** Leads in multi-residency among business owners, with 49% of Hong Kong entrepreneurs having an additional residency in mainland China. It also forms part of the largest wealth corridor in the research

Original Press Release:

Feb. 27 -- HSBC **Private Banking** issued the following news release:

The world's wealthiest investors are becoming more mobile as they plan for additional residences around the world and seek out global opportunities for their assets and businesses.

HSBC's Global Wealth Hubs: Drivers of Diversification 2025 report shows how wealthy business owners share a global mindset – where national and regional borders are viewed as opportunities rather than obstacles.

The report is based on an analysis of a survey of high net worth (HNW) and ultra high net worth (UHNW) entrepreneurs on their attitudes towards their wealth and businesses in international markets. It focuses on five key global wealth hubs – each with their unique attractions, but which complement each other:

Hong Kong: Hong Kong ranks top for business owners with multi-residency. It also forms part of the biggest wealth corridor in our research, with 49 per cent of Hong Kong entrepreneurs having an additional residency in mainland China

Singapore: Singapore has thrived as an international wealth hub in recent decades, particularly with the region's entrepreneurs. The Singapore-India wealth corridor is the third largest in our research

Switzerland: Switzerland retains its broad appeal across all ages and levels of wealth. It ranks first for entrepreneurs seeking to move their personal wealth to a new location over the next 12 months

UK: The UK is home to the largest percentage of multi-resident entrepreneurs surveyed in Western markets, and is the most popular location for the oldest and the wealthiest surveyed entrepreneurs considering taking up residency

US: The US remains a magnet for the world's wealthy and business owners, ranking equal first alongside Singapore in the survey of 23 cited markets for HNW entrepreneurs considering it as a location to establish part or all of their business

Willem Sels, Chief Investment Officer of HSBC Global **Private Banking** and Wealth, said: "We see no sign of deglobalisation from an investment perspective. In fact, entrepreneurs' desire to access opportunities outside their home markets is growing at a time when many respective governments are adopting a more domestic bias from an economic or trade perspective. Diversification is all about opening up opportunities."

About Global Wealth Hubs: Drivers of Diversification 2025

The findings are based on extensive research conducted by Ipsos UK on behalf of HSBC among 1,798 high net worth business owners with at least USD2 million of investable assets. A third (583) were ultra high net worth with a net worth of more than USD100 million. The research was conducted online in mainland China, France, Hong Kong, India, Singapore, Switzerland, Taiwan, UAE, UK and US. See the report for the full methodology.

About HSBC Global **Private Banking**

HSBC Global **Private Banking** helps clients manage, grow and preserve their wealth for generations to come. Its network of global experts helps clients access investment opportunities around the world, plan for the future with wealth and succession planning, manage their portfolio with tailored solutions, and find the right support for their philanthropy. www.privatebanking.hsbc.com.

About HSBC Holdings plc

HSBC Holdings plc, the parent company of HSBC, is headquartered in London. HSBC serves customers worldwide from offices in 58 countries and territories. With assets of USD3,017 billion at 31 December 2024, HSBC is one of the world's largest banking and financial services organisations.

[Category: Asset Management/ Mutual Funds, Financial/ Capital Market, Retail/ Commercial Banks]

Source: HSBC **Private Banking**

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Business

HSBC to invest more in Asia as COst cuts begin

Enoch Yiu

802 words

20 February 2025

South China Morning Post

SCMP

B1

English

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Lender will redeploy US\$1.5 billion from 'low-return' markets as it reduces investment banking and capital markets activities in US, UK and Europe

HSBC Holdings has said it will invest more resources in Hong Kong's **wealth-management** products and services in the coming years, as the city's biggest commercial bank restructures to cut costs and grow in its largest market in terms of revenue.

The 160-year-old bank planned to redeploy US\$1.5 billion from "low-return" markets to Hong Kong and other parts of Asia, HSBC's CEO Georges Elhedery said yesterday after unveiling a 2 per cent growth in 2024 net profit.

As part of the plan, HSBC has started to scale down its investment banking and capital markets activities in the US, Britain and Europe. It also plans to sell its private bank in Germany and its insurance business in France.

"We will reinvest these funds in our areas of growth, namely in **wealth [management]** in Asia, particularly Hong Kong", Elhedery said via an online media briefing, in his first set of annual financial results since taking the helm in September from Noel Quinn.

"Hong Kong is on track to becoming the world's largest cross-border wealth hub, [inasmuch] as Hong Kong is also a global financial centre. There are definitely a lot of investments that we will put in this market to support the growth here."

The London-based bank, one of Europe's largest by assets, generates most of its revenue from Asia – particularly Hong Kong – which is its largest market.

"We are very positive about the Hong Kong economic outlook", Elhedery said, after kicking off his presentation with Lunar New Year greetings in Mandarin.

"We had a fantastic franchise in Hong Kong where we have grown our customer base by adding 800,000 new customers."

Pre-tax profit from the bank's Hong Kong operations, including its Hang Seng Bank unit, grew 9.5 per cent last year to US\$11.69 billion. HSBC's 2024 pre-tax profit rose 6.6 per cent to US\$32.3 billion, surpassing the consensus market estimate of US\$31.7 billion.

Net profit rose 2.2 per cent to US\$22.9 billion, or US\$1.25 per share, missing the US\$24.1 billion expected in an analysts' consensus collated by Bloomberg. Still, the net profit was in line with the US\$22.67 billion consensus expected in HSBC's in-house survey of 18 analysts.

Besides Hong Kong, HSBC would invest more in Singapore, mainland China and India, where the bank was a key provider of **wealth management** services, he said.

"We are also looking to invest more in small and medium-sized enterprises in the UK," Elhedery said, adding that the lender would also invest more in artificial intelligence (AI) and generative AI to enhance productivity.

HSBC also unveiled a new US\$2 billion share buy-back programme, matching the same amount announced a year earlier. The bank spent US\$9 billion in 2023 on share buy-backs.

The bank will pay 36 US cents per share in fourth-quarter dividends, bringing the total for 2024 to 87 US cents, more than the 61 US cents paid in 2023. HSBC shares rose 1.4 per cent to close at HK\$88.40.

"Since becoming CEO, I have focused on simplifying how we operate and injecting energy and intent into the way we deliver our strategy", Elhedery said.

"We are creating a simple, more agile [and] focused bank built on our core strengths."

Pre-tax profit rose 133 per cent to US\$2.3 billion during the fourth quarter. The gain came after HSBC took a US\$3 billion impairment charge in the same period in 2023 from the sale of its stake in Bank of Communications.

The group's total revenue fell 0.3 per cent last year to US\$65.8 billion from US\$66.1 billion a year earlier. Net interest margin, an important measure of profitability, fell 10 basis points from a year earlier to 1.56 per cent, due to interest rate cuts since September.

Elhedery announced a plan to generate US\$300 million in cost cuts this year and US\$1.5 billion of savings by the end of 2026, as he reorganises the top echelons of the bank. To achieve that, HSBC planned to incur US\$1.8 billion in severance and other upfront costs by 2026, he added.

"The costs [saved] represent about 8 per cent of our staff cost, but [there] will be fewer people affected because [the cuts apply] to senior people, [and are] therefore weighted towards the higher earners," Elhedery said.

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Document SCMP000020250219e12k0000i

Maktoum bin Mohammed meets with Chairman of Bank of Singapore

326 words

17 February 2025

Arab News Releases

ARABNE

English

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17 Feb 2025 (Wam) H.H. Sheikh Maktoum bin Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum, First Deputy Ruler of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Finance of the UAE, met with Andrew Lee, Chairman of Bank of Singapore and Group Chairman of Oversea-Chinese Banking Corporation (OCBC).

The meeting reviewed cooperation with Bank of Singapore, a leading **private bank** and the dedicated **private banking** arm of OCBC Bank, one of the largest financial institutions in Southeast Asia. Discussions highlighted the bank's growing ties with Dubai following its establishment in the Dubai International Financial Centre (DIFC) in 2016, as well as its vision for expanding operations in the region from Dubai. The emirate's advanced financial infrastructure and extensive support for financial institutions have reinforced its position as a leading global hub for finance and business.

The meeting highlighted Dubai's commitment to enhancing cooperation with leading global financial institutions, reinforcing its status as a trusted business hub. It also discussed the emirate's innovative financial policies that support sustainable growth and the role of banks in financing strategic projects and advancing financial technology.

The discussions further explored the incentives and advantages offered by the UAE and Dubai to financial institutions, including world-class infrastructure and a robust regulatory framework that ensures an optimal environment for businesses to succeed.

The meeting was attended by Helal Saeed Al Marri, Director General of Dubai's Department of Economy and Tourism; Essa Kazim, Governor of DIFC; Hesham Abdulla Al Qassim, Vice Chairman and Managing Director of Emirates NBD; Mohammad Ali Rashed Lootah, President and CEO of Dubai Chambers; and Arif Amiri, CEO of DIFC Authority.

Bank of Singapore is a leading **private bank** specialising in wealth management solutions, with assets under management increasing from \$20 billion in 2010 to \$116 billion as of September 2023. The bank offers a comprehensive range of financial services, including investment advisory, wealth planning, and trust solutions

Document ARABNE0020250218e12h0006j

The Korea Times

SC Bank Korea launches global **wealth management** campaign

238 words

12 February 2025

Korea Times

KORTIM

English

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By Lee Yeon-wooA promotional image of Standard Chartered (SC) Bank Korea's global management campaign, "Now's your time for wealth" / Courtesy of SC Bank Korea

Standard Chartered (SC) Bank Korea launched its global management campaign, "Now's your time for wealth," the company said Wednesday. The campaign encourages the public to start investing globally to protect and grow their assets for future generations.

This campaign will run simultaneously in seven key markets where SC Group operates — Korea, Singapore, Hong Kong, China, Taiwan, the UAE and India.

As part of the campaign, an event will run until March 31 for customers beginning their investment journey. Customers who do not currently hold fund products at SC Bank Korea can receive benefits by subscribing through the bank's branches or mobile banking service.

SC Bank Korea stated that it will leverage its domestic **wealth management** expertise alongside SC Group's global investment capabilities, built over 170 years across 52 markets worldwide.

"This campaign reflects SC Bank Korea's commitment to supporting customers throughout their investment journey, helping them grow their wealth and achieve their financial goals across the present, future and next generations." Chang Ho-june, executive vice president of SC Bank Korea, said.

"We encourage customers to experience global-**wealth management**, featuring diversified asset management solutions and advanced investment advisory services that are not easily found in the domestic market."

Document KORTIM0020250212el2c0000t

Business

Standard Chartered Bank Korea launches global asset management campaign

283 words

12 February 2025

The Korea Herald

KORHER

English

(c) 2025 The Korea Herald

Standard Chartered Bank Korea announced Wednesday the launch of a new campaign, "Now's Your Time for Wealth," aimed at providing customized investment solutions leveraging the bank's international expertise and global network.

The campaign highlights the importance of long-term global investment and offers tailored **wealth management** services designed to benefit future generations.

"With over 170 years of global asset management experience and a team of international investment professionals across 52 markets, we provide a distinctive approach to global **wealth management**," the bank stated.

Launched simultaneously in seven major markets -- South Korea, Singapore, Hongkong, China, Taiwan, UAE and India -- the campaign will feature digital advertisements across various platforms until the end of April.

The "Now Asset Management Event," which is part of the campaign, will run through March 31. Participants can receive exclusive rewards: Those who register for funds with an investment of 1 million won (\$689.39) or more will receive a mobile coupon, while those investing 30 million won or more will be granted an additional coupon.

Jang Ho-jun, executive vice president of SC Bank Korea, expressed hope for the promotion, stating, "We are happy to accompany our customers on a long-lasting investment journey, helping them achieve asset growth and their financial objectives." He added, "We hope our customers experience diversified solutions that meet their needs, which are specially tailored to the domestic market."

With this campaign, SC Bank Korea aims to reinforce its position as a leading provider of global **wealth management** services, empowering customers with long-term investment solutions.

[A digital ad for SC Bank Korea's "Now's Your Time for Wealth" campaign \(SC Bank\)](#)

Document KORHER0020250212el2c00105

Singapore's DBS reports record profits as long-serving chief bows out

Owen Walker in Singapore

432 words

10 February 2025

10:12

Financial Times (FT.Com)

FTCMA

English

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City-state's biggest lender buoyed by strong commercial and **wealth management** performances

Piyush Gupta, DBS's long-serving chief executive, signed off his 16-year tenure at south-east Asia's biggest bank with record profits announced on Monday.

DBS reported an 11 per cent increase in 2024 profits to S\$11.4bn (\$8.4bn) — in line with analysts' estimates — buoyed by stronger performance in its commercial bank and **wealth management** businesses. It predicted net interest income in 2025 would be slightly above 2024 levels.

The Singaporean bank, the region's largest by assets, increased its dividend payout to S\$6.3bn, up 27 per cent on 2023, having already announced a S\$3bn share buyback programme.

Gupta, with one of the longest tenures of any chief executive at a major bank, is due to retire at DBS's annual meeting in March, having joined from Citigroup in 2009.

"While macroeconomic and geopolitical uncertainties persist, the franchise and digital transformations carried out over the past decade position us well to continue delivering healthy returns," Gupta said.

He is due to be succeeded next month by his deputy, Tan Su Shan.

"As I reflect on my journey at DBS, I feel good about where the bank is and am confident it will reach further heights under Su Shan's leadership," he added.

The bank benefited from a 5 per cent rise in net interest income in its commercial business to S\$15bn last year, thanks to a higher net interest margin and its bigger balance sheet. Loans and deposits rose by 3 per cent and 4 per cent respectively. Fees in the commercial bank increased by 23 per cent to S\$4.2bn.

DBS also enjoyed a rise in consumer banking and **wealth management**, with the division increasing income by 13 per cent to S\$10.2bn, as a result of higher net interest income, **wealth management** fees and card fees.

One downside for the bank was a 4 per cent increase in non-performing loans in the final quarter to S\$5bn, yet analysts at Citigroup said "overall asset quality was benign".

In November, DBS unveiled a S\$3bn share buyback programme as the bank looks to return excess capital to shareholders. Over the past five years, it has doubled its ordinary dividend.

Shares in DBS — Singapore's most valuable company — have risen more than 50 per cent in the past year. Its shares rose more than 3 per cent at the market open on Monday.

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Standard Chartered Launches Industry-First AI-Powered FX Insights

Distributed by Contify.com

774 words

6 February 2025

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

- * Standard Chartered launched an AI-powered video column called 'Standard Chartered **Wealth Management** FX Intelligent Expert' in collaboration with LSEG.

- * This initiative provides real-time FX market insights to clients in an easily digestible format.

- * The AI-driven solution converts insights from the Bank's Daily Market Navigator into one-minute videos with voiceover and visuals.

Original Press Release:

Singapore, Feb. 6 -- Standard Chartered issued the following news release:

Standard Chartered today announced the launch of an innovative AI-powered video column, the “Standard Chartered **Wealth Management** FX Intelligent Expert” for clients across its key markets. The feature leverages advanced artificial intelligence technology in collaboration with LSEG (London Stock Exchange Group). This industry-first initiative represents a significant step forward in delivering real-time, easily digestible FX market insights directly to clients, underscoring Standard Chartered’s commitment to client-centric innovation and leadership in digital-first wealth solutions.

Building on insights drawn from the Bank’s Daily Market Navigator – an authoritative market publication produced by Standard Chartered’s Global Chief Investment Office – this new solution applies AI-driven summarisation, translates the material where necessary, and automatically converts the summarised insights into an engaging one-minute video with voiceover and relevant visuals.

Following its December 2024 debut for retail clients in Mainland China, plans are now in place to roll out the service in the coming months in Singapore, Hong Kong and Taiwan.

Foreign exchange investments are a crucial component of diversified asset allocation, yet many investors struggle to stay abreast of the rapidly changing market. The “Standard Chartered **Wealth Management** FX Intelligent Expert” aims to overcome this challenge by providing faster time to market, scalability, and cost efficiency.

Clients benefit from an improved experience through dynamic, on-demand video updates that are both interactive and accessible, enabling them to understand crucial market movements and potential trade opportunities more easily. This engaging communication platform positions Standard Chartered at the forefront of the banking industry’s adoption of new technologies that further enhance client advisory services.

The Bank’s leadership in adopting such cutting-edge technology underscores its broader strategy to enhance its wealth capability across key markets, helping clients make more informed decisions and driving increased opportunities for FX transactions. For Standard Chartered, the initiative solidifies its position as the preferred partner for foreign exchange activities and demonstrates how harnessing AI and digital innovation can lead to deeper client engagement, thereby cementing its position as a leading international **wealth manager**.

Samir Subberwal, Global Head, Wealth Solutions, Deposits and Mortgages, and Chief Client Officer at Standard Chartered, said: “We are delighted to collaborate with LSEG to bring this pioneering AI-powered FX video insight service to our clients in our key markets. By transforming our Global Chief Investment Office’s expert views into easily digestible, high-quality videos, we offer our clients access to timely market insights wherever they are,

reinforcing our commitment to technological innovation and personalised wealth solutions that meet evolving needs.”

Sneha Manohar, Head of Strategic Accounts, APAC, LSEG, commented: “We are proud to work with Standard Chartered on this innovative use of artificial intelligence in the banking industry. Our technological solutions help refine complex FX market data into accessible video content, empowering investors to make well-informed decisions in an increasingly dynamic environment. This partnership signals an exciting shift in how financial institutions can engage with clients around the globe.”

About LSEG

LSEG (London Stock Exchange Group) is a leading global financial markets infrastructure and data provider, playing a vital social and economic role in the world's financial system. With our open approach, trusted expertise and global scale, we enable the sustainable growth and stability of our customers and their communities. We are dedicated partners with extensive experience, deep knowledge and a worldwide presence in data and analytics; indices; capital formation; and trade execution, clearing and risk management across multiple asset classes. LSEG is headquartered in the United Kingdom, with significant operations in 70 countries across EMEA, North America, Latin America and Asia Pacific. We employ 23,000 people globally, more than half located in Asia Pacific. LSEG's ticker symbol is LSEG.

Standard Chartered

We are a leading international banking group, with a presence in 52 of the world's most dynamic markets. Our purpose is to drive commerce and prosperity through our unique diversity, and our heritage and values are expressed in our brand promise, here for good.

Standard Chartered PLC is listed on the London and Hong Kong stock exchanges.

[Category: Asset Management/ Mutual Funds, Financial/ Capital Market, New Offerings]

Source: Standard Chartered

Document ATINBK0020250206el260008k

Wealth management expert, Standard Chartered Bank launches global wealth campaign in India

Express Web Dek

259 words

5 February 2025

Indian Express Online

INEXON

English

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British multinational bank, Standard Chartered has launched its latest global wealth campaign in India. Called 'Now's your time for wealth', the campaign calls for its global network to "grow, protect and pass on their wealth", according to a statement by the company.

In India, the campaign is aimed at including 'Global Indians' — entrepreneurs with successful businesses—looking to grow financially. Done in collaboration with Hong Kong based Publicis Groupe, Standard Chartered as an international **wealth manager** is offering "expertise and unrivalled wealth investment solutions."

The global wealth campaign aligns with Standard Chartered India's pivot towards wealth and affluent, the bank said in an official statement.

"Global Indians' embody India's growth story while pursuing global aspirations and ambitions. With our deep market expertise and extensive international network, Standard Chartered strives to support them on their **wealth management** journey," says Aditya Mandloi, Managing Director (India and South Asia), Standard Chartered Bank.

"The genesis of our campaign is inspired by our clients and their wealth ambitions, now and in the future," added Haymans Fung, Global Head at Standard Chartered Bank.

The bank is targeting 200 billion dollars in Net New Money by 2029 and a double-digit CAGR in wealth solutions. Apart from India the campaign will also take place in Singapore, Hong Kong, Mainland China, Korea, Taiwan and UAE.

[The global wealth campaign aligns with Standard Chartered India's pivot towards wealth and affluent, the bank said in an official statement. \(Image: sc.com\)](#)

Document INEXON0020250206el250003t

UOB's Benny Lee: DPM assets grew 20% annually over five years

Priyanka Boghani

597 words

28 January 2025

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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United Overseas Bank's discretionary portfolio management assets have grown at a healthy clip over the last five years, with assets under management (AUM) increasing annually by 20%, its DPM head says.

Benny Lee, the Singaporean **private bank**'s head of DPM, said UOB has seen a positive trajectory since the desk was launched nine years ago across its fixed income, balanced and growth strategies.

Over 95% of its DPM portfolios have delivered positive returns for clients since the start, according to the bank.

'The recent impetus for turning to DPM mandates, however, has been the Federal Reserve cutting interest rates as this has led to fixed deposit rates coming off and clients taking on more risk,' Lee said.

Lee said that as early as two years ago, he began to see the rotation from fixed deposits into DPM, with many clients opting for fixed income, balanced and growth strategies. He said that although the equity sleeve has outperformed the bank's reference index by 6%, fixed income has avoided defaults and also outperformed the index over the last three years, proving to be 'most popular' and 'most sticky.'

While many **private banks** look to boost performance adding structured products and alternative investments, for example, Lee said UOB **Private Bank**'s focus remains on fixed income and equities allocations, given their performance over the last two years. The bank takes a more 'measured approach' to alternatives allocations.

'Generally, we think adding alts helps balance the portfolio, create resilience and lead to a better Sharpe ratio...However we do take liquidity concerns as an input when deciding how much to allocation to alts,' he said.

Similar to other **private banks** though, UOB **Private Bank** offers a DPM format with a lower ticket size for clients, through its Ucits product.

'My observation is that clients who do not want to do the traditional segregated account can opt for this and allocate a smaller quantum,' he said. 'Otherwise our segregated account format starts at \$1m for the fund of funds series and \$2.5m for the standard series.'

Several **private banks**, including BNP Paribas Wealth Management and Deutsche Bank, have [adopted](#) a similar approach that involves lowering the minimum starting size to service clients with smaller portfolios.

Asia's DPM penetration still typically lags behind its global counterparts, hovering in the high single digits. However, the concept is no longer foreign in the region, with a concerted effort both from banks and clients to understand and maximise the benefits of the offering.

Lee noted that relationship managers are better trained in terms of specific features of DPM strategies and are encouraged by the bank to engage clients with DPM services for better risk-adjusted performance.

Some banks have targets for bankers and use metrics to keep track of accounts opened and the portion of client portfolios allocated.

UOB **Private Bank**, which has \$93bn in assets under management as of June 2024, and has managed to shore up its recurring fees in 2023, said DPM penetration rate is in the 'healthy teens level'.

Lee expects penetration levels to go up in 2025, likely buoyed by healthy returns from equities markets backed by a resilient US economy and the pro-business policy drivers from the Trump administration.

'Many clients are aware that fixed deposits came off and are aware that investment can generate higher returns. We saw an increase in DPMs since rate cuts happened last year so maybe this will help clients gain confidence [in 2025] too.'

HSBC expands into India's GIFT City, opens 20 new branches

Priyanka Boghani

486 words

23 January 2025

Citywire Middle East

CWIRME

English

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HSBC has established a presence in India's international financial services centre, GIFT City.

The bank said its office in Gujarat state will allow it to leverage GIFT City's infrastructure, business-friendly environment and provide its clients with wealth management services, in a 20 Jan statement.

HSBC said it will become the first international bank to offer a full spectrum of products and services to its clients in the financial hub.

The bank said it will look to design enhanced wealth management services in GIFT City to meet the growing needs of its premier and **private banking** clients who want to invest in global markets as well as NRIs seeking investment opportunities in India. This includes foreign currency banking accounts, USD fixed deposits and dollar denominated investment products among others.

'GIFT City is shaping into a key global financial hub, and HSBC is proud to be a part of this journey and being amongst the top three banks now in GIFT City within the first four years of our operations,' Hitendra Dave, CEO, HSBC India, said.

The Gujarat International Financial Tec-City, known as GIFT City, was established in 2007 as India's first international financial services centre. Recently, the Indian government moved to allow family offices to set up in GIFT City through a family investment fund (FIF), enabling them to access international investment opportunities. However, several applications from domestic family offices to set up investment funds in the finance hub are still [awaiting](#) approval.

HSBC's operations in GIFT City commenced in January 2021 and it was the first international bank to get investment banking permission and a foreign portfolio license. Over the past four years, HSBC has strengthened its presence there, acquiring a 6.125% equity stake in CCIL IFSC Limited (CCIL IFSC).

Branch expansion

The news comes shortly after HSBC India approval from local regulator, the Reserve Bank of India, to open 20 new bank branches in key cities. The expansion reinforces the bank's commitment to the wealth sector, the bank said on 17 Jan.

The Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities, where the bank said growing pools of wealth are emerging, include Amritsar, Bhopal, Bhubaneswar, Dehradun, Faridabad, Indore, Jalandhar, Kanpur, Ludhiana, Lucknow, Mysuru, Nagpur, Nashik, Navi Mumbai, Patna, Rajkot, Surat, Thiruvananthapuram, Vadodara and Vishakhapatnam.

'We're aiming to be the preferred international bank for India's affluent and globally mobile Indians,' said Sandeep Batra, HSBC India's head, international wealth and premier banking.

'These new branches will help drive our international wealth and premier banking proposition and build on our momentum with customers in India and our growing non-resident clientele around the world.'

The bank reopened its **private banking** doors in India in 2023 after an eight-year hiatus, joining a growing league of international and domestic **private banks** eyeing the country's burgeoning wealth opportunity.

Document CWIRME0020250123el1n00001

DBS's Lee Woon Shiu on catering to global Indians via insurance solutions

Priyanka Boghani

809 words

20 January 2025

Citywire Middle East

CWIRME

English

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DBS **Private Bank** sees insurance products as a way to connect to both its non-resident Indian (NRI) and onshore Indian clients, the bank's Lee Woon Shiu says.

Lee (pictured), group head of wealth planning, **family office** and insurance solutions, said the Singaporean lender works with India-based clients who are interested in offshore investments, which include insurance, by creating funds and approved structures through the Overseas Direct Investment (ODI) route.

'These funds can take the ODI route and access large ticket universal life (UL) solutions,' he said. 'This is particularly important for clients who have families outside of India as they may wish to retain a certain portion of the death benefits offshore.'

Where the beneficiaries are offshore family members, Lee said that it would be possible to structure a payout of such death benefits offshore.

The group head has 75 people in his team, with almost 20 focused on insurance alone.

Several insurance firms in Singapore have included a death benefit in UL offerings, a popular product among high net worth individuals, as this provides more payment options to assist with legacy planning. In India, products are not as developed for high or ultra-high net worth individuals, Lee said, particularly as many want larger ticket sizes and the ability to customise.

In general, larger Indian families are setting up **family offices** outside of India as they look to diversify their portfolios, move funds for their children or migrate for lifestyle reasons. Wealth planning and structuring for outgoing funds is an area where DBS's Lee believes is a big opportunity.

He has also seen an uptick in requests to help set up **family office** structures from onshore Indians keen to use the ODI route to create corporate entities. While Dubai has been the hottest destination for **family offices** and wealth management due to its tax incentives, Lee noted that clients' preferences have been more complex, with some wanting to create structures in Dubai for proximity reasons, but with assets booked in Singapore.

'Indeed, we had a client with a daughter studying in the US who wanted to send funds from their Singapore account instead of his Dubai account because of the relative ease of remittance,' he recounted.

NRI nuances

The **private bank**, which has NRI desks in Hong Kong and Singapore, caters to clients across the global Indian diaspora from the UK, Singapore, Kenya, Hong Kong and even Thailand. Within this group, insurance has played a strong role too, Lee said.

'Clients are increasingly turning to insurance policies offshore, purchasing them with funds they have legally remitted offshore via the ODI route... as a result we are seeing a rise in revenue and assets under management (AUM) from insurances products from our NRI clients,' he said.

NRI clients from Thailand have particularly turned to life insurance products, Lee said. This follows a recent change in tax laws in the country that saw insurance recognised as one of the exceptions to the taxation on the inward remittance of offshore income.

From 1 January 2024, the new rules in Thailand stated that foreign income brought into Thailand will be taxed in the year it is brought into the country, regardless of where the income was earned. Certain types of income, however, are exempt from personal income tax, including funds from insurance.

'The usual UL solutions will work but if they need funds back within two years, we advise clients to go for the variable UL solutions as some of the funds thereunder can be remitted back to Thailand tax-free sooner,' Lee said.

Variable universal life (UL) products combine variable life and universal life policies, allowing the premiums to be adjustable while being able to invest in underlying sub-accounts through different investment options tied to financial markets.

For clients keen on insurance solutions, the bank invites them to Hong Kong or Singapore to engage with its third-party insurance partner, Manulife.

Lee also noted that NRI clients are also using **family offices** structures to help certain Indian communities as part of their impact investing funds. In Singapore, he said the SFO scheme helps as they are allowed to make a grant or a donation in their home country and receive certain tax exemptions, as long as it is made through a qualified intermediary.

The NRI and global Indian community have become increasingly intertwined, with many **private banks** pitching desks to create corridors between Singapore, India and Dubai. While the increasingly moneyed diaspora is notoriously price sensitive, Lee said that it is their strong sense of heritage and shared beliefs that make the onshore and offshore communities inseparable.

'It makes this market group a very interesting one. We need to serve NRI clients consistently through the same culture and language,' he added.

Document CWIRME0020250120e1k00001

MARKETS

HSBC Global Private Banking overweight on India

427 words

8 January 2025

BusinessLine (The Hindu)

BSNLNE

English

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MARKETS

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The bank believes equities will outperform bonds, and bonds will outperform cash.

HSBC Global **Private Banking** expects risk assets to remain well supported by a healthy global economic outlook, broadening earnings growth and synchronised central bank rate cuts in the first half of 2025.

The bank believes that equities will outperform bonds, and bonds will outperform cash. It is overweight on equities in the UK, Japan, India and Singapore for their favourable growth appeal and risk-reward profile.

positive trends

It views the recent pull-back in Indian equities as an opportunity to add exposure. "Double-digit earnings growth, superior return on equity relative to other Asian peers, robust economic fundamentals, easing of valuations after the recent pullback are supportive for Indian equities," said James Cheo, Chief Investment Officer, Southeast Asia and India, Global **Private Banking** and Wealth, HSBC.

According to him, the bank prefers large-cap stocks over mid- and small-cap stocks, given their more defensive nature and relatively reasonable valuations. It retains its preference for financials and industrials sectors but see growing uncertainties for the consumer discretionary sector.

RBI to cut rate twice

HSBC GPB expects the Reserve Bank of India to deliver two rate cuts of 25 bps over February and April, bringing the policy rate to 6 per cent for the rest of the year.

It is bullish on Indian local currency, government bonds and expects them to outperform cash in 2025 and USD-rupee to end the year at 86.

"We expect rupee bonds to continue to deliver stable returns in 2025 owing to RBI rate cuts leading to lower yields and capital appreciation for bond prices, an attractive yield of around 6.9 per cent and favourable technicals owing to moderate supply due to fiscal discipline as well as strong demand from international investors stemming from global index-inclusion linked flows," said Cheo.

Asia GDP growth

The bank expects Asia ex-Japan GDP growth to stay resilient at 4.4 per cent in 2025, well above the global average of 2.7 per cent growth, thanks to robust domestic growth in India and ASEAN, coupled with China's broadening policy stimulus.

India's domestically driven earnings profile makes it defensive to US tariff risks. HSBC GPB expects the Federal Reserve will continue the rate-cutting cycle with 3 more 25 basis points of rate cuts in March, June and September.

'We expect rupee bonds to continue to deliver stable returns in 2025 owing to RBI rate cuts'

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HSBC appoints new Head of International Wealth Hub for Singapore

Distributed by Contify.com

476 words

7 January 2025

Contify Banking News

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English

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Key Highlights:

* Jil appointed as the new Head of International Wealth Hub for HSBC Singapore.

* Jil has 22 years of experience in **wealth management** and retail banking.

* Jil will focus on scaling the bank's offshore business through new client growth and deepening client relationships.

Original Press Release:

Jan. 7 -- HSBC Group issued the following news release:

HSBC has appointed Jil Chin as its new Head of International Wealth Hub for Singapore. Jil joined the bank on 6 January 2025, and reports to Ashmita Acharya, Head of International Wealth and Premier Banking, HSBC Singapore.

Jil brings with her 22 years of experience in **wealth management** and retail banking, with demonstrated competencies in leading large frontline teams and initiatives covering sales, service, talent management and acquisitions. Jil's cross-business and cross-functional experience includes managing the Wealth and Cards sales platforms, as well as driving digital growth initiatives. She also led both onshore and offshore collaborative transformation strategies aimed at providing optimal client advisory and creating a future-ready and sustainable **wealth management** business. Jil was most recently Citigold & Citigold Private Client Banking Director for **Wealth Management** at Citibank Singapore.

As Head of International Wealth Hub for HSBC Singapore, Jil will oversee the scaling of the bank's offshore business through new client growth, deepening client relationship and fostering stronger cross-border collaboration.

Ashmita Acharya, Head of International Wealth and Premier Banking, Singapore, said, "Our ambition is to be Singapore's leading international bank for both onshore and offshore clients across the wealth continuum. A comprehensive hub for wealth and asset management, Singapore has one of the fastest retail offshore AUM growth globally. I am delighted to have Jil on board to lead the business in capturing these growth opportunities. With our comprehensive wealth proposition, enhanced digital banking and wealth capabilities, and high-calibre teams, we are well positioned to take our international wealth business to new heights."

About HSBC Singapore

HSBC opened its first branch in Singapore in 1877. A qualifying full bank serving international needs of individual, corporate and institutional clients, HSBC in Singapore offers a comprehensive range of banking and financial services including retail banking and **wealth management**; commercial, investment and private banking; insurance; forfaiting and trustee services; securities and capital markets services. It was recognised by Asiamoney as "Best International Bank in Singapore" in 2022 and 2023.

The Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corporation Limited

The Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corporation Limited is the founding member of the HSBC Group. HSBC serves customers worldwide from offices in 62 countries and territories. With assets of US\$3,001bn at 31 March 2024, HSBC is one of the world's largest banking and financial services organisations.

[Category: Banks, Asset Management/ Mutual Funds, Banks, Financial/ Capital Market, Management/ Leadership Changes]

Source: HSBC Group

Document ATINBK0020250113el170005I

Exclusive: UOB PB hires from Noah to up North Asia and Asean coverage

Priyanka Boghani

170 words

6 January 2025

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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A former private wealth planning head at Noah Holdings has joined UOB **Private Bank**, Citywire Asia can reveal.

Kevin Foo has joined the Singaporean **private bank** as its business development head, covering North Asia and the Asean markets. He reports to John Chen, head, commercial officer, who sits in the sales and strategy department for UOB **Private Bank**.

UOB declined to comment on the hire.

At China-based wealth management firm Noah Holdings, Foo **spent** over four years helping its high net worth clients set up family offices and outsource their offshore wealth management to Singapore.

UOB **Private Bank** has set a **target** to hit S\$145bn (\$110bn) in assets under management by 2026, and a headcount of 400 relationship managers. UOB head of **private bank** Chew Mun Yew said he aims to do this by deepening the share of wallet of its existing clients, rather than relying on new clients through hiring relationship managers.

Document CWIRAS0020250107e1600002



Business

Hong Kong employers look to hire more relationship managers and data analysts next year

Mia Castagnone

617 words

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SCMCOM

English

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Human resource professionals also say customer due diligence officers are in demand

Relationship managers, customer due diligence officers and data analysts are some of Hong Kong's hottest jobs in the coming year, according to human resource professionals.

In the current business environment, relationship managers will be one of the "hot jobs" in the financial services sector, according to Betty Lam, the head of human resources at [DBS Bank](#) in Hong Kong.

Outside **private banking**, relationship managers are also supporting small and medium-sized enterprises. The relationship managers are especially helpful in guiding these businesses through the challenges of Hong Kong's current economic environment, Lam said.

Do you have questions about the biggest topics and trends from around the world? Get the answers with [SCMP Knowledge](#), our new platform of curated content with explainers, FAQs, analyses and infographics brought to you by our award-winning team.

The Singaporean bank went on a hiring spree this year, adding 106 new staffers – including 50 relationship managers. The rest support its **private bankers**, according to Lam.

Banks like [HSBC Holdings](#) and [Standard Chartered](#) have also signalled they would focus on more profitable parts of their business, including private and corporate banking.

Earlier this year, Standard Chartered said it would double the size of its wealth management team, hoping to grab a bigger piece of the growing ultra-rich segment in the region.

UBS Group said it would add staff as it looks to double the assets it manages for its millionaire clients in the region over the next three to five years, while Bank of Singapore boosted staffing levels in Hong Kong by 30 per cent.

"Wealth management is a growing industry, as the ultra-wealth segment matures in China," said Jerry Chang, a consultant at executive search firm Barons & Co.

"Beyond that, maintaining client relations, having people skills and connections to get business," he said. "These are really the important parts of a good relationship manager, which banks today are all looking for."

German lender [Deutsche Bank](#)'s hiring of late has focused on investment banking, **private banking** and corporate banking. It has emphasised the importance of client coverage.

Key skills for 2025 include language proficiency – especially Mandarin – and data analytics, according to Nishant Mihir, Deutsche Bank's head of human resources for Asia-Pacific, the Middle East and Africa.

The bank also sees growth opportunities in the Middle East and Southeast Asia.

"Language is important, if people have an ability to speak Mandarin, that's always helpful," Mihir said. "There are many emerging new corridors and an increasing number of Chinese enterprises that want to go global."

Artificial intelligence (AI) is also allowing businesses to be more efficient and as they evolve, people will need to learn new skills, said Karen Ng, Asia market lead at human resources platform Deel. Getting certificates in AI learning and ESG are great ways for employees to hone their skills, she said.

"The trilingual component is still very much attractive, when you're doing business in China, you can still work from north to south China," she said.

Jobseekers are interested in opportunities for career growth, Ng said, and they want a competitive salary, good benefits and a healthy company culture.

DBS's Lam said businesses are looking especially for customer due diligence officers and data analysts.

"The role goes beyond the numbers, beyond the data," she said. "How can it be interpreted?" She added that as AI makes coding faster and easier, the ability to analyse data will be more important.

"Interest, curiosity, innovative thinking and agility will increasingly become relevant," said Lam.

Document SCMCOM0020241225ekcp00003

StanChart PB hires former HSBC private banking UAE head

Priyanka Boghani

350 words

13 December 2024

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StanChart (Standard Chartered) Global Private Banking is on a hiring spree, expanding its frontliners by 20% in the UAE, including its most recent signing of a group head, taking the total to eight new recruits this year.

Momin Jaffar joined the British lender as group head from HSBC, where he was the UAE-based head of private banking.

The rest include fellow former HSBC bankers, Hamza Zahid and Zein Chaudhry as relationship managers; Mahmoud Elsgaei as relationship manager from ADCB; Ahmed Anabtawi as ED and team leader who has worked at the likes of Mashreq, QIB and Emirates; Alasdair Scarr also as ED from HSBC, Deutsche Bank and Citibank; and Samar Zarifeh and Hamsah Fadhil as directors who have both worked at Mashreq in their previous roles. The bankers joined over the course of the year.

The bank said the UAE plays a pivotal role in growing its affluent business as it acts as a gateway to international markets and hubs. The expansion is part of a broader strategy to double its investment in the affluent business over the next five years, according to the bank.

'Expanding our private banking team in the UAE reflects our confidence in the country's unique role as a global wealth hub,' said Vinay Gandhi (pictured), Standard Chartered Global Private Bank's global head of GSAC and regional head of AMEE.

'The UAE continues to be a priority market for Standard Chartered, with the bank actively investing in talent and resources to meet the needs of its high and ultra-high-net-worth clients.'

The hires come after the bank set an ambitious target of attracting \$200bn in net new money and double-digit growth in its wealth solutions over the next five years, with a focus on global Chinese and Indians stationed in Singapore, Hong Kong, the UAE and Jersey.

Earlier this year, it onboarded a dozen new private bankers across its Hong Kong, Singapore and UAE centres, and promoted Rajesh Kannan to head of wealth and retail banking in the Middle East.

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HSBC India launches credit card for private banking clients

Priyanka Boghani

283 words

10 December 2024

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HSBC India has rolled out Privé, its first premium credit card for its private banking clients, who include professionals, entrepreneurs and families with investable assets of more than \$2m.

Launched in collaboration with Mastercard, HSBC Privé's privileges include entry into premium airport lounges worldwide, travel insurance and zero forex mark-ups on international spends. Other benefits include access to private clubs and lounges across Asia, Australia, Europe and the US, as well as Michelin-starred restaurants, private jets, golf courses and wellness programmes. Hospitality group benefits and shopping perks are also available.

'For our global private banking clients who lead dynamic lives with a spirit of ambition and entrepreneurship, we offer a distinctive wealth management approach and our clients choose us not only because of our deep understanding of their needs, but also our capabilities to provide them with bespoke services beyond private banking,' said Sandeep Batra, head, wealth and personal banking at HSBC India, on the launch.

Spending is on the rise in India, as the wealthy remain optimistic about the growth of their businesses in the country's booming economy. Credit card spending by the UHNW and HNW segment, represented by World and World Elite Mastercard cardholders in India, increased by 87% year on year in 2023. Overseas spending on experiences and travel categories rose by 69% and 56%, respectively, over the same period.

HSBC GPB re-entered India in 2023 after an eight-year hiatus. The bank has undergone a global overhaul of its senior management in recent months that will see London-based global private banking and wealth head Annabel Spring leave at the end of 2024.

Document CWIRME0020241210ekca00001

HSBC hires from Lombard Odier for Singapore desk head

James Phillipps

290 words

9 December 2024

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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HSBC Global **Private Banking** has recruited Annie Lim as desk head for Singapore.

Lim joined from Lombard Odier, where she focused on wealth management and advisory, covering ultra-high net worth clients, including family offices.

In her new role she will also cover the UHNW and family office segment, reporting to Hammad Hashmi, market head, Singapore, Malaysia and Indonesia.

In a career spanning nearly three decades, Lim has also previously worked at Credit Suisse, Standard Chartered and American Express Bank.

HSBC head of GPB South Asia Tommy Leung said: 'HSBC is deeply committed to our ambitious wealth strategy in South Asia. To support this growth, we are actively enhancing our team's seniority, experience, and relevant skill sets.'

The Anglo-Asian lender has undergone a series of restructures this year since new CEO Georges Elhedery took the reins in July. The bank announced on Friday that Annabel Spring, its chief executive for global **private banking** and wealth, will [leave at the end of the year](#).

Her departure follows an [earlier overhaul](#) that saw the creation of an international wealth and premier banking division in October. The new division will be led by Barry O'Byrne, who was previously CEO for global commercial banking at HSBC.

Spring's role will be split in two following her departure. Lavanya Chari will become head of wealth and premier solutions within the division, while Gabriel Castello will be made interim CEO for global **private banking**, both reporting to O'Byrne. A permanent successor will be announced later.

In November, HSBC also named a [new boss and head of investment solutions](#) for its Indian onshore business and it also [split](#) the Asean and Australia market head roles.

Document CWIRAS0020241209ekc900003

BusinessWorld

Special Report

SPECIAL REPORT: Third Quarter Banking Report FINANCIAL RATIOS

1,563 words

9 December 2024

BusinessWorld

BSWRLD

S4/4

English

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THE PHILIPPINE COMMERCIAL BANKING SYSTEM

Based on Solo and Consolidated Balance Sheets
as of September 30, 2024

INTERMEDIATION RATIO Q3' 24 Q2' 24 Q3' 23
P100B AND OVER

BDO Unibank, Inc.	81.88%	80.49%	77.34%
Land Bank of the Philippines	40.07%	39.91%	38.89%
Metropolitan Bank & Trust Co.	73.61%	67.18%	59.48%
Bank of the Philippine Islands	85.35%	84.54%	79.66%
China Banking Corp.	67.04%	63.53%	65.21%
Rizal Commercial Banking Corp.	68.42%	68.15%	65.68%
Security Bank Corp.	87.10%	86.27%	87.77%
Philippine National Bank	68.94%	69.57%	65.72%
Union Bank of the Philippines	80.34%	77.40%	70.20%
Development Bank of the Philippines	67.91%	65.73%	59.38%
East West Banking Corp.	87.52%	84.98%	81.32%
Citibank NA	9.78%	-	23.87%
Asia United Bank Corp.	67.51%	67.51%	65.48%
Hongkong & Shanghai Banking Corp. Ltd., The	46.37%	46.38%	42.93%
Bank of Commerce	66.86%	69.59%	62.18%
Philippine Trust Co.	19.03%	17.88%	14.35%
Philippine Bank of Communications	76.81%	80.22%	73.82%
Maybank Philippines, Inc.	71.70%	79.09%	66.93%
MUFG Bank Ltd.	36.56%	44.66%	39.30%
Standard Chartered Bank	19.83%	17.92%	17.48%
MEDIAN	68.17%	68.15%	65.35%

OVER P50B, BUT BELOW P100B

CTBC Bank	109.87%	102.37%	89.04%
Mizuho Bank Ltd.	28.78%	31.06%	37.64%
JPMorgan Chase Bank N.A.	3.29%	1.33%	1.00%
Philippine Veterans Bank	44.73%	44.22%	37.85%
Bank of China Ltd.	130.38%	115.08%	99.54%
Deutsche Bank AG	62.04%	51.80%	53.46%
MEDIAN	53.39%	48.01%	45.65%

OVER P20B, BUT BELOW P50B

Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corp.	51.99%	36.03%	34.46%
Australia & New Zealand Banking Group Ltd.	16.99%	35.29%	34.18%
CIMB Bank Philippines, Inc.	75.21%	71.10%	65.69%
Bank of America NA	4.09%	13.51%	15.95%
BDO Private Bank	7.18%	8.22%	13.51%
ING Bank N.V.	211.48%	113.48%	165.59%

KEB Hana Bank	117.50%	150.81%	140.83%
MEDIAN	51.99%	36.03%	34.46%

P20B AND BELOW

Bangkok Bank Public Co. Ltd.	146.33%	163.33%	160.32%
Mega International Commercial Bank	82.03%	102.40%	68.10%
Shinhan Bank	123.38%	137.50%	128.97%
Hua Nan Commercial Bank Ltd.	31332.07%	17677.30%	8349.05%
Industrial Bank of Korea	245.52%	385.56%	214.91%
Industrial and Commercial Bank of China Ltd.	122.17%	169.58%	703.52%
Cathay United Bank Co. Ltd.	703.89%	865.81%	272.58%
Chang Hwa Commercial Bank Ltd.	13608.47%	20844.94%	34795.46%
United Overseas Bank Ltd.	671.30%	623.61%	428.18%
First Commercial Bank Ltd.	458.45%	621.03%	406.06%
Al-Amanah Islamic Investment Bank	28.45%	29.68%	29.99%
Robinsons Bank Corp.	-	-	70.73%
MEDIAN	245.52%	385.56%	243.75%

GRAND MEDIAN	72.66%	71.10%	65.72%
TOTAL LOANS / TOTAL DEPOSITS	69.01%	68.05%	64.01%

STOCKHOLDER'S EQUITY RATIO Q3' 24 Q2' 24 Q3' 23

P100B AND OVER

BDO Unibank, Inc.	11.93%	11.68%	11.90%
Land Bank of the Philippines	7.93%	7.58%	8.08%
Metropolitan Bank & Trust Co.	11.09%	10.40%	10.83%
Bank of the Philippine Islands	13.30%	12.87%	12.81%
China Banking Corp.	8.33%	8.05%	8.62%
Rizal Commercial Banking Corp.	10.96%	10.94%	11.64%
Security Bank Corp.	10.81%	11.44%	14.09%
Philippine National Bank	17.04%	15.62%	14.93%
Union Bank of the Philippines	16.44%	16.08%	14.83%
Development Bank of the Philippines	9.37%	8.99%	8.38%
East West Banking Corp.	14.46%	13.85%	14.54%
Citibank NA	5.99%	-	7.18%
Asia United Bank Corp.	14.73%	14.73%	13.15%
Hongkong & Shanghai Banking Corp. Ltd., The	6.49%	6.07%	7.72%
Bank of Commerce	13.31%	13.01%	12.76%
Philippine Trust Co.	12.99%	12.16%	11.99%
Philippine Bank of Communications	12.89%	12.92%	12.54%
Maybank Philippines, Inc.	11.21%	11.68%	12.89%
MUFG Bank Ltd.	9.82%	9.40%	10.30%
Standard Chartered Bank	7.38%	6.90%	7.68%
MEDIAN	11.15%	11.68%	11.95%

OVER P50B, BUT BELOW P100B

CTBC Bank	11.27%	12.19%	14.83%
Mizuho Bank Ltd.	10.36%	9.50%	10.32%
JPMorgan Chase Bank N.A.	9.48%	9.65%	11.76%
Philippine Veterans Bank	4.24%	3.54%	2.27%
Bank of China Ltd.	17.97%	18.62%	18.79%
Deutsche Bank AG	5.83%	5.38%	6.60%
MEDIAN	9.92%	9.58%	11.04%

OVER P20B, BUT BELOW P50B

Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corp.	30.43%	27.46%	28.89%
Australia & New Zealand Banking Group Ltd.	13.02%	11.62%	14.57%
CIMB Bank Philippines, Inc.	23.90%	21.33%	21.81%
Bank of America NA	15.17%	15.47%	17.39%
BDO Private Bank	21.50%	19.26%	18.55%
ING Bank N.V.	28.81%	22.01%	41.11%

KEB Hana Bank	27.37%	26.59%	28.46%
MEDIAN	23.90%	21.33%	21.81%

P20B AND BELOW

Bangkok Bank Public Co. Ltd.	49.93%	55.69%	53.59%
Mega International Commercial Bank	32.68%	31.81%	25.96%
Shinhan Bank	45.50%	44.89%	44.00%
Hua Nan Commercial Bank Ltd.	29.40%	28.34%	32.40%
Industrial Bank of Korea	51.90%	52.51%	46.65%
Industrial and Commercial Bank of China Ltd.	60.76%	53.47%	34.71%
Cathay United Bank Co. Ltd.	74.11%	74.34%	71.83%
Chang Hwa Commercial Bank Ltd.	40.97%	38.72%	47.32%
United Overseas Bank Ltd.	50.23%	48.33%	50.45%
First Commercial Bank Ltd.	65.11%	65.31%	70.19%
Al-Amanah Islamic Investment Bank	1.19%	2.67%	7.90%
Robinsons Bank Corp.	-	-	10.54%
MEDIAN	49.93%	48.33%	45.33%

GRAND MEDIAN	13.30%	13.01%	14.09%
TOTAL STOCKHOLDERS EQUITY / TOTAL ASSETS	11.54%	11.28%	11.52%

STOCKHOLDER EQUITY TO LOANS RATIO Q3' 24 Q2' 24 Q3' 23

P100B AND OVER

BDO Unibank, Inc.	18.43%	18.01%	19.08%
Land Bank of the Philippines	22.34%	21.35%	23.49%
Metropolitan Bank & Trust Co.	22.52%	21.68%	24.40%
Bank of the Philippine Islands	20.31%	19.50%	20.10%
China Banking Corp.	18.29%	18.17%	18.60%
Rizal Commercial Banking Corp.	23.32%	23.24%	24.77%
Security Bank Corp.	22.48%	23.30%	26.49%
Philippine National Bank	31.62%	29.94%	30.37%
Union Bank of the Philippines	35.79%	35.27%	33.15%
Development Bank of the Philippines	18.20%	17.87%	17.91%
East West Banking Corp.	22.15%	21.73%	23.51%
Citibank NA	110.61%	-	49.47%
Asia United Bank Corp.	27.07%	27.07%	24.28%
Hongkong & Shanghai Banking Corp. Ltd., The	22.58%	20.45%	26.56%
Bank of Commerce	24.70%	24.15%	25.91%
Philippine Trust Co.	79.29%	78.19%	95.87%
Philippine Bank of Communications	22.37%	21.63%	22.91%
Maybank Philippines, Inc.	21.66%	21.33%	28.29%
MUFG Bank Ltd.	37.58%	29.60%	38.06%
Standard Chartered Bank	60.16%	57.99%	74.43%
MEDIAN	22.55%	21.73%	25.34%

OVER P50B, BUT BELOW P100B

CTBC Bank	20.61%	21.63%	25.19%
Mizuho Bank Ltd.	45.40%	38.69%	34.30%
JPMorgan Chase Bank N.A.	367.11%	945.14%	1531.56%
Philippine Veterans Bank	10.50%	8.81%	6.45%
Bank of China Ltd.	30.79%	29.76%	34.51%
Deutsche Bank AG	17.52%	17.67%	21.23%
MEDIAN	25.70%	25.70%	29.74%

OVER P20B, BUT BELOW P50B

Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corp.	95.98%	118.34%	123.45%
Australia & New Zealand Banking Group Ltd.	140.83%	68.37%	62.23%
CIMB Bank Philippines, Inc.	47.45%	49.79%	50.02%
Bank of America NA	497.88%	160.80%	151.29%
BDO Private Bank	469.87%	434.91%	224.50%
ING Bank N.V.	63.76%	73.25%	121.06%

KEB Hana Bank	45.69%	38.42%	39.71%
MEDIAN	95.98%	73.25%	121.06%

P20B AND BELOW

Bangkok Bank Public Co. Ltd.	82.28%	98.84%	83.22%
Mega International Commercial Bank	96.32%	86.12%	91.12%
Shinhan Bank	94.99%	84.21%	71.43%
Hua Nan Commercial Bank Ltd.	62.92%	59.90%	69.81%
Industrial Bank of Korea	89.79%	79.93%	90.45%
Industrial and Commercial Bank of China Ltd.	277.79%	149.03%	81.54%
Cathay United Bank Co. Ltd.	129.94%	133.81%	95.45%
Chang Hwa Commercial Bank Ltd.	179.06%	160.43%	134.12%
United Overseas Bank Ltd.	66.12%	59.89%	64.70%
First Commercial Bank Ltd.	123.67%	113.46%	101.03%
Al-Amanah Islamic Investment Bank	5.23%	10.28%	30.37%
Robinsons Bank Corp.	-	-	19.29%
MEDIAN	94.99%	86.12%	82.38%

GRAND MEDIAN	41.49%	35.27%	34.51%
STOCKHOLDERS EQUITY / TOTAL LOANS	22.78%	22.08%	23.53%

Document BSWRLD0020241209ekc900011

Top Stories

Singapore, HK to make up half of StanChart's affluent business in 'ambitious' expansion plans

Tan Nai

643 words

5 December 2024

Business Times Singapore

STBT

English

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SINGAPORE and Hong Kong will continue to make up half of Standard Chartered's affluent business, as the bank embarks on "ambitious" plans to expand the franchise, said Judy Hsu, chief executive of wealth and retail banking at StanChart.

Singapore currently accounts for around 20 per cent of the affluent business, while Hong Kong contributes around 30 per cent. The growth of the two markets will likely remain in proportion, given the size of the respective markets, Hsu said in a media call on Wednesday (Dec 4).

StanChart said in an investor briefing on Tuesday that it will target US\$200 billion in new assets, and double-digit income growth in its wealth business over the next five years. This builds on an earlier announcement, where the bank said it would cut back on its mass retail business in some markets, so that it can invest US\$1.5 billion into its affluent business.

At StanChart, the affluent business represents clients with assets under management (AUM) of more than US\$25,000. Clients in the highest "private" tier have a net worth of more than US\$10 million, and those in the "priority private" tier have AUM of more than US\$1 million.

Hsu said that Singapore is "very much an integral part of our overall affluent strategy". It has a full retail franchise, ranging from **private banking** to mass retail through Trust Bank -- its collaboration with the National Trades Union Congress.

Hong Kong as a gateway

Meanwhile, Hong Kong remains StanChart's largest wealth centre, and a gateway to China and the Greater Bay area.

"Hong Kong is not just for global Chinese -- we are also quite material in terms of franchise banking," she said, noting that the bank has both a strong domestic and offshore business in Hong Kong. She added that the bank's Hong Kong team will continue to collaborate with its teams in mainland China, to make better use of its network.

A large portion of the US\$1.5 billion investment will go into increasing the number of relationship managers, Hsu said.

Across StanChart's wealth continuum, the priority private, **private banking** and international banking segments will require more resources given their service models.

This means more investments in Singapore, Hong Kong and India, where it has **private banks**, and London, where it has an advisory centre.

The lender will also invest in growing big onshore markets, particularly in India and China, as well as in Malaysia and Taiwan.

Hsu identified two main groups of clients that have strong growth potential: the global Indians, and the global Chinese.

"We've had fabulous success with the global Chinese, and we are now leveraging some of our capabilities, success and experience (for global Indians)," she said.

To fund the US\$1.5 billion investment, Hsu said the lender is looking to cut back on businesses that are not aligned to its affluent strategy, or have very little potential to grow into a scalable business.

This includes its exit from three markets in Africa -- Botswana, Uganda and Zambia -- which Hsu said have played more in the personal loans and mass retail space.

But she noted bright spots elsewhere in Africa, such as in Kenya, where the bank has seen strong flows between Kenya and the United Arab Emirates, largely due to global Indians.

Pivoting strategy in India

StanChart is also pivoting its strategy in India away from personal loans, so it can focus its resources on its affluent business.

For the first nine months of 2024, the affluent business represented 68 per cent of StanChart's wealth and retail banking business. The affluent business accounted for 27 per cent of the overall group income, and 33 per cent of overall group profit.

Document STBT000020241204ekc50030i

COMPANIES & MARKETS

Russian money 'not our business', says StanChart CEO, as bank doubles down on **wealth management**

Jude

726 words

4 December 2024

Business Times Singapore

STBT

English

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STANDARD Chartered has vowed to double down on its **wealth-management** business. But chief executive Bill Winters is clear that one segment will not be contributing to this growth: wealthy Russians.

"A lot of Russian money has moved out of Switzerland and gone to Dubai, but that's not our business," Winters told The Business Times in an exclusive interview in late November.

BT understands that StanChart does not actively pursue Russian clients.

Many of its global peers have also kept a wide berth from the Russian **wealth-management** business, as concerns mount over widening sanction risks.

Some financial institutions have restricted or even severed some ties with affluent clients that have links to Russia, for fear of incurring tough penalties from the US and Europe.

In Singapore, second-largest lender OCBC has reportedly told its customers, including private banking clients, that it will stop handling transactions involving Russia from Nov 1, citing operational difficulties in managing regulatory requirements.

But the city-state's largest lender, DBS, is said to be beefing up its **wealth-management** team to cater to rich Russians, Bloomberg reported on Tuesday (Dec 3).

Meanwhile, StanChart said on Tuesday that it aims to attract US\$200 billion in new assets over the next five years, expanding on earlier announced plans to double its investment in its **wealth-management** arm to US\$1.5 billion.

With this shift in focus towards affluent individuals, StanChart plans to hire more relationship managers and investment advisers, deploy more wealth solutions and implement enhanced advisory, cross-border and digital capabilities.

The bank said that it will aim to increase the size of its relationship-manager team by 50 per cent by 2028.

This comes after Winters, in a statement accompanying the lender's latest quarterly results, announced that it would continue to reshape its mass retail business "to focus on developing our pipeline of future affluent and international banking clients".

For the third quarter ended September, StanChart saw its pre-tax profit more than double to US\$1.7 billion, from US\$633 million the year before. Profit from its wealth and retail banking client segment rose 11 per cent to US\$742 million, spearheaded by a 32 per cent increase in income from its wealth solutions business to US\$694 million.

The increase was attributed to broad-based growth across products, as the bank recorded continued growth momentum in net new sales and affluent new-to-bank clients.

StanChart's increased investment in **wealth management**, Winters said, will enable the bank to "sustain double-digit income growth in wealth solutions" over the medium term.

However, the landscape for the **wealth-management** business is becoming more competitive.

"Dubai was almost irrelevant four years ago, and now it's coming up," Winters said. "There's Abu Dhabi as well, so they're actually competing a little bit with each other.

"They're accumulating -- especially in Abu Dhabi, actually -- a pretty big expat population of hedge fund managers, asset managers and other financiers, who are rich. And it's a zero tax jurisdiction with lots of incentives to set up business there."

That said, he pointed out that the **wealth-management** infrastructure in the United Arab Emirates, including rule of law, is not yet fully developed. This means having to take legislative steps to reassure wealthy clients that their money is safe there.

"But they will get there," he said. "It's becoming competitive."

For now at least, he believes that the Asian wealth hubs of Singapore and Hong Kong should not be worried about rising competition from the United Arab Emirates.

"I don't think you'll notice it for a long time," Winters said. "In the meantime, Singapore and Hong Kong are growing so fast because the Asean region and mainland China are getting wealthy fast."

"There are limits, obviously, but it's a huge place," he added. "We see some Chinese putting money in Dubai, but the overwhelming majority of funds that are being invested are being invested in Hong Kong and Singapore -- roughly evenly."

He played down competition between Singapore and Hong Kong -- two of StanChart's biggest wealth centres.

"Hong Kong is fine, Singapore is fine; there's plenty of good stuff to go around," he said.

Document STBT000020241203ekc4002ec

Pictet WM names Tina Yu global head of fixed income

James Philipps

130 words

3 December 2024

Citywire Switzerland

CWIRSW

English

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Pictet Wealth Management has promoted Tina Yu to global head of fixed income.

Yu was previously head of discretionary portfolio management fixed income Asia, based in Singapore - a role she had held for two and a half years.

She started in her new position this week, according to her LinkedIn profile, and it will see her split her time between Singapore and Geneva.

Prior to Pictet, Yu spent more than six years at Julius Baer, latterly as head of Asian fixed income. She also had earlier stints at family office Wah Hin, UOB Asset Management and the Investment Company of the People's Republic of China, which manages Chinese central bank assets.

Pictet has been approached for comment.

Document CWIRSW0020241204ekc300004

UOB PB recruits from Julius Baer for head of investment strategy

Cheryl Heng

132 words

2 December 2024

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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UOB Private Bank has hired from Julius Baer to recruit its head of investment strategy.

Kelly Chia joined the Singaporean bank this week, according to his LinkedIn update.

Citywire Asia has reached out to UOB for a comment. Chia was previously deputy head of research, Asia at Julius Baer where he lead on thematic, macro strategy, ESG and crypto. He joined the Swiss bank in 2011.

Prior to that, Chia was an associate director, portfolio management with Temasek for a brief stint. He has held research and equity investment analyst roles at Standard Chartered and OCBC Securities.

UOB Private Bank [targets to hit S\\$145bn](#) (\$110bn) in assets under management by 2026, and a headcount of 400 relationship managers.

Document CWIRAS0020241202ekc20002t

J Safra Sarasin hires DBS **private banker** in Hong Kong

154 words

29 November 2024

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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Bank J Safra Sarasin has recruited a **private banker** from DBS **Private Bank** in Hong Kong.

Doris Chiu joined the Swiss-Brazilian bank in November, servicing ultra-high net worth individuals, according to her LinkedIn profile.

Citywire Asia has reached out to the bank from comment.

Chiu was with DBS **Private Bank** for six years, servicing ultra-high net worth individuals, family offices and external asset managers. She has over 15 years of industry experience.

Prior to that, she was a **private banker** in institutions including BNP Paribas, Standard Chartered, and Merrill Lynch.

Previously, J Safra Sarasin [lost](#) a team head and a senior banker who covered the non-resident Indian (NRI) segment.

Digby Warren and Anuj Grover, team head for the NRI and Southeast Asia region and senior NRI banker, respectively, also left the bank earlier this year. Both were based in Singapore.

Document CWIRAS0020241129ekbt0002t



DBS India launches enhanced **wealth management** with access to 6 markets including Singapore

Distributed by Contify.com

293 words

29 November 2024

Banking Frontiers

ATBANF

English

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DBS India has unveiled an enhanced **wealth management** proposition, providing Indian customers with seamless access to cross-border treasury services across major Asian markets, including Singapore, Hong Kong, Taiwan, Indonesia, and China. Designed to cater to high-net-worth individuals (HNIs) and non-resident Indians (NRIs), both in India and overseas, this upgraded offering also features a streamlined digital account opening process for NRIs. This process enables the majority of account setup steps to be completed within an hour, significantly improving convenience while requiring minimal document submission.

DBS Treasures, the premium banking service from DBS for customers maintaining a total relationship value of over Rs 3 million, offers comprehensive **wealth management** solutions, dedicated relationship managers, and a range of exclusive privileges. In 2023, the bank introduced the Vantage Card, an invitation-only credit card tailored for high-net-worth individuals (HNIs) and frequent international travellers, providing a host of premium benefits.

The bank has also simplified the account opening process for NRIs, offering online applications with view-access functionality before document submission. This digital process is designed to minimize paperwork and improve convenience. In addition to these updates, DBS has opened a new flagship branch in Indiranagar, Bangalore, marking its third location in the city. This branch will primarily focus on providing **wealth management** services to HNIs and NRIs.

“Having been in India for over 30 years, DBS has developed a robust understanding of the preferences of high-net-worth Indians, both in the country and abroad. The pattern of wealth creation in India has become more decentralized, demanding a stronger regional presence”, said Richa Tripathi, Head of **Wealth Management** and Treasures at DBS Bank India.

Document ATBANF0020250111ekbt0003c

HSBC Hosts Inaugural Private Markets Conference For Global **Private Banking** Clients In Hong Kong

Distributed by Contify.com

955 words

28 November 2024

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* Only 25% of Hong Kong's high net worth investors have access to a wide range of alternative investment products, but nearly three times that number are confident in investing in them.

* HSBC hosted its first Private Markets Conference in Hong Kong on 20 November 2024, providing insights into private markets investment strategies.

* The global alternatives industry is expected to exceed USD30 trillion in assets under management by 2030, up from USD16.8 trillion at the end of 2023.

Original Press Release:

Nov. 28 -- HSBC **Private Banking** issued the following news release:

- Only 25 per cent of Hong Kong's high net worth investors reported having access to a wide range of alternative investment products. However, nearly three times that number expressed confidence in investing in them, according to HSBC's research.[1]

- Real estate (64 per cent) and private equity (56 per cent) are the most popular asset classes among Hong Kong high net worth investors who are aware of private markets.[1]

- HSBC Global **Private Banking** recorded strong momentum in alternative investments in Asia with double digit growth in asset under management of alternatives driven by strong inflows.

HSBC hosts its first Private Markets Conference in Hong Kong on 20 November 2024, providing ultra high net worth and high net worth clients with exclusive insights into a variety of private markets investment strategies from renowned asset and investment managers.

Industry thought leaders discussed both opportunities and challenges in private markets, covering private equity, private credit, venture capital, infrastructure and real estate.

Lok Yim, Regional Head of Global **Private Banking**, Asia Pacific, HSBC, said: "Incorporating private markets into an investment portfolio enhances the risk-return profile through diversification, especially during times of market volatility and inflationary concerns. Our global scale and connectivity with HSBC Alternatives [2], coupled with the depth and breadth of our extensive relationships are key enablers for us to provide clients access to best-in-class investment managers and exclusive opportunities. We are delighted to host an intimate event that brings critical insights and networking opportunities to our clients."

HSBC Global **Private Banking** has recorded an exceptional year in alternative investments, with assets under management showing robust double-digit growth, driven by strong inflows. Notably, there is a significant increase in inflows into private market funds from clients who are new to private markets, indicating a growing interest from private wealth clients.

The uptake was driven by an expanded private market solutions product shelf across various investment strategies in light of a growing emphasis on portfolio diversification. Clients are increasingly seeking higher returns from asset classes that are less correlated with the public market, particularly in a shifting economic environment.

Mathieu Forcioli, Global and Asia Pacific Head of Alternatives, Global **Private Banking** & Wealth, HSBC commented: "We are seeing a remarkable uptake in interests in private market investments from individuals, along with a broader industry shift toward broadening access for ultra high net worth investors in recent years. Our recent research^[1] showed that only 25 per cent of Hong Kong's high net worth investors had access to a wide range of alternative investment products, yet nearly three times that number expressed confidence in investing in them. Looking ahead, we remain committed to providing clients with a wide array of alternative solutions tailored to their needs and will continue to work closely with them to optimise their investment strategies."

The global alternatives industry is poised to exceed USD30 trillion in assets under management by 2030, up from USD16.8 trillion at the end of 2023. Real estate (64 per cent) and private equity (56 per cent) are the most popular asset classes among Hong Kong high net worth investors who are aware of private markets, according to HSBC's research.^[1]

Some of the external speakers at the HSBC Private Markets Conference included: [In alphabetical order]

- * Joseph Bae, Co-CEO, KKR
- * Hans-Jörg Baumann, Chairman and Partner of Private Debt, StepStone
- * Philippe Camu, Chairman & Co-CIO of Infrastructure, Goldman Sachs Asset Management
- * Eugene Cook, Head of Private Equity, Blackstone Korea
- * Nicholas Goodman, President and Chief Financial Officer, Brookfield Corporation
- * Chris Gradel, Co-founder and CEO, PAG
- * Jack Hennessy, Partner, Chairman of ANZ & Cross Border, EQT Private Capital Asia

About HSBC Global **Private Banking**

HSBC Global **Private Banking** helps clients manage, grow and preserve their wealth for generations to come. Its network of global experts helps clients access investment opportunities around the world, plan for the future with wealth and succession planning, manage their portfolio with tailored solutions, and find the right support for their philanthropy. www.privatebanking.hsbc.com

The Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corporation Limited

The Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corporation Limited is the founding member of the HSBC Group. HSBC serves customers worldwide from offices in 60 countries and territories. With assets of USD3,099 billion at 30 September 2024, HSBC is one of the world's largest banking and financial services organisations.

Footnotes:

[1] The findings of HSBC Global **Private Banking** Benchmark Study 2024 are based on extensive research carried out by Savanta on behalf of HSBC Global **Private Banking**. Results are based on a sample of 2091 high net worth individuals who chose to take part with at least USD2 million of investable assets. The research was conducted in India, the UK, the USA, Singapore, mainland China, Hong Kong, Switzerland, Taiwan, the UAE and Mexico.

[2] HSBC Alternatives is the alternatives team at HSBC Asset Management, its combined assets under management and advice of USD68.7 billion, as of 31 March 2024.

[3] Future of Alternatives 2029, Preqin

Source: HSBC **Private Banking**

[Category: Banks, Retail/ Commercial Bank, Events]

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India Business

DBS India launches wealth management with access to six markets

Mayur Shetty

413 words

28 November 2024

The Times of India

TOI

English

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MUMBAI: DBS India has launched an enhanced **wealth management** offering, providing Indian customers with unified access to cross-border treasury services across key Asian markets, including Singapore, Hong Kong, Taiwan, Indonesia, and China. This offering targets high-net-worth individuals (HNIs) and non-resident Indians (NRIs) in India and abroad. The bank also announced the launch of a digital account opening process for NRIs, allowing them to complete the process, excluding document submission, within an hour. DBS Treasures, the bank's premium banking service for customers with a total relationship value exceeding Rs 30 lakh, provides access to **wealth management** solutions, experienced relationship managers, and exclusive privileges. In 2023, DBS launched the Vantage Card, an invite-only credit card with a suite of benefits for HNIs and international travelers.

The bank has also streamlined its account opening process for NRIs, allowing online applications with view-access functionality before document submission. This digital process aims to reduce paperwork and enhance convenience. Coinciding with these announcements, DBS inaugurated a new flagship branch in Indiranagar, Bangalore. This branch, the bank's third in the city, will focus on **wealth management** services to HNIs and NRIs. "Having been in India for over 30 years, DBS has developed a robust understanding of the preferences of high-net-worth Indians, both in the country and abroad. The pattern of wealth creation in India has become more decentralized, demanding a stronger regional presence," said Richa Tripathi, Head of **Wealth Management** and Treasures at DBS Bank India. DBS Bank has a 'phygital' strategy targeting new wealth in India. "This 'phygital' approach combines the convenience of digital banking with the personalized touch of physical branches, catering to a diverse customer base with varying preferences, said Tripathi. According to DBS the financial wealth of India's affluent reached \$588 billion in 2023 and is projected to grow to \$730 billion annually by 2028. "Bengaluru's entrepreneurial ecosystem and rise in investable wealth make it an ideal market for piloting our premium banking products and propositions," said Tripathi. "Our online account opening solution for NRIs enables them to unlock more value through a seamless, location-agnostic experience. Asia, with India at the heart, is the rising epicentre of wealth and, as the largest bank in Southeast Asia, we look forward to bringing all the advantages of our Asian connectivity to our Indian and NRI clients."

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Document TOI0000020241128ekbs0008c

DBS Bank Leverages Asian Network, Digital Expertise to Enhance Wealth Offering for HNI and NRI customers

Distributed by Contify.com

1,331 words

28 November 2024

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* India generated a record US\$588 billion in new financial wealth in 2023, with an expected annual increase of ~US\$730 billion until 2028.

* DBS Treasures customers with Total Relationship Value over INR 30 Lakh get access to customised **wealth management** solutions, experienced relationship managers, and exclusive privileges.

* DBS Vantage Card in India provides exclusive benefits like 8 Vantage Points for every 200 of international spends, zero forex mark-up in Singapore, and low forex mark-up of 1.75% elsewhere.

Original Press Release:

India, Nov. 28 -- DBS Bank Ltd issued the following news release:

DBS Bank has announced a significantly enriched wealth proposition for its customers in India, building on its existing offering and introducing new, digitally enhanced features, tailored to the needs of NRIs and HNIs. The bank also inaugurated its third flagship branch in Indiranagar, Bengaluru, reinforcing its presence in the country's technology hub, with a comprehensive suite of bespoke offerings and cross-border solutions for HNI clients and NRIs to access both domestic and global banking capabilities. The latest branch opening adds to the 26 DBS branches already serving Bengaluru and underlines the importance of the city to the bank's operations in India.

In its largest increase in history, new financial wealth of US\$588 billion was generated in India in 2023 and the country is expected to add wealth of ~US\$730 billion annually until 2028[1]. This increase in affluence has led to the emergence of new customer needs, and coupled with the rising phenomenon of the globally mobile Indian, there is a requirement for customised solutions that factor in personal, business and lifestyle preferences.

DBS Bank has leveraged its presence across Asia, and its advanced digital capabilities to design a differentiated offering, that gives DBS Treasures customers, with a Total Relationship Value of more than INR 30 Lakh, total access to a full suite of customised **wealth management** solutions, experienced relationship managers, exclusive privileges, and the trusted advantage of the DBS network. The full proposition, including preferential FX rates for international fund transfers, waived service fees, and zero ATM withdrawal fees, is available to customers across the six key DBS markets of Singapore, Hong Kong, Taiwan, Indonesia, India and China. In 2023, DBS Bank launched its super-premium, invite-only credit card in India, the DBS Vantage Card, offering exclusive benefits for high-net-worth customers and international travellers. These benefits include 8 Vantage Points for every 200 of international spends (1 VP = 1), zero forex mark-up on international transactions in Singapore, and a low forex mark-up of 1.75% for transactions elsewhere.[2]

The bank has pioneered an online account opening experience for its new NRI customers which lets them complete the account opening process (prior to document submission), within an hour, setting the standard for seamless onboarding. In line with the needs of a multi-location lifestyle, global Indians can open a DBS savings account with view-access and can track their application through the DBS Mobile Application Platform. View-access gives customers the functionalities of a savings account, except for fund withdrawal. Once all mandatory documents are submitted, customers can transact and withdraw funds with full account functionality. The new streamlined DBS process is a major step forward in accessibility and convenience for NRI banking, reducing the time and effort of paper documentation and follow-ups and ensuring a smooth and efficient customer experience end-to-end.

Richa Tripathi, Head - **Wealth Management** and Treasures, DBS Bank India, said, "Having been in India for over 30 years, DBS has developed a robust understanding of the preferences of high-net-worth Indians, both in the country and abroad. The pattern of wealth creation in India has become more decentralised, demanding stronger regional presence. DBS Bank India's large branch network, coupled with advanced digital expertise, supports its 'phygital' strategy, which can comprehensively serve the rapidly growing new wealth in India. At the same time, Bengaluru's entrepreneurial ecosystem and rise in investable wealth make it an ideal market for piloting our premium banking products and propositions.

The new signature DBS branch in Bengaluru will offer more exclusive and personalised services for the complex and evolving needs of our affluent and NRI customers as well as business owners. Our online account opening solution for NRIs enables them to unlock more value through a seamless, location-agnostic experience.

Asia, with India at the heart, is the rising epicentre of wealth and, as the largest bank in Southeast Asia, we look forward to bringing all the advantages of our Asian connectivity to our Indian and NRI clients."

The bank in India has also tailored its **wealth management** approach for resident elderly customers with a proposition known as "DBS Golden Circle", designed to not only address this demographic's financial needs, but also to enhance their overall quality of life through a suite of specialised services, enabling them to 'Live more, Bank Less'.

About DBS

DBS is a leading financial services group in Asia with a presence in 19 markets. Headquartered and listed in Singapore, DBS is in the three key Asian axes of growth: Greater China, Southeast Asia, and South Asia. The bank's "AA-" and "Aa1" credit ratings are among the highest in the world. In 2024, CRISIL Ratings reaffirmed its 'CRISIL AAA/Stable' rating on the corporate credit facility of DBS Bank India Ltd (DBIL). The rating on the certificate of deposits programme was also reaffirmed at 'CRISIL A1+'.

Recognised for its global leadership, DBS has been named "World's Best Bank" by Global Finance, "World's Best Bank" by Euromoney and "Global Bank of the Year" by The Banker. The bank is at the forefront of leveraging digital technology to shape the future of banking, having been named "World's Best Digital Bank" by Euromoney and the world's "Most Innovative in Digital Banking" by The Banker. In addition, DBS has been accorded the "Safest Bank in Asia" award by Global Finance for 16 consecutive years from 2009 to 2024. In line with its focus on responsible banking, DBS was named the Best Bank for Sustainable Finance – India by Global Finance in 2024. Additionally, DBS Bank was ranked among the top 3 on Forbes' list of the World's Best Banks in India for three consecutive years, from 2020 to 2022.

DBS Bank has been present in India for 30 years, opening its first office in Mumbai in 1994. DBS Bank India Limited is the first among the large foreign banks in India to start operating as a wholly owned, locally incorporated subsidiary of a leading global bank. As a trusted partner, DBS provides a range of banking services for large, medium, and small enterprises and individual consumers in India, focusing on a seamless customer experience that helps them 'Live more, Bank less'. In November 2020, Lakshmi Vilas Bank was merged with DBS Bank India Limited. DBS Bank India now has a network of ~500 branches in 19 Indian states.

DBS is committed to building lasting relationships with customers as it banks the Asian way and understands the intricacies of doing business in the region's most dynamic markets. Through the DBS Foundation, the bank creates impact beyond banking by supporting businesses for impact: enterprises with a double bottom-line of profit and social and/or environmental impact. DBS Foundation also gives back to society in various ways, including equipping underserved communities with future-ready skills and helping them to build food resilience.

With its extensive network of operations in Asia and emphasis on engaging and empowering its staff, DBS presents exciting career opportunities. For more information, please visit www.dbs.com.

Footnotes:

[1] (BCG, Global Wealth Report 2024: The GenAI Era Unfolds).

[2] All benefits related to Vantage Points are linked to card spends

[Category: Banks, Banks, Financial/ Capital Market, New Offerings]

Source: DBS Bank Ltd

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HSBC GPB opens new office in Kuwait

Priyanka Boghani
262 words
25 November 2024
Citywire Middle East
CWIRME
English

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HSBC Global **Private Banking** opened its office doors in Kuwait this month, marking its latest expansion into the Middle East region.

The **private bank**, which held an event at the Sheikh Jaber Al-Ahmad Cultural Centre (JACC), said the move was in response to growing demand for tailored **wealth management** services and solutions from high net worth individuals.

HSBC GPB's market head at HSBC Kuwait is Rayan Kazerooni, who was [hired](#) last year, while the CEO of HSBC Kuwait is Samer Alabed.

'The launch of global **private banking** in Kuwait is a significant milestone for HSBC and reinforces its commitment to Kuwait,' Kazerooni said.

'Kuwait, with its strategic location and diversifying economy, presents a significant opportunity for **wealth management** services,' Alabed added. 'We see growing demand for more sophisticated **wealth management** services as Kuwait's vision continues to transform the country into a regional trade and investment hub.'

The news comes shortly after the bank announced its new CEO for the Middle East region, Selim Kervancı. He was previously HSBC CEO Turkey.

Last year, HSBC added 100 **private bankers** in the MENA region, including former Credit Suisse bankers, such as the ex-Qatar CEO Aladdin Hangari and Justine Kreis, who [joined](#) as head of alternatives Europe, Middle East and Africa (EMEA) from Credit Suisse in Zurich.

The London-headquartered bank recently underwent a global [restructure](#) that created four divisions and split its business along east and west geographic lines, in a move the bank said will simplify the firm and cut costs.

Document CWIRME0020241126ekbp00002

HSBC: Q1 2025 Investment Outlook – New Growth Engines for a Changing World

Distributed by Contify.com

687 words

25 November 2024

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* HSBC Global **Private Banking** advises clients to minimize cash holdings to capitalize on opportunities in public and private markets amid strong global economic and earnings momentum.

* The bank's Q1 2025 Investment Outlook suggests that the US is not heading towards a recession, leading to a positive outlook for private sector investment and growth.

* HSBC sees better investment opportunities in the US stock market compared to Europe, citing current growth, innovation, and policy support.

Original Press Release:

Nov. 25 -- HSBC **Private Banking** issued the following news release:

HSBC Global **Private Banking** is advising clients to keep cash at a minimum to seize opportunities in public and private markets amid resilient global economic and earnings momentum.

The bank's Q1 2025 Investment Outlook, New Growth Engines for a Changing World, concludes it has become clear that the US is not on course for a recession. The bank believes this positive outlook should trigger a rise in private sector investment which will be a key driver of growth in the country. In addition, industrial policies, AI applications, M&A deals and fiscal and monetary stimulus in China should add to the positive momentum globally.

HSBC Global **Private Banking** continues to see better opportunities in the US stock market than in Europe, due to relative levels of current growth, innovation and policy support. We expect Asian growth to stay resilient in 2025 and hold an overweight position in India, Japan and Singapore's stock markets.

The report also identifies five key trends:

* Asia in the new world order. The bank favours regional industry champions that tap into domestic demand. It finds promising opportunities in India and the ASEAN region due to young demographics, a rising middle class and a technology boom

* Disruptive technologies. Innovation and leading technologies are driving productivity gains, reshaping the security industry and addressing unmet medical needs, causing new business segments to emerge

* Climate action. Demand for sustainable or zero-carbon products and services continues to present investment opportunities and is a key driving force in corporate expenditure

* Evolving society. The bank favours companies that have a more diverse workforce as studies show they tend to perform better. It is also looking for investment opportunities in companies that could benefit from ageing populations

* Riding the earnings and rate cut tailwinds. Cyclical support for portfolios should principally come from earnings growth and continued rate cuts. The bank is advising clients to look for the most attractive opportunities in US equities, and adopt an active approach in bonds to lock in attractive yields

Willem Sels, Global Chief Investment Officer at HSBC Global **Private Banking** and Wealth, said: “The US’s steady GDP is like a super tanker that will be difficult to blow off course. We’re at a favourable point in the global economic cycle and are telling our clients that sitting on excess cash is likely to be a drag on performance.”

Cheuk Wan Fan, Chief Investment Officer for Asia at HSBC Global **Private Banking** and Wealth, said: “When clients ask us about Asia, we find many domestic-driven opportunities. We believe that robust domestic growth drivers in India and the ASEAN region, together with China’s widening policy stimulus, will drive durable Asia ex-Japan GDP growth of 4.4 per cent in 2025.”

About HSBC Global **Private Banking**

HSBC Global **Private Banking** helps clients manage, grow and preserve their wealth for generations to come. Its network of global experts helps clients access investment opportunities around the world, plan for the future with wealth and succession planning, manage their portfolio with tailored solutions, and find the right support for their philanthropy. www.privatebanking.hsbc.com

About HSBC Holdings plc

HSBC Holdings plc, the parent company of HSBC, is headquartered in London. HSBC serves customers worldwide from offices in 60 countries and territories. With assets of USD3,099 billion at 30 September 2024, HSBC is one of the world’s largest banking and financial services organisations.

[Category: Banks, Banks, Retail/ Commercial Bank, Financial Results, Artificial Intelligence]

Source: HSBC **Private Banking**

Document ATINBK0020241126ekbp000jk

MINT, Industry

Standard Chartered Bank looks to raise its **wealth management** game in India

Shayan Ghosh

631 words

13 November 2024

Mint

HNMINI

English

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Mumbai, Nov. 13 -- UK-based Standard Chartered Bank is looking to up its **wealth management** play in India, hiring more relationship managers and giving a facelift to several branches in a market that has recently attracted strong interest from both global and domestic money managers.

"India is a huge opportunity for the wealth business and in the next decade, the amount of wealth that will get created in India will possibly be the highest in any of our footprints," Samir Subberwal, global head of wealth solutions, deposits and mortgages, and chief client officer, Standard Chartered Bank, said in an interview on Tuesday. "In India, we are pivoting more towards affluent clients and **wealth management**."

According to Subberwal, who transitioned to the current role in April, the bank will improve the look and feel of its branches in order to handle more affluent clients. The bank, he said, will also hire more relationship managers and wealth advisers and will "materially scale up" the business in India.

"Everybody is talking about wealth, so are we," said Subberwal.

India is now being seen by many as an upcoming **wealth management** destination as a result of growing affluence among a cohort of consumers.

Goldman Sachs pointed out in a report in January that the top 4% of the working-age population in India has a per capita income greater than \$10,000 per annum, compared to India's average per capita income of \$2,100. The report classified this category as "affluent India", comprising 44 million working-age population in 2023.

The bank plans to increase the number of relationship managers to around 520, from 400 at present, over the next 12-15 months. Outside of the top metros, from wealth and affluent point of view, the bank will also focus on markets like Ahmedabad, Bhubaneswar, Chandigarh and Jaipur, among others.

"We already have a presence in these markets. We have 100 branches across 42 cities in 19 states, covering 70% of the country's GDP (gross domestic product)," said Subberwal.

Meanwhile, as part of Standard Chartered Bank's plan to tap into wealthy Indians, the bank is considering raising the assets under management (AUM) threshold for individuals to become a **wealth management** customer. "We have not changed these thresholds for 10 years or longer, and now we will also enrich the proposition. It is not just increasing minimum balances, we will also have a proposition that will be far richer than what we offer today."

India allows foreign banks to operate either as a branch or a wholly-owned subsidiary of the parent. All except two - DBS Bank India and SBM Bank India - work as branches. Per RBI data, Standard Chartered Bank has the largest branch network in India (100) among foreign banks operating as branches, followed by HSBC with 26, Deutsche Bank with 17, and Citibank with 14, as on 31 August.

Apart from resident Indians, the bank also sees opportunity in the Indian diaspora. "So if you imagine our footprint, the number of Indians in the UAE, Singapore, even Hong Kong, there is a large non-resident Indian population," said Subberwal.

That said, the rise in relationship managers in India ties in with the bank's global strategy. Bill Winters, group chief executive, Standard Chartered PLC, said on 30 October that over the next five years, the bank will invest around \$1.5 billion in relationship managers and investment advisers, as well as enhanced international and digital capabilities, twice of what it had previously planned to invest.

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Document HNMINT0020241113ekbd0005m

Banking

Standard Chartered wants to be banker to India's affluent

Joel Rebello

495 words

13 November 2024

The Economic Times

ECTIM

English

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MUMBAI: Standard Chartered Bank is banking on rising affluence in India, strong income growth in the wealth segment and its global network in its pivot toward **wealth management** in the country. The bank plans to add over a hundred relationship managers, increase entry thresholds in its **wealth management** business and leverage its corporate banking associations as it doubles down on its **wealth management** business in India. Samir Subberwal, global head of wealth solutions, deposits and mortgages at the bank said shifting focus to the affluent in retail banking will help Standard Chartered to play from a position of strength in India which is a difficult market to compete in the mass market space where local banks dominate. "India is among the top five markets for the group if we take wealth income as a parameter.

India has had the highest growth rate for the last five years, though the size of the business is still smaller than some of our big centres, like Hong Kong, Singapore, Taiwan and China," Subberwal said. The bank declined to share income or assets under management (AUM) numbers from India though it said income from wealth and retail banking in India has grown 17% while home loans have grown 15% between 2020 and 2023. The bank has categorised wealthy clients in India starting with emerging affluent at ₹15 lakh, priority banking above ₹30 lakh and the most wealthy private banking clients at \$1 million plus. Subberwal said the bank plans to increase the entry threshold and add another ultra-high net worth tier within the private bank to reflect the increase in affluence in India in the last 10 years. In the first six months of 2024, Standard Chartered's global wealth business posted a record income of over \$1.2 billion, up 23% year-on-year, driven by a 25% increase in income from investment products. Its AUM grew 12% from December 2023 to \$135 billion, including \$23 billion of new money in the first half of the year. CEO Bill Winters has said that the bank will double investments in the **wealth management** business and reshape its mass retail business to focus on developing the pipeline of future affluent and international banking clients. Subberwal said the wealth business' capital-light model also is a positive for the bank to achieve its return on equity targets. Last month the bank increased its return on tangible equity (RoTE) target for 2026 from 12% to 13%. Deposits and home loans are also part of the wealth business; the affluent segments also buy investment properties. The bank does not plan to restart its personal loan business after it sold its Rs 4,100 crore to Kotak Mahindra Bank last month, exiting that business after more than two decades. Subberwal said home loans and credit cards will remain the two lending products within retail for the bank.

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Exclusive: HSBC names private banking India and investment heads

Priyanka Boghani

350 words

11 November 2024

Citywire Middle East

CWIRME

English

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HSBC Global Private Banking (GPB)'s onshore India office has named a new chief, as well as a new head of investments and wealth solutions, Citywire Asia can confirm.

Neena Goel, currently the national manager of GPB India, has been appointed GPB onshore India head more than a year after the private bank chose to re-enter the country last year. She takes over responsibilities from Nikhil Singhal, HSBC's India head of private clients business.

Saibal Ghosh has been made head of investments and wealth solutions (IWS) for the private bank's onshore India operations. He will develop and lead the suite of wealth management products, platforms and the customer journey across all client segments from retail to ultra-high-net-worth clients.

Based in India, Goel and Ghosh will report to Sandeep Batra, head of wealth and personal banking for India on an entity basis. They have a functional reporting line to Hong Kong-based Tommy Leung, head of GPB for South Asia, and Stefan Lecher, regional head of IWS for Asia Pacific, respectively.

A spokesperson from the bank confirmed the appointments.

Goel joined HSBC GPB in 2023, based in Delhi. Prior to this, she worked at Credit Suisse, Standard Chartered and Axis Bank, among other private banks.

Mumbai-based Ghosh has most recently been focusing on HSBC's IWS since 2021 as head of wealth and liabilities for the consumer banking division. He began his HSBC career in 1994, working in various roles including retail brokerage, branch management, mortgages and risk and sales management.

After an eight-year gap, HSBC GPB returned to India in July 2023, entering an intensely competitive and crowded market. At the time of the launch, HSBC GPB's CEO, Annabel Spring, said she expects the India business to grow in line with or faster than the increase in India's wealth of around 8% year on year.

Part of the bank's strategy is to upgrade clients sitting in other parts of its business, such as its premier unit, to private banking.

Document CWIRME0020241111ekbb00003

Exclusive: HSBC GPB splits Asean and Australia market head role

Priyanka Boghani

338 words

8 November 2024

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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HSBC Global **Private Banking** has decided to split Chris Harwood's role after his departure and divide his various markets between two existing co-heads, Citywire Asia understands.

Abhishek Mehrotra and Hammad Hashmi have been appointed as co-heads for Asean, Australia and Japan **private banking** business, reporting to Tommy Leung.

Mehrotra, who is relocating to Singapore from Hong Kong, will oversee the Philippines, Thailand, Vietnam, Australia and Japan markets. Hashmi, who is based in Singapore, will look after the Indonesia, Singapore and Malaysia markets.

Hashmi will oversee the \$2-10m segment, while Mehrotra will drive the ultra-high-net-worth segment, according to the announcement.

The pair were performing the roles on an interim basis before their permanency was announced yesterday. A spokesperson from the bank confirmed the appointments.

Mehrotra joined HSBC in 2004 and worked in India, the Philippines and Hong Kong across the group's corporate and **private banking** divisions. Prior to that, he was at Credit Suisse for over a year as a team head.

Meanwhile, Hashmi has spent almost two decades at HSBC covering various markets, including being the desk head for Malaysia. Previously, he was at Deutsche Bank as a senior **private banker** covering the Pakistan market.

Harwood left his role as the market head of Asean and Australia in 2021. Before that, he had led the bank's efforts to manage external asset managers across the region and headed the collaboration and global solutions group in Singapore.

He has since [resurfaced](#) at JP Morgan **Private Bank** as its new market team lead for Southeast Asia and Indonesia, as reported by Citywire Asia in July.

HSBC recently went through a large global [restructure](#) which saw the bank reorganise into four divisions, splitting its business along east and west geographic lines.

The overhaul was similar to the restructure Citi went through earlier this year, which scrapped most Asia head of wealth roles and split coverage by North and South Asia regions.

Document CWIRAS0020241108ekb800003

OCBC Group Third Quarter 2024 Net Profit Rose 9% from the Previous Year to S\$1.97 billion

Distributed by Contify.com

1,867 words

8 November 2024

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

- * OCBC Group's net profit for the third quarter of 2024 was S\$1.97 billion, a 9% increase from the previous year
 - * Net profit for the nine months of 2024 reached S\$5.90 billion, up 9% from the previous year
 - * Cost-to-income ratio improved to 38.5% in 3Q24
 - * Non-performing loan ratio declined to 0.9%
 - * Return on equity rose to 14.1% in 3Q24
 - * Earnings per share increased to S\$1.73 in 3Q24
 - * Total NPAs as of September 30, 2024, were S\$2.80 billion, down 10% from the previous year
 - * Customer loans grew 4% from a year ago to S\$305 billion as of September 30, 2024
 - * Group CET 1 CAR was 17.2% as of September 30, 2024
 - * Sustainable financing loans rose 31% from a year ago to S\$47.1 billion, comprising 15% of total customer loans
- Original Press Release:

Singapore, Nov. 8 -- OCBC Bank issued the following news release:

- Nine months 2024 net profit up 9% to a new high of S\$5.90 billion

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corporation Limited ("OCBC") reported net profit of S\$1.97 billion for the third quarter of 2024 ("3Q24"), 9% higher than S\$1.81 billion in the previous year ("3Q23"), and 2% above S\$1.94 billion a quarter ago ("2Q24"). Net profit for the nine months of 2024 ("9M24") increased 9% from a year ago ("9M23") to S\$5.90 billion.

The Group's strong year-on-year performance for 3Q24 was driven by robust non-interest income growth and lower allowances. Increased **wealth management** activities lifted fee and trading income, with insurance income higher as well. Cost-to-income ratio ("CIR") improved from the previous year to 38.5% on positive operating jaws. Asset quality remained resilient with non-performing loan ("NPL") ratio declining to 0.9%. Customer loans grew 4% from a year ago, on a constant-currency basis. On an annualised basis, return on equity rose to 14.1% and earnings per share increased to S\$1.73.

Disclaimer: The table can be viewed at:

<https://www.ocbc.com/group/media/release/2024/ocbc-group-third-quarter-2024-net-profit-rose-9-percent-from-the-previous-year-to-1point97-billion.page>

3Q24 Year-on-Year Performance

Group net profit rose 9% from a year ago to S\$1.97 billion, led by higher non-interest income and lower allowances.

* Net interest income was S\$2.43 billion, 1% lower than 3Q23. Average assets grew 3% while net interest margin ("NIM") compressed by 9 basis points to 2.18%, as the rise in funding costs more than offset the higher asset yields.

* Non-interest income grew 41% to S\$1.37 billion from broad-based growth.

- Net fee income rose 10% to S\$508 million, underpinned by higher **wealth management**, investment banking and loan-related fees. In particular, **wealth management** fees climbed 25% from a year ago, reflecting increased customer activities across all wealth product channels.

- Net trading income more than doubled to a new quarterly high of S\$508 million. Customer flow treasury income rose to a record S\$306 million, driven by both corporate and wealth segments. Improved investment performance across Global Markets and Great Eastern Holdings ("GEH") lifted non-customer flow treasury income.

- Insurance income from GEH increased 6% to S\$233 million, supported by robust underlying business performance.

* The Group's **wealth management** income, comprising income from private banking, premier private client, premier banking, insurance, asset management and stockbroking, was S\$1.29 billion, 15% higher than the previous year, and contributed 34% to the Group's total income. Group **wealth management** AUM was S\$284 billion, up 5% from S\$270 billion a year ago from both net new money inflows and improved market valuation.

* Operating expenses were S\$1.46 billion, up 9% year-on-year. This was underpinned by higher expenses associated with increased business volumes, as well as IT-related expenses as the Group continued to drive its digitalisation initiatives. During the quarter, S\$15 million of costs relating to the integration of PT Bank Commonwealth ("PTBC") in Indonesia were also recorded. As income growth outpaced the increase in expenses, CIR improved to 38.5%.

* Total allowances dropped 8% from a year ago to S\$169 million.

* Share of results of associates was S\$251 million, 1% below 3Q23.

3Q24 Quarter-on-Quarter Performance

Group net profit of S\$1.97 billion was 2% higher than the previous quarter.

* Net interest income of S\$2.43 billion held steady from a quarter ago. The effect of a comparatively longer quarter compensated for the impact of a 2-basis point narrowing of NIM.

* Non-interest income grew 14% to S\$1.37 billion from the prior quarter, driven by stronger fee and trading income. Net fee income was up 9%, largely attributable to a 16% increase in **wealth management** fees, and higher investment banking and loan-related fees. Net trading income rose by 43% from 2Q24.

* Operating expenses were 7% above 2Q24, led by a rise in variable staff compensation linked to higher business volumes.

* Total allowances of S\$169 million were higher as compared to S\$144 million in the previous quarter, largely from higher allowances for non-impaired assets.

* Share of results of associates rose 4% from 2Q24 to S\$251 million.

Disclaimer: The table can be viewed at:

<https://www.ocbc.com/group/media/release/2024/ocbc-group-third-quarter-2024-net-profit-rose-9-percent-from-the-previous-year-to-1point97-billion.page9M24> Year-on-Year Performance

Group net profit increased 9% to S\$5.90 billion, surpassing the previous nine-month high reported a year ago. This was driven by broad-based income growth and lower allowances.

* Net interest income grew 2% to a record S\$7.30 billion, backed by a 4% rise in average assets from growth in customer loans and the deployment of liquidity into high-quality assets which were income- accretive but lower yielding. NIM contracted 6 basis points to 2.22%, mainly due to increased funding costs which outpaced the rise in asset yields.

* Non-interest income rose 23% to a new high of S\$3.76 billion. Net fee income grew 8% to S\$1.45 billion, largely attributable to a 21% increase in **wealth management** fees. Net trading income was 58% higher at S\$1.23 billion, driven by both customer and non-customer flow income. Insurance income improved by 13% to S\$815 million.

* Operating expenses were S\$4.18 billion, 7% higher as compared to 9M23, largely due to increased staff costs and IT-related expenditure to support the Group's business expansion. Integration costs of S\$27 million for PTBC were also included in 9M24. CIR improved to 37.8% from 38.2% a year ago, as the 8% rise in total income exceeded expense growth.

* Share of results of associates was S\$749 million, 2% lower than a year ago.

* Total allowances were S\$483 million, 12% below S\$546 million in 9M23, mainly due to a decline in allowances for non-impaired assets.

* On an annualised basis, ROE rose to 14.4% from 14.2% in the previous year, and earnings per share grew 9% to S\$1.74.

Disclaimer: The table can be viewed at:

<https://www.ocbc.com/group/media/release/2024/ocbc-group-third-quarter-2024-net-profit-rose-9-percent-from-the-previous-year-to-1point97-billion.page>

* Total NPAs as at 30 September 2024 were S\$2.80 billion, 10% below the previous year and down 4% from the last quarter. The quarter-on-quarter drop in NPAs was driven by higher recoveries/upgrades and write-offs, which more than compensated for a rise in new corporate NPAs.

* NPL ratio was 0.9%, lower than a year ago and unchanged from the prior quarter. The allowance coverage for total NPAs was 164%, as compared to 139% in the previous year.

* Total allowances for 3Q24 were S\$169 million, which comprised allowances for impaired assets of S\$37 million and allowances for non-impaired assets of S\$132 million.

* On an annualised basis, total credit costs for 9M24 were 17 basis points, lower as compared to 20 basis points in 9M23.

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<https://www.ocbc.com/group/media/release/2024/ocbc-group-third-quarter-2024-net-profit-rose-9-percent-from-the-previous-year-to-1point97-billion.page>

* Customer loans grew 4% from a year ago and 2% from the previous quarter in constant currency terms, to S\$305 billion as at 30 September 2024.

- The year-on-year loan growth was led by an increase in corporate loans and mortgages. By geography, loan growth was largely driven by Singapore,

- Malaysia, and the Group's international markets including the United Kingdom and Australia.

Sustainable financing loans rose 31% from year ago to S\$47.1 billion, and comprised 15% of total customer loans. The total sustainable financing loan commitments stood at S\$64.7 billion as at 30 September 2024.

* Customer deposits of S\$369 billion were lower than a quarter ago, mainly driven by a S\$3 billion drop in higher-cost fixed deposits. CASA deposits increased to S\$179 billion and CASA ratio rose to 48.4%.

* Loans-to-deposits ratio was 81.6%, higher as compared to 79.7% in the previous year and 81.1% in the prior quarter.

* The Group is subject to MAS' final Basel III reforms requirements which came into effect on 1 July 2024, and are being progressively phased in between 1 July 2024 and 1 January 2029. Group CET 1 CAR as at 30 September 2024 was 17.2%, and was 15.6% on a fully phased-in basis.

Message from Group CEO, Helen Wong

"Our record earnings for the first nine months of 2024 underscored the robust performance across the Group's diversified franchise. Loan growth momentum was sustained as we supported customers across our markets, while portfolio quality remained sound. The strong improvement in our **wealth management** business and trading

income reflected the progress we have made in advancing our corporate strategy. We also saw solid profit contribution from Great Eastern Holdings (GEH), and we look forward to driving further collaboration and synergies with GEH.

Our shareholding in GEH is 93.72% after the expiry of GEH minority shareholders' right under Section 215(3) of the Companies Act on 23 October 2024. I am pleased that we have also completed the merger between OCBC Indonesia and PT Bank Commonwealth in September 2024.

Looking ahead, we will continue to proactively manage our balance sheet to prepare for a lower interest rate environment. We are closely monitoring potential volatilities arising from uncertain geopolitical conditions. We remain confident in the resilience and long-term prospects of our key markets in Asia. With our well-established franchise and strong financial position, we are well-placed to drive value for all stakeholders."

[Category: Banks, Banks, Retail/ Commercial Bank, Financial Results]

Source: OCBC Bank

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Front Page Business

DBS stock surges on share buyback plan, record \$3.03b profit

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The Straits Times

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DBS Group Holdings unveiled a multibillion dollar share-buyback programme, as **wealth management** fees and trading income drove quarterly earnings past the \$3 billion mark for the first time.

Its shares hit a record on the share buyback plan and higher-than-forecast profit. They closed at \$41.70 on Nov 7, up 6.5 per cent. The stock has gained more than 37 per cent this year.

DBS, the first local lender to report third-quarter results, said net profit surged 15 per cent to \$3.03 billion, beating the mean estimate of nearly \$2.8 billion from five analysts, according to LSEG data.

It also topped the previous quarterly record of \$2.96 billion set in the first quarter of 2024, even though its net interest margin, a key profitability gauge, declined to 2.11 per cent during the third quarter from 2.19 per cent the same quarter a year earlier.

Net profit for the nine months to Sept 30 rose 11 per cent year on year to a record \$8.79 billion.

The strong result came on the back of record fee income driven by **wealth management**, higher treasury customer sales and increased markets trading income.

DBS sees an upside to its 2025 profit when Donald Trump takes office as US president next year, as his policies could spell fewer interest rate cuts by the Federal Reserve that translate into higher net interest margin.

The incoming Trump administration is generally expected to adopt stricter immigration policies and impose more tariffs that could spur inflation, as well as increased deficit spending, DBS chief executive Piyush Gupta said in a briefing on DBS' results.

"If that is the case, then it is possible that the Fed monetary policy might stay tighter than is currently being projected," he added. "I think higher interest rate environment is generally better for DBS."

Nevertheless, Mr Gupta said DBS, with operations across the region from Singapore to China, must be wary of legal and regulatory risks under Trump's administration.

DBS forecast 2025 net profit to be below 2024 levels due to a 15 per cent global minimum corporate tax being introduced by Singapore from January and imposed on multinational companies including DBS. Pre-tax profit and group net interest income will be around 2024 levels, according to Mr Gupta's observation slides accompanying the results.

Net interest margin will see a slight decline that could be mostly offset by loan growth, he added.

Non-interest income for the commercial book will grow at "high-single digits" next year, led by **wealth management** fees and treasury customer sales, he said.

DBS, which is South-east Asia's biggest bank, announced a quarterly dividend of 54 cents per share, up from 48 cents declared the same quarter a year ago. The third-quarter dividend will be paid out on or about Nov 25.

The bank announced that its board had established a new share buyback programme of \$3 billion.

Similar to other firms, DBS periodically buys back its stock in the open market. This is the first time, however, that repurchased shares will be cancelled. Post-buyback, DBS will retain about \$6 billion in excess capital, according to Bloomberg Intelligence analyst Rena Kwok.

"The new buyback programme... is underpinned by our strong capital position and ongoing earnings generation, and it is another affirmation of our commitment to capital management," Mr Gupta said.

He said there is no timeframe for the buybacks to take place and the programme could take "a few years to do".

DBS said the programme is expected to provide a "permanent lift" to its earnings per share as well as return on equity.

Asked why the bank opted for a buyback instead of paying out the excess capital to shareholders via a special dividend, deputy CEO Tan Su Shan, who will take over from Mr Gupta in March 2025, said: "The buyback programme expands our toolkit for capital management. The considerable amount of capital we have returned in recent years has been a distinguishing hallmark that remains well-supported by our financial strength."

Morgan Stanley analysts said that while the share repurchase programme is a "positive surprise", the value creation is limited given the bank's high valuation. DBS is trading at more than 1.7 times its book value, the highest among the three local banks.

OCBC Bank and UOB are scheduled to report their quarterly results on Nov 8. REUTERS, BLOOMBERG

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breakingnews

HSBC wins Thailand's Best International Bank awards

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Bangkok Post

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HSBC Thailand won Best International Bank in Thailand awards from Euromoney and FinanceAsia, World's leading financial publications, reaffirming its mission to 'open up a world of opportunities' as the leading bank for inbound international business into Thailand and the leading international bank for Thai corporates and High-Net-Worth Individuals (HNWI) looking to grow and diversify regionally and globally.

HSBC Thailand's expertise and strong commitment to long-term investment in the Thai market, along with its support for the growth of local businesses and the economy, have been recognised through numerous prestigious awards, according to chief executive of HSBC Thailand, Giorgio Gamba.

Furthermore, HSBC is recognised as Asia's Best Bank and Asia's Best Bank for Sustainable Finance by Euromoney. Across the Asean region, HSBC has also been honoured as the "Best International Bank" in five of the six Asean countries in which it operates, namely Thailand, Malaysia, Singapore, the Philippines and Vietnam.

In addition, HSBC Thailand has earned further 9 accolades such as Thailand's "Best Service Provider for Transaction Banking" and Thailand's "Best Service Provider for Trade Finance" from the Asset Triple A Awards 2024. These awards, many of which have been won consecutively over several years, highlight HSBC's deep roots and solid expertise in the Thai market as the country's first bank since 1888.

International Connectivity

With a strong global network across 60 countries, HSBC empowers its local branch to support Thai businesses, particularly in cross-border banking services, where the bank holds a significant advantage.

As one of the largest financial institutions in the world, HSBC facilitates cross-border investments on a global scale, helping clients connect business flows across major trade corridors where the bank maintains an active presence.

HSBC's international connectivity, combined with its extensive expertise, breadth, and perspective, uniquely positions the bank to unlock new opportunities for both Thai and foreign clients.

Mr Gamba emphasised that HSBC Thailand has leveraged the strengths and advantages of its parent company to support all customer segments, including multinational firms, large Thai corporations, and medium-sized businesses. At the same time, HSBC Thailand is committed to meeting the needs of all customer segments through its comprehensive financial solutions.

HSBC Thailand's cross-border banking and related financial services have been specifically designed to facilitate both inbound and outbound investments for its clients.

HSBC Thailand supports Thai businesses in expanding into 41 countries.

"On average, we assist each local customer in expanding their business to three different countries. We also have two Thai clients with operations in over 20 countries globally," noted Mr Gamba.

Despite these achievements, HSBC remains focused on continually developing innovative financial products and services to fully support its clients. The bank is also committed to strengthening collaboration with both the public and private sector to facilitate local business growth and contribute to the Thai economy.

Strategic Partnership with the BOI

According to Mr Gamba, HSBC Thailand has also signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with the Board of Investment (BOI) to support Thailand's inward and outward foreign direct investment (FDI) flows. This partnership aims to leverage HSBC's international network, spanning 60 countries, to capture global FDI opportunities for Thailand.

Through this cooperation, HSBC Thailand will assist the BOI in promoting Thailand as a key investment hub in Southeast Asia. The bank will also support international investment roadshows to showcase Thailand's potential to global investors.

"Our role in this partnership is to support the BOI on international investment roadshows to showcase Thailand's potentials to the world. We aim to work with the BOI to develop new trade and investment corridors where HSBC has a presence, particularly the United Kingdom, Mainland China, Hong Kong, India, Saudi Arabia, ASEAN, and Europe," Mr. Gamba added.

Thailand has long been a key manufacturing hub in the region and remains a vital component of many global supply chains. This strategic position continues to make the country an attractive destination for large-scale investments from both Asean countries and global markets.

"As a regional manufacturing powerhouse, Thailand is quite strong and attractive for FDI in several industries, especially the auto industry. Thailand stands to gain significantly from the global growth of electric vehicles [EVs], especially from Chinese manufacturers, positioning the country to become a key player in this sector."

Thailand continues to be a vital market for international corporations and a prime destination for FDI. Additionally, HSBC Thailand is focused on facilitating investments in strategic sectors where Thailand possesses a distinct competitive advantage, Mr. Gamba said.

According to Mr Gamba, HSBC's country strategy aligns with Thailand's national plan, particularly in sectors such as EVs, digital innovation, and environmental, social, and governance (ESG) initiatives. The bank's key international clients from China, intra-Asean, and the US are also following Thailand's FDI trends.

Digital Banking

The development of digital banking is another crucial area for supporting business growth in Thailand. HSBC has launched HSBC UniTransact, an innovative digital solution designed to streamline cross-border transactions with enhanced speed, cost efficiency and transparency.

Since its introduction in 2022, HSBC Thailand has seen a remarkable 34% increase in cross-border payment turnover, along with a substantial 27% rise in the number of cross-border transactions.

Moreover, HSBC ranks as the global leader in digital payments and is investing an additional US\$2 billion in digital banking transformation. The institution processes over 4 billion transactions annually, totaling around \$600 trillion.

Global **Private Banking**

As a leading international bank in Thailand, HSBC has long provided financial services to both local and global businesses. While large corporations and multinational firms have traditionally formed the core of the bank's customer base, HSBC Thailand is increasingly expanding its Global **Private Banking** business to support the ambitions of Thai HNWI and UHNWI to manage, grow, and preserve their wealth legacy for generations to come.

HSBC Global **Private Banking** ranks among one of Asia's largest **private banks** with an extensive regional footprint. It operates in over 40 markets and 13 strategic booking centres across the globe. This makes us stand out against competition to offer global wealth and mobility solutions to our clients. Our Global **Private Banking** in Thailand is the 2nd onshore location in Southeast Asia, bringing access to a wide range of sophisticated wealth product into the local market.

Confidence in Thailand

"We are committed to growing our business, expanding our client base, investing in Thailand, and helping our clients connect with regional and global opportunities to invest and grow," said Mr Gamba.

"We will work closely with the government to shape industrial policy and create client opportunities. When our client's business succeeds, so does ours," he concluded.



Business

StanChart beats forecasts with net profit of US\$931m

Mia Castagnone

553 words

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SCMP

B1

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British bank plans to bolster **wealth management** business and sell underperforming operations

Standard Chartered plans to bolster its **wealth management** business and sell underperforming units after reporting better- than-expected profit for the third quarter.

Net profit for the three months to September came in at US\$931 million under international accounting rules, beating forecasts of US\$886 million.

The London-based bank, which generates much of its income in Asia, reported US\$1.7 billion in pre-tax profit, exceeding the US\$1.5 billion forecast by analysts. Operating income rose by 11 per cent to US\$4.9 billion.

"We have delivered a strong performance in the third quarter, driven by a record quarter in wealth solutions and strong growth in our global markets business," chief executive Bill Winters said in a statement to the Hong Kong stock exchange yesterday.

"We are doubling investments in our fast-growing and high- returning **wealth management** business, and we will continue to reshape our mass retail business to focus on developing our pipeline of future affluent and international banking clients."

Shares in Standard Chartered closed 3 per cent higher at HK\$90.75 yesterday.

Operating income for the wealth solutions business jumped by 32 per cent to US\$694 million, supported by a continued strong momentum and an increase in affluent new clients. Operating income from global markets grew by 16 per cent to US\$840 million.

Standard Chartered said it planned to invest about US\$1.5 billion over five years, double the amount outlined previously, to bolster its **wealth management** business.

The bank plans to increase the headcount of relationship managers and investment advisers, and enhance its wealth solutions, as well as cross-border and digital capabilities.

Standard Chartered attracted more than 70,000 new affluent customers and US\$10 billion in deposits during the third quarter, chief financial officer Diego de Giorgi said in a media call yesterday. It has attracted "north of 60,000 clients" for seven consecutive quarters.

The investment outlay for the **wealth management** unit would come from the restructuring of the retail business, he said.

The bank said it could sell part or all of its "smaller businesses where the strategic rationale was not sufficiently compelling", adding a sale would take place in the next 18 to 24 months.

De Giorgi cited China's importance to Standard Chartered.

"Chinese and Hong Kong clients remain an absolute core to our very diversified geographical offer, but our heart beats very strong in Hong Kong," he said.

The second area of focus will be its corporate and investment banking segment, which includes cross-border transactions in Asia, Africa and the Middle East. The bank plans to consolidate its client base and reduce the number of clients whose needs do not match its strengths.

Winters said the bank would increase its shareholder distribution – dividends and buy-backs – target to at least US\$8 billion from US\$5 billion from 2024 to 2026.

In July, it said it would buy back US\$1.5 billion of shares and pay an interim dividend of 9 US cents per share following its second-quarter earnings.

Net interest income increased by 9 per cent to US\$2.6 billion.

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HSBC's private bank unit in Asia hits \$205bn in invested assets

Cheryl Heng

329 words

30 October 2024

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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HSBC's global private banking unit saw its Asia invested assets grow 30% year on year, the bank said in its third-quarter results.

The Asia region had \$205bn of invested assets as of the third quarter this year, making up more than half of the global private banking assets, which sat at \$397bn.

Its wealth and personal banking unit recorded profit before tax of \$0.5bn in the third quarter, up 16% year on year.

Wealth revenue was up 25% year on year, buoyed by general higher fees collected. Its private bank arm saw strong brokerage and trading performance in Asia, while the investment distribution unit noted higher sales of mutual funds and structured products.

In the third quarter, its Asia wealth business attracted \$11bn of net new invested assets (NNIA), of which its private banking business pulled in \$5bn.

This brings its total NNIA assets attracted in the first nine months of 2024 to \$59bn, with \$49bn booked in Asia.

The lender announced a major overhaul last week under its new CEO Georges Elhedery to control costs and improve efficiency. It is restructuring the bank into four businesses, namely Hong Kong, UK, corporate and institutional banking, and international wealth and premier banking.

Elhedery said in yesterday's earnings statement that these plans will be implemented immediately but further details will be shared next February.

Overall, HSBC reported better-than-expected profit for the quarter, up 10% to \$8.5bn, while announcing to buy back \$3bn of shares.

'We delivered another good quarter, which shows that our strategy is working. There was strong revenue growth and good performances in wealth and wholesale transaction banking,' said Elhedery.

Its private banking arm recently rolled out an exclusive credit card in Hong Kong called HSBC Privé card. The bank also noted success on semi-liquid funds with private bank clients, with private credit taking the lion's share.

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Business

Standard Chartered to focus on wealth business, sell units after upbeat earnings

Mia Castagnone

759 words

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Net profit for the June to September period handily beat analysts' estimates of US\$886 million

[Standard Chartered](#), one of Hong Kong's three currency-issuing banks, plans to bolster its **wealth management** business and sell its underperforming units after reporting better-than-expected profit for the third quarter.

Net profit for the three months to September came in at US\$931 million under international accounting rules, beating forecasts of US\$886 million.

The London-based bank, which generates much of its income in Asia, reported US\$1.7 billion in pre-tax profit, exceeding the US\$1.5 billion forecast by analysts. Operating income, which is similar to revenue in US accounting terms, rose 11 per cent to US\$4.9 billion.

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"We have delivered a strong performance in the third quarter driven by a record quarter in wealth solutions and strong growth in our global markets business," CEO Bill Winters said in a statement to the Hong Kong stock exchange on Wednesday.

"We are doubling investments in our consistently fast-growing and high-returning **wealth management** business, and we will continue to reshape our mass retail business to focus on developing our pipeline of future affluent and international banking clients."

Operating income for the bank's wealth solutions business rose 32 per cent to US\$694 million, supported by continued strong momentum and an increase in affluent new clients. Global markets' operating income rose 16 per cent to US\$840 million.

Standard Chartered said it plans to invest around US\$1.5 billion over five years, double its previously planned investments, to bolster its **wealth management** business. It plans to increase its headcount of relationship managers and investment advisers, and enhance its wealth solutions, cross-border and digital capabilities.

"We have decided to step up our planned investment into this business to accelerate income growth and returns," the bank said.

The bank also said it could sell part or all of its "smaller businesses where the strategic rationale is not sufficiently compelling", adding that a sale will take place in the next 18 to 24 months. It did not give any details.

The second area of focus will be its corporate and investment banking segment, which includes cross-border transactions in Asia, Africa and the Middle East. It plans to consolidate its client base and reduce the number of clients whose needs do not match its strengths.

Winters said the bank would increase its shareholder distribution – dividends and buy-backs – target to at least US\$8 billion from US\$5 billion from 2024 to 2026.

In July, Standard Chartered said it would buy back US\$1.5 billion of shares and pay an interim dividend of 9 US cents per share following its second-quarter earnings.

Standard Chartered shares jumped 3.1 per cent in the afternoon to HK\$90.85 after the earnings report was released during the lunch break.

Net interest income increased by 9 per cent to US\$2.6 billion.

The net interest margin, an important measure of lending profitability, rose to 1.95 per cent in the third quarter, from 1.63 per cent a year earlier. It increased by 24 basis points from 1.71 per cent in the second quarter.

Underlying pre-tax profit in the corporate and investment banking segment rose 9 per cent to US\$1.4 billion.

Standard Chartered took credit impairment charges of US\$178 million during the quarter, an increase of 39 per cent from a year earlier. This included a US\$177 million charge in its wealth and retail banking business, which was higher than normal because of a US\$21 million overlay relating to the bank's Korea e-commerce platforms.

On Tuesday, rival HSBC's CEO, Georges Elhedery, announced a US\$3 billion stock buy-back after the city's biggest currency-issuing bank delivered results that beat market estimates, buoyed by growth in its wealth and personal banking divisions.

HSBC's net profit rose 9 per cent to US\$6.13 billion under international accounting rules for the quarter ended September 30, beating market forecasts to grow for the first time in four quarters. Total revenue increased by 5 per cent to US\$17.21 billion.

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HSBC launches its most prestigious credit card for Global **Private Banking** clients

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945 words

24 October 2024

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* HSBC launched HSBC Privé, a premium credit card for **private banking** clients in Hong Kong, with plans to expand to Singapore, India, and more markets globally.

* The card is designed for ultra high net worth and high net worth clients who are entrepreneurial, international, and keen to expand their networks globally.

* Credit card spending by these clients in the Asia Pacific region nearly doubled between 2022 and 2023, with hotel accommodation and dining being the leading spending categories.

Original Press Release:

Oct. 24 -- HSBC **Private Banking** issued the following news release:

HSBC has unveiled HSBC Privé – its first premium credit card designed with privileges exclusively curated for **private banking** clients.

The launch in Hong Kong this week inaugurated the first phase of a global programme to offer elevated travel, exclusive access and exceptional lifestyle experiences to its clients. Following its debut in Hong Kong, the invitation-only card will also be launched in Singapore, India and more markets globally.

Launched in partnership with Mastercard, HSBC Privé's privileges are specially curated for its ultra high net worth and high net worth clients, who are entrepreneurial, international and keen to expand their networks to discover new opportunities globally.

Lok Yim, Regional Head of Global **Private Banking**, Asia Pacific, HSBC, said: "Every moment counts for our Global **Private Banking** clients, who often live busy global lives to pursue their personal and business ambitions. Our clients choose us not only because of our deep understanding of their wealth management needs, but also our capabilities to provide them with bespoke services beyond **private banking**.

With their aspirations and lifestyle needs in mind, we are excited to welcome our clients to discover the unparalleled experiences and opportunities that HSBC Privé has to offer."

Credit card spending by ultra high net worth and high net worth Mastercard cardholders in the Asia Pacific region nearly doubled between 2022 and 2023¹. Hotel accommodation and dining outlets emerged as the leading overseas spending categories for these cardholders in 2023, with transaction volumes rising by 87 per cent and 78 per cent respectively, compared to 2022. Additionally, dining was their top local spending category in 2023 and saw a 74 per cent year-on-year increase in transaction volume^[1].

Recognising these spending trends, HSBC Privé is built upon deep client insights to cater to the needs of ultra high net worth and high net worth clients.

Driven by a client-centric approach, HSBC Global **Private Banking** conducted in-depth studies in early 2024 to review recent market developments and future client needs^[2].

Dedicated Lifestyle Relationship Managers are available to assist HSBC Privé cardholders to explore a suite of prestigious benefits^[3] uniquely curated for them, including:

* Exclusive access — worldwide access to bespoke private clubs, members-only lounges and workspaces at more than 150 locations across Asia, Australia, Europe and the United States

* Elevated travel — A companion first or business class airline ticket with leading airlines, access to premium airport lounges worldwide, airport limousine transfers, hotel night stays, hotel loyalty membership upgrades and travel insurance

* Exceptional lifestyle — Complimentary tasting menus for an accompanying guest at Michelin-starred restaurants and premium hospitality groups, courtesy green fees at select golf courses and fast-track to top membership status at iconic department stores in London and Paris

Ari Sarker, President, Asia Pacific, Mastercard, said: “HSBC Privé is crafted for individuals for whom international is a way of life. In a constant pursuit of the extraordinary, they seek the same level of access and experience wherever they are in the world. They are ambitious yet intentional in how they expand their network and sphere of influence. In recognition of these needs, Mastercard is proud to elevate extraordinary experiences everywhere for HSBC’s Global **Private Banking** clients as they explore the world on their terms and make the connections that matter.”

About HSBC Global **Private Banking**

HSBC Global **Private Banking** helps clients manage, grow and preserve their wealth for generations to come. Its network of global experts helps clients access investment opportunities around the world, plan for the future with wealth and succession planning, manage their portfolio with tailored solutions, and find the right support for their philanthropy. www.privatebanking.hsbc.com.

About HSBC Holdings plc

HSBC Holdings plc, the parent company of HSBC, is headquartered in London. HSBC serves customers worldwide from offices in 60 countries and territories. With assets of USD2,975 billion at 30 June 2024, HSBC is one of the world’s largest banking and financial services organisations.

About Mastercard (NYSE: MA)

Mastercard is a global technology company in the payments industry. Our mission is to connect and power an inclusive, digital economy that benefits everyone, everywhere by making transactions safe, simple, smart and accessible. Using secure data and networks, partnerships and passion, our innovations and solutions help individuals, financial institutions, governments and businesses realize their greatest potential. With connections across more than 210 countries and territories, we are building a sustainable world that unlocks priceless possibilities for all. www.mastercard.com

Footnotes:

[1] Statistics provided by Mastercard Asia Pacific.

[2] The HSBC GPB Credit Card Value Proposition Survey was conducted between February and March 2024 with more than 200 existing Global **Private Banking** clients in Hong Kong and Singapore. The survey reveals that a vast majority of HSBC Global **Private Banking** clients are existing HSBC credit cardholders in Hong Kong (97 per cent) and Singapore (77 per cent), who have supportively contributed their ideas to today’s HSBC Privé programme. ↩

[3] Terms and conditions apply.

[Category: Banks, Banks, Retail/ Commercial Bank, New Offerings]

Source: HSBC **Private Banking**

Document ATINBK0020241025ekao0008e

StanChart rolls out 'Global Indian' proposition, launches India centre

Priyanka Boghani

353 words

23 October 2024

Citywire Middle East

CWIRME

English

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Standard Chartered said it has 'refreshed' its Global Indian proposition to better serve affluent and high net worth individuals in India, Singapore, Hong Kong, the UAE and the UK.

The suite of products and services for its Priority, Priority Private and global **private bank** propositions include access to signature investment opportunities, international banking capabilities and cross-border wealth and lending solutions. The Global Indian offering will also have a team of relationship managers who are based close to where the clients are.

'Wealthy Indians have a strong entrepreneurial spirit and are very sophisticated, with complex investment needs,' said Vinay Gandhi, global head, global South Asian community and regional head, Europe, Africa & Middle East, **private banking** at Standard Chartered.

The proposition also looks to cater to the increasingly global nature of Indians who are looking abroad to set up family offices or park their wealth in various jurisdictions as their wealth requirements change.

'The Indian diaspora now has a more "global" investment outlook,' added recently-[promoted](#) Rajesh Kannan, Standard Chartered's head of global Indian and head of wealth and retail banking UAE, Jersey (UK). 'We are focused on managing this change by providing an international gateway for these clients by leveraging our international wealth centres combined with our deep-rooted knowledge and understanding of India to support their global wealth ambitions beyond borders.'

India centre

In addition, the bank has established an international priority centre in Mumbai, making it the first globally. It will give clients an in-person place to meet their teams and access international financial solutions. It also offers unique lifestyle experiences such as exclusive dining opportunities and travel assistance.

Standard Chartered **Private Bank** India already has five **private banking** centres across India and [manages](#) over \$10bn in assets, with \$56bn in assets under custody, as of June 2024. It has around 35 **private bankers**.

The firm plans to add more centres in 2025 as the UHNW population in non-metro locations in the country increases, Pankaj Walia, the India **private banking** CEO told Citywire Asia in an earlier conversation.

Document CWIRME0020241023ekan00002

MINT, Industry

Standard Chartered to focus on affluent, SME banking; sees 12-15% SME business growth

Anshika Kayastha

739 words

22 October 2024

Mint

HNMINI

English

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Mumbai, Oct. 22 -- Following the recent sale of its personal loan business to Kotak Mahindra Bank, Standard Chartered India is now looking to "double down" on affluent banking, SME (small and medium enterprise) loans, and **wealth management**, a top official of the bank said.

Aditya Mandloi, managing director and head of wealth and retail banking-India and South Asia, said that the mindsets of resident Indians are changing. "As their affluence increases, their outlook becomes more global. Their needs and wants are going beyond the geographical boundaries of the country," he said. At the same time, Mandloi added that bank's global network also allows non-resident Indians to extend their banking relationships to India.

On the SME side, the bank expects growth to be faster, allowing more opportunity to cross-sell and offer **wealth management** and investment solutions to self-employed and individual business owners. "If the India economy grows 6-7%, we should be growing 12-15% on the SME side," Mandloi told Mint at the sidelines of an event to launch the bank's first international banking centre branch in Mumbai.

The branch will focus on helping affluent and high-net-worth individuals manage their wealth and banking needs across the globe, the bank said in a statement, adding that the scope of these customers has shifted from just NRIs to "global Indians" given the rising global aspirations and outlook of local Indians for their personal, business and wealth requirements.

Also read | Wipro wins multi-million dollar deal from Standard Chartered

The bank aims to address this shift by providing a multi-market gateway for these clients, by leveraging its international wealth centres in Singapore, UAE, Hong Kong, Jersey (UK) and India. This will include investment opportunities, international banking and cross-border wealth and lending solutions.

The bank said that the initiative is being led by a team of highly experienced INSEAD-trained relationship managers based close to where the clients are, supported by a global network of wealth specialists and partners that help clients seamlessly manage their wealth across borders.

Mandloi said that by end-2025, 75% of the bank's priority relationship managers are expected to have completed the INSEAD programme, with the aim of growing the number of relationship managers to 950 from around 810 currently. The bank also has "aggressive hiring plans" to take in **wealth management** specialists in addition to relationship managers.

The foreign bank currently has branches in 42 cities, of which it offers SME solutions via branches in 18 of these cities.

The foreign bank currently offers SME solutions in 18 of the 42 cities in which it has branches. The minimum threshold for the loan segment is around Rs.10 lakh, which entails a basic unsecured loan, going up to partly secured trade working capital facilities of up to Rs.80 crore, he added.

Also read | Standard Chartered set to exit CDSL with 7.18% stake sale

Standard Chartered defines the affluent segment as those with an annual income of Rs.15 lakh and above, priority segment as Rs.30-50 lakh, and private banking of up to around \$1 million (about Rs.8.5 crore), Mandloi said during a press meet adding that there is work happening to see whether "these thresholds can be moved".

The bank currently has about 90,000-95,000 retail or individual customers in India and around 27,000 SME customers. It estimates the affluent market size at around 750,000, including both resident and non-resident customers.

The recent sale of the personal business to Kotak Bank for Rs.4,100 crore is in-line with the bank's global strategy of focusing on more high-ticket, affluent segments, Mandloi said.

The bank's average ticket size for the personal loan business was Rs.2.5-3.5 lakh. The portfolio largely comprised relatively small-ticket and small-tenure loans, which are not seen as part of the "core requirement of affluent segment", the bank said, adding that it will also look at other products such as credit cards and cross-border payments within the ambit of this affluent customer segment.

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Business

Hong Kong to host Rockefeller, Middle East tycoons at global **family office** forum

Enoch Yiu

707 words

15 October 2024

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SCMCOM

English

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Standard Chartered to kick off its inaugural global **family office** forum in Hong Kong as the city enhances its role in the region

More than 200 representatives from some of the world's [wealthiest families](#), including the Rockefeller family, will be in Hong Kong this week to network, develop business ties and seek growth opportunities in the region, according to Standard Chartered.

Tycoons from the Middle East, India and Africa are also expected to show up at the Global Family Network Forum, a move seen as helping Hong Kong establish an edge over rival regional financial centres for the assets and talents in the industry.

The two-day forum, which kicks off on Tuesday at the Four Seasons Hotel in Central, will be the UK lender's inaugural annual event, according to Raymond Ang, global head of private banking and affluent clients for Greater China and North Asia. More than half of the attendees will be flying to Hong Kong for the event, he said.

Do you have questions about the biggest topics and trends from around the world? Get the answers with [SCMP Knowledge](#), our new platform of curated content with explainers, FAQs, analyses and infographics brought to you by our award-winning team.

"Many of our private banking clients want us to host a global event for them to meet with their peers, learn from their experience or explore business collaborations," Ang said in an interview on Monday. "Hong Kong is a natural place to hold a large-scale **family office** forum in Asia because of its large pool of wealth."

Assets under management in Hong Kong grew 2.1 per cent to HK\$31.2 trillion (US\$4 trillion) in 2023, while net fund inflows surged 342 per cent to HK\$389 billion in the same period, according to government data. Standard Chartered managed US\$294 billion of assets globally on behalf of its affluent clients at the end of June.

Financial Secretary Paul Chan Mo-po will deliver a welcome speech at a dinner on Tuesday. Discussions on family succession, investing in different asset classes, globalising family businesses and other topics will follow in a full-day session on Wednesday, according to Ang.

Justin Rockefeller, a great-great-grandson of John Rockefeller, will be among key speakers on Wednesday. He is a co-founder and chairman of The ImPact, a global membership community of 75 prominent families committed to improving the environment and social problems through their investments.

Hong Kong developer New World Development's executive director Sonia Cheng Chi-man and her uncle Peter Cheng Kar-shing, are also among the speakers.

While many wealthy tycoons have already set up **family offices** in their home countries, they are also exploring setting up a new base in Hong Kong, Ang said. The forum will allow them to learn more about Hong Kong's latest policies and incentives for **family offices**, he added.

"These **family offices** are growing so quickly that they may have a **family office** in multiple markets," Ang said. "Some European families have offices in Hong Kong, Singapore, London and Switzerland because they want people with local knowledge", while others are keen on Greater China area opportunities, he added.

They also view Hong Kong's tax incentives and other policies for **family offices** to be more favourable than those in Singapore, he said.

Hong Kong launched its investment migration scheme in March, which fast-tracks residency for individuals who invest HK\$30 million or more in stocks, bonds or insurance policies in Hong Kong. This followed a tax incentive for **family offices** in May last year.

Ang believes the outlook for **family offices** in Hong Kong is bright. The recent stock market rally, fuelled by the first US interest-rate cut in this cycle and China's stimulus bazooka last month, has helped improve market sentiment.

"**Family offices** have been investing for generations, and they take a very long-term view," Ang said. "They believe in the long-term growth story of Hong Kong and mainland China. Hong Kong is very attractive because it is very international, and it is a gateway to mainland China."

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Business

Hong Kong investors should be cautious about sustainability of stock market rally: DBS

Mia Castagnone

543 words

9 October 2024

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SCMCOM

English

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Effects of China fiscal policies and corporate earnings should be assessed before judging staying power of rally, Singaporean bank says

Investors in Hong Kong will need to assess the effects of [China's fiscal policies](#) as well as corporate earnings before getting excited about the sustainability of the stock market rally, according to DBS **Private Bank**.

The bank's in-house target for the Hang Seng Index at the end of 2024 is 20,300, which was set before surprise policy announcements from Beijing last month pushed the benchmark to a 32-month high of 23,099.78 on Monday.

"The target can overshoot to 22,800 but that's a technical overshoot," Michelle Ho, the head of investment strategy at the chief investment office (North Asia), said at a briefing in Hong Kong on Tuesday. "Fundamentally we are waiting for more fiscal policies to come out and see how that turns into company earnings."

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"Beijing's policy measures are unprecedented, and it is a booster for the sentiment," Ho added.

[Hong Kong's market cooled off on Tuesday](#), with a record HK\$620 billion worth of shares changing hands. It plunged 9.4 per cent in its worst day since 2008, wiping out all the gains it made while markets on the mainland were shut for a long holiday.

Meanwhile, [mainland-listed stocks](#) rallied after Chinese markets reopened. The CSI 300 Index, which tracks the largest companies in Shanghai and Shenzhen, closed 5.9 per cent higher after surging as much as 10.8 per cent earlier.

The initial euphoria surrounding China's onshore and offshore stocks waned after an eagerly anticipated news conference by the National Development and Reform Commission (NDRC) did not deliver the [additional stimulus goodies](#) that market participants were expecting.

On a broader note, the Singaporean **private bank** believes "it is now time for Asean equities to shine" as stocks from the Association of Southeast Asian Nations will benefit from lower global interest rates and a weaker US dollar.

The bank is bullish on stocks that are tapped into long-term secular growth trends like technology, healthcare, ageing populations, and the rise of middle-class spending in China.

"We've always had faith in the Chinese government to gradually introduce enough measures to turn around and boost their economy within the China market," Ho said. The bull market in stocks is expected to continue and will largely be led by AI-driven stocks, which she said is in its infancy and has immense growth potential.

Overall, additional rate cuts from the US Federal Reserve will provide some momentum for all assets that carry risk.

In the coming quarter, DBS **Private Bank** has a preference for Chinese banks for their income and dividend yielding ability, in addition to shares of technology, insurance and e-commerce firms. The bank maintained its preference for bonds and is overweight on developed-market government and corporate bonds.

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Gatekeepers: Standard Chartered turns to alts to give India access

Priyanka Boghani

539 words

8 October 2024

Citywire Asia

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Most **private banks** in the region are using mutual funds or exchange-traded funds (ETFs) with exposure to Indian stocks to give their clients exposure to the burgeoning market, but Standard Chartered is looking at private market solutions, the bank's alternative investments head says.

The British lender will launch pre-initial public offering and private credit strategies in India to give its investors a good way to generate income, Mischa Bitton said.

'It's all very exciting,' he said. 'Our international investors, which include non-resident Indians [NRIs], also see tailwinds in the Indian market and want access, so we are looking at solutions that are India-only.'

Typically, NRI investors have had a 'home bias' towards India and have been relatively more comfortable with rupee-denominated investments compared with their international counterparts. An eight-year bull run, positive forecasts on GDP growth, the financialisation of assets, and the growth of wealth have made India a standout market.

Bitton said the country's regulatory framework, including the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016, has helped assuage concerns from international investors looking for private markets investments in India. Further, the emergence of new rules and a focus on India's first international financial zone, GIFT City, has helped reduce the tax leakage for overseas clients. This has allowed them to gain a liquidity premium.

'In the last 12 months, the scope has broadened and we are seeing a wider set of clients who are seeing the favourable macroeconomic conditions in India,' Bitton said.

<figure></figure>

Private banks offer India mutual funds and ETFs to clients interested in the country, but international investors are seeking alternative asset classes for diversification as well.

Onshore opportunities

The alternatives team also helps the onshore India desk with sourcing, identifying new products, onboarding, and distributing them in the country, Bitton said, adding that the teams have already launched three to four funds this year as a joint effort.

Most recently, the bank tied up with an Indian venture capital fund, which it chose not to name, aiming to give onshore India clients alternatives and rupee exposure, delivering 20%+ annual returns.

'We are observing a paradigm shift: on one side Indian private asset managers are now looking to diversify away from their traditional institutional investors, and on the other side individual investors are increasingly open to investing in private assets.'

Standard Chartered **Private Bank** India, headed by Pankaj Walia, **manages** more than \$10bn in assets and at the end of June had \$58bn in assets under custody. The onshore desk has about 35 **private bankers** and aims to reach 40 by the end of the year.

Walia said the rise of alternative investment fund vehicles among the ultra-high-net-worth band has helped investors access emerging new sectors, such as technology, healthcare and renewable energy.

Bitton said the longer time frame for fundraising in India (about one year) compared with the shorter windows of offshore fundraising rounds, has helped the venture capital strategy gain a strong reception from clients.

The generative AI theme has been popular and will likely be a source of 'supersize returns in the next 20 years,' Bitton added.

Document CWIRAS0020241008eka800002

HSBC GPB names Southeast Asia structured products head

Priyanka Boghani

204 words

7 October 2024

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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HSBC Global **Private Banking** (GPB) has hired a products specialist to head its structured products desk for the Southeast Asia region.

Chinmay Patil has joined the bank to build on growing appetite among **private banking** clients, based in Singapore. Patil is now part of HSBC's investments and wealth solutions team and reports to Ishan Sarkar, HSBC's head of capital markets for Southeast Asia.

A spokesperson from the bank confirmed Patil's hire.

Patil was most recently at Taskinetics for a brief period and previously spent almost nine years at structured products platform specialist Leonteq as its Asia head of **private banking** sales. He has also worked on Deutsche Bank's structured products desk in Singapore.

Private banks in the region have seen an uptick in interest in private market assets, however, some clients have opted to take a tactical approach and trade derivatives. In particular, the rise in cash rates and the decrease in volatility has provided opportunities for investors to tap into equity-linked structured products.

HSBC GPB recently [announced](#) a tie-up with global fintech platform iCapital as a technology provider for private market investments in Hong Kong and Singapore.

Document CWIRAS0020241007eka700001

Exclusive: DBS Private Bank bulks Philippines team with CS hires

Priyanka Boghani

217 words

6 October 2024

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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DBS Private Bank has hired two from Credit Suisse, including a new team head to bolster its Southeast Asia desk, Citywire Asia has learned.

Anne Gabriel is joining DBS Private Bank as its new Singapore-based team head for Philippines, reporting to Edwin Tan, the Singaporean private bank's market head of Thailand and the Philippines. Clement Choong, who relocated from Hong Kong to Singapore, is also joining the Philippines team and will report to Gabriel, along with an existing team of four other bankers.

Both Gabriel and Choong are former Credit Suisse bankers who have both spent almost a decade at the Swiss private bank. Gabriel was also previously market head for the South Asia market at HSBC Global Private Bank.

Citywire Asia reached out to DBS for a comment on the hires.

DBS Private Bank has been building its Southeast Asia desk, hiring aggressively for its onshore and offshore Thailand desk, as it looks to triple its onshore Thailand assets under management and allow clients to access offshore investments via a single banker.

The bank recently made its current group head of institutional banking and long-time private banking veteran Tan Su Shan deputy CEO, positioning her to succeed Piyush Gupta as CEO.

Document CWIRAS0020241007eka600005

Exclusive: UBS GWM Thai market head tipped to join StanChart

Priyanka Boghani

217 words

3 October 2024

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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UBS Global Wealth Management's former market head is slated to join Standard Chartered's Thailand team, according to multiple sources.

Boriboon Niyomsathien will join the British lender's Thailand team, led by his [former](#) colleague Tian Ong Foo, regional head of Southeast Asia, and Singapore head for the private banking business.

A spokesperson for Standard Chartered declined to comment on the hire.

Niyomsathien was named UBS GWM's Thailand market team head along with Raymond Heng during the organisational restructuring at UBS GWM following its merger with Credit Suisse last year. Following his departure, the Swiss private bank reshuffled its Thai team, promoting Kwankamol Thongyai to business sector head GWM Thailand, according to an internal memo [seen](#) by Citywire Asia.

Meanwhile, Standard Chartered has continued to hire bankers from UBS GWM on both sides of the seniority scale. Earlier this month, the bank [named](#) former UBS GWM market team head Matthew Henderson as its team leader for Singapore and Malaysia and it is also to [onboard](#) John George.

The British lender has also made several internal reshuffles to its leadership teams, appointing Vinay Gandhi as its global head of the South Asian community and regional head of Africa, Middle East and Europe earlier this year.

Document CWIRAS0020241003eka300003

HSBC Elevates Premier Offering to Meet Growing Wealth, Health, International and Lifestyle Needs of Mass Affluent Customers in Singapore

Distributed by Contify.com

1,323 words

27 September 2024

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* HSBC launched an enhanced Premier offering in Singapore on 1 October, focusing on **wealth management**, health protection, international services, and lifestyle privileges.

* The mass affluent segment represents 11% of the global population and about 40% of global wealth.

* HSBCs Retail Invested Assets stood at USD 412 billion in June 2024.

Original Press Release:

Sept. 27 -- HSBC Group issued the following news release:

- International connectivity powers HSBC's expansion in the mass affluent customer base

HSBC's Wealth and Personal Banking (WPB) today announced the launch of an enhanced Premier offering in Singapore, designed to meet the evolving demands of affluent and internationally mobile customers.

The new proposition, launching in Singapore on 1 October, delivers comprehensive solutions in **wealth management**, health protection, international services and lifestyle privileges, strengthening HSBC's position as the top choice for affluent and international customers worldwide.

The new Premier enhancements in Singapore coincide with its launch in Hong Kong, with plans to progressively launch in the UK from next month. The mass affluent segment, representing 11% of the global population and approximately 40% of global wealth^[1], is strategically important to WPB on a global scale.

Through Premier, the bank has been serving these customers for decades, and has observed a steady growth over time. Premier customers already play an important role in building up HSBC's Retail Invested Assets, which stood at USD 412 billion in June 2024. ^[2]

Supporting affluent customers in a globally mobile world

The rise of global mobility among the mass-affluent is reshaping how people embrace international opportunities, particularly in managing their wealth and well-being across borders.

According to HSBC's Quality of Life report 2024, affluent customers in Singapore are navigating the complexities of managing their finances internationally. In Singapore, 45% of parents with children studying abroad and 44% of expatriates highlight cross-border payments as a crucial financial service, reflecting the need for seamless solutions. Additionally, 26% of parents and 30% of expatriates emphasize the importance of 24/7 global banking support, underscoring the demand for round-the-clock financial services that cater to their international lifestyles.

Moreover, the same study shows that life satisfaction significantly increases with better financial planning, with 9 in 10 individuals who take a comprehensive approach to financial planning – covering protection, wealth accumulation, retirement, and legacy objectives – reported feeling satisfied with their lives, compared to only 6 in 10 of those with a narrower focus.³

New Premier features focus on Wealth, Health, Lifestyle & International

Recognising these trends and the need for a solid support system to navigate the complexities of moving, living, and investing overseas, HSBC's elevated Premier proposition is tailored to these evolving customer needs:

* **Health and Wellness:** Amongst Singaporeans, physical wellness remains the top factor for a good quality of life, followed by financial wellness and mental wellness. [3] In response to rising healthcare costs and growing demand for wellness solutions, Premier customers will now have access to health services like discounted virtual doctor consultations, complimentary insurance, health check-ups and mental health support through strategic medical alliances. [4]

* **Travel and Lifestyle:** Through the HSBC Premier Mastercard® Credit Card and partnerships with top-tier merchants, HSBC Premier offers unique travel, dining and entertainment privileges. Benefits include airport lounge access, limousine rides, concierge services, and bespoke dining and entertainment experiences and offers. [5]

* **Wealth:** The new Future Planner tool in the HSBC mobile banking app allows customers to set, track and customise financial aspirations – whether saving for retirement, funding their child's education, or purchasing a home. Future Planner assesses needs and readiness based on the input of customers, providing actionable recommendations and access to a Relationship Manager for expert guidance.

With HSBC's unique international network, the Premier offering has played a vital role in attracting and retaining customers who manage their financial lives across borders.

Taylan Turan, CEO, Retail Banking, said: "Mass affluent customers have incredible aspirations, from international careers and overseas education for their children, to new life experiences at home and abroad. We know that building a better life isn't just down to one thing – it's many complex components. HSBC has a unique ability to meet their diverse needs through our global expertise and international reach.

Refreshing our Premier offering enables us to support a new generation of customers with their life goals and deepen our existing relationships. We know a good quality of life matters to everyone – not just financial but mental and physical health too[3], so we're committed to helping our customers navigate life well, wherever their ambitions take them."

Ashmita Acharya, Head of Wealth and Personal Banking, Singapore, added: "As Singapore continues to grow as a global financial hub, staying relevant to the evolving needs of our clients is essential. The refreshed Premier offering is our commitment to providing customers who bank in Singapore with tailored solutions that match their sophisticated demands. By combining local expertise with global connectivity, we are empowering our clients to manage their wealth and navigate a rapidly changing financial landscape."

About HSBC Premier

HSBC Premier is a premium banking service designed to provide affluent customers and their family with personalised **wealth management** and global banking support. Customers can benefit from comprehensive global banking, **wealth management**, international payment and protection solutions. For details, please visit: <https://internationalservices.hsbc.com/premier/Opens> in new window

Eligibility requirements for HSBC Premier in Singapore

* Maintain a minimum of SGD 200,000 (or its equivalent in foreign currency) in deposits, investments or insurance with HSBC.

* Automatically eligible to join Premier in Singapore if you are a Premier customer in another country/territory.

HSBC in Singapore

HSBC opened its first branch in Singapore in 1877. A qualifying full bank serving international needs of individual, corporate and institutional clients, HSBC in Singapore offers a comprehensive range of banking and financial services including retail banking and **wealth management**; commercial, investment and private banking; insurance; forfailing and trustee services; securities and capital markets services. HSBC was recognised by Euromoney as "Best International Bank in Singapore" in 2024.

Footnotes:

[1] According to Capgemini, the mass affluent segment of wealth customers (investable assets in the range of USD100,000 to USD1m), accounted for about 11% of the overall global population in 2020. Accounting for about

40% of global wealth, they are expected to replace the middle class as growth drivers in the coming decade: www.capgemini.com/insights/expert-perspectives/the-rise-of-the-mass-affluent/Opens in new window

[2] As of 30 June 2024; HSBC Holdings Interim Report 2024: <https://www.about.hsbc.com.hk/-/media/hong-kong/en/investor-relations/interim-results-2024/240731-interim-report-2024.pdf>

[3] The HSBC Global Quality of Life Report 2024 captures insights from 11,230 affluent investors across 11 markets, to understand what they consider to be a good quality of life. The Quality of Life Index provides scores derived from a multidimensional concept covering physical and mental wellness, and financial fitness: <https://internationalservices.hsbc.com/quality-of-life/2024Opens> in new window

[4] The healthcare services are benefits offered to eligible Premier and Premier Elite customers as part of the complimentary Group Personal Accident Insurance available to them. This insurance is available to Premier and Premier Elite customers residing in Singapore who have made at least one customer-initiated transaction in the past 12 months. The policy is underwritten by HSBC Life (Singapore) Pte Ltd., with HSBC Bank (Singapore) Limited is the policyholder of this group insurance policy. HSBC Life (Singapore) Pte. Ltd and HSBC Bank (Singapore) Limited are members of the HSBC Group.

[5] The travel, dining, and entertainment benefits mentioned will be rolled out progressively, with additional privileges becoming available in the coming months.

[Category: Banks, Asset Management/ Mutual Funds, Banks, Financial/ Capital Market, New Offerings]

Source: HSBC Group

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